

SUNDAY 23 AUGUST 2026

Twenty First Sunday Ordinary Time

NEWSLETTER FOR THE PARISHES OF THE WEST TYRONE PASTORAL AREA:

Aghyaran ♦ Ardstraw West & Castlederg ♦ Drumquin

REV PAUL FRASER PP, Tel:028 816 71393; REV THOMAS CANNING CC, Tel: 028 82831 225

SCHEDULE FOR THIS WEEK:

DAY	AGHYARAN	ARDSTRAW WEST & CASTLEDERG	DRUMQUIN
Monday 24 August		Mass, Castlederg: 7.30pm	Mass, 10.00am Rosary, 8.00pm at Grotto
Tuesday 25 August	Mass, 10.00am		
Wednesday 26 August			Mass, 10.00am
Thursday 27 August	Mass, 10.00am		
Friday 28 August		Mass, Castlederg: 10.00am	
Saturday 29 August	Vigil Mass, 7.30pm	Vigil Mass, Castlederg, 6.15pm	Vigil Mass: 5.00pm
Sunday 30 August	Mass, 11.00am	Mass: Dregish, 9.30am Castlederg, 11.00am Drumnabey, 12.30pm	Mass, 11.00am

THANK YOU for your generosity in last week's collection:

AGHYARAN: £844 & €30. **Church Restoration Fund:** £790 & €66.

ARDSTRAW WEST & CASTLEDERG: £1,576 & €36, made up of:

Castlederg £680 & €15, **Drumnabey** £598 & €21, **Dregish** £298. **DRUMQUIN:** £826.

Thank you, as always, to all who contribute by Standing Order. In July, these amounted to:

Aghyaran: £855 & €20. **CRF** £592. **Ardstraw West & Castlederg:** £2,481. **Drumquin:** £3,005.

ARANDERG CCE - QUIZ NIGHT: Sportsman's Inn, Castlederg, Friday 28 August, at 8.00pm. £20 per table with teams of four. Pre-book by contacting Aranderg CCE Facebook or just come along on the night. See you there!

SONGS FROM HOME - learn to sing songs written about Tyrone by people who were born here. Perform them as part of a song and story path in the Ulster American Folk Park, Omagh, Sat 11 October, 10.30am – 2.00pm. A variety of Rehearsal dates: contact Claire on 07751 371800 or Fionnuala on 07966 409372 for details. Everyone welcome!

TEAM HOPE FUNDRAISING GARDEN PARTY – Friday 4 Sept, 2.00 – 7.00pm, 30 Lurganbuoy Road, Castlederg.

Live music with Macdara O'Dwyer. Tea, coffee, treats, raffle, garden games, fun for children and families. Deborah Lowry wishes you to know that everyone is welcome - drop in at any time during the afternoon or evening.

Please remember in prayer our young parishioners, family members and friends who are making important choices and decisions at this time, having received exam results:

We pray, O Lord, that they be guided by the Holy Spirit

as they seek to plan their future, whether

at school, in third-level education or in the workplace.

Grant that the path they choose in life will bring them happiness and fulfilment.

May Your love be upon them, O Lord, as they place all their trust in You. Amen.

†

We pray for the happy repose of the soul of Michael Harper, Castlefin Road, whose Funeral Mass took place in Castlederg on Wednesday. We offer our sympathy and our prayerful support to his family and to all who mourn his death. May he rest in peace.

ARDMORE PARISH NEWSLETTER

Sunday, 23rd August 2026

21st Sunday in Ordinary Time

Thoughts on the Gospel

“You are Peter, and on this rock I will build my Church.” — Matthew 16:18

In today’s Gospel, Jesus asks His disciples a very personal question about who they believe He is. Many people had different opinions about Him, but Jesus wanted His followers to speak from their own faith and experience.

Peter answers with confidence, recognising Jesus as the promised Saviour and the Son of God.

This passage reminds us that faith cannot depend only on what others believe. We may learn about God from our parents, teachers, friends or church community, but each of us must eventually make our own response to Jesus.

Remember the word **ROCK**

R — RECOGNISE Jesus as Lord and Saviour.

O — OWN our faith through our daily choices.

C — COMMIT to the calling God gives us.

K — KEEP standing firm when life becomes difficult.

Peter was not perfect, yet Jesus still used him for a great purpose. In the same way, God can work through our weaknesses and help us become part of His mission.

When we build our lives on Christ, our faith becomes stronger, our hope grows deeper, and our lives show the answer to Jesus’ question. Our response should not be seen only in our words, but also in how we love, forgive, serve and remain faithful.

Christ is the true foundation, and when we stand on Him, life’s storms may shake us, but they cannot destroy the hope He gives.

Prayer

Lord Jesus, you are the Messiah, the Son of the living God. Strengthen our faith to confess You with courage. May nothing overcome the hope we have in You.

Liturgy & Prayer

Readings for Sunday 30th August

1st Reading: Jeremiah 20:7-9

Psalm: 62:2-6, 8-9

2nd Reading: Romans 12:1-2

Gospel: Matthew 16:21-27



Saints of the Coming Week

Monday: St Bartholomew, Apostle

Tuesday: St Joseph Calasanz, priest; St Louis

Thursday: St Monica

Friday: St Augustine, bishop & doctor of the Church

Saturday: The Passion of St John the Baptist, martyr



Faith & Spiritual Life

Embrace the Grace

Legion of Mary Young Adult (18-40) Catholic Conference



Saturday 29th August



9.30 am - 6 pm



De Montfort House, Morning Star Ave, Dublin, D07 VA03

Tickets from Eventbrite. Search **“Embrace the Grace.”**



Please Pray for Vocations

Visit **derryvocations.org**



Sharing the Good News

Visit **theway.ie/ezine-2/** for the weekly ezine.



Lough Derg Day Retreats

August: 29 & 31

September: 5, 6, 9, 12, 15, 19 & 20

Take time away from the busyness of life for a day of guided prayer, quiet reflection and spiritual renewal in the peaceful surroundings of Lough Derg.

Visit **loughderg.org**

St Joseph's Men's Camino 2026

A day of **pilgrimage, prayer, brotherhood and renewal.**

Saturday 12th September

Step away from the demands of everyday life and spend a day walking with Christ alongside other Catholic men.

Inspired by the ancient tradition of pilgrimage, St Joseph Men's Camino is a **25km guided pilgrimage along the beautiful Boyne Valley Camino.**

Open to men aged 18 and over.

Cost: €65 (includes lunch & dinner)

Students: €55

Visit **dominicans.ie**

Contemplative Prayer Group

The Contemplative Prayer Group meets on **Mondays at 8 pm** in the Prayer Room in the Parochial House, Barrack St.

All welcome.

Family & Marriage

Catholic Mothers Ireland Family Day

Sunday 6th September

 Termonbacca Retreat Centre, Derry

 Beginning with the **National Mass at 2 pm**, celebrated by Bishop McKeown.

The Mass will be followed by refreshments, children's activities and a talk for parents. This promises to be a lovely day for the whole family.

For information / to book: info@catholicmothers.ie

All welcome.

Accord Derry Marriage Preparation

Marriage Preparation Course for those getting married in **late 2026 / early 2027.**

Next dates:

- September 25th/26th 2026
- November 20th/21st 2026

Please note that Accord Derry will **NOT** be facilitating courses during October or December 2026.

Register online at **accordni.com**

Marriage Enrichment Weekend

Marriage Encounter invites married couples to a residential weekend:

 **2nd - 4th October**

 Focolare Centre, Prosperous, Kildare

Step away from daily distractions to deepen your communication, renew your love and rediscover the joy of your marriage.

Visit **marriageencounter.ie**

Parish & Community Notices

Buncrana Annual Garden Fete

Today (Sunday), 3 - 6 pm

 Grounds of Scoil Mhuire, Buncrana, F93 PN53

Fun for all the family with Bouncy Castles, Mechanical Bull, Petting Farm, Facepainting, Bingo, Rickety Wheel, Children's Games, Raffle Prizes, etc.

Entry: €5pp / €15 per family (*cash only*)

All welcome.

Coffee Morning in Aid of Foyle Hospice

 **Friday 25th September**

 **9.30 am - 12.30 pm**

 Murphy's on the Green

Prize draw: £1 per line.

All welcome.

Michael English Church Concert

An Evening of Faith, Hope and Inspiration

 **Friday 2nd October**

 **7.15 pm**

 St Patrick's Church, Keenaught, Desertmartin

Tickets: £30

Available at Heron's Gift Shop, Draperstown, Moneyneena PO, Ballinascreen, Desertmartin Parish or through Eventbrite.

Reflections Through Poetry

Reflections Through Poetry by **Fr John P Forbes** is available in the Pastoral Office.

Cost: £10

Proceeds to **Children in Crossfire** and **Cause for Sr Clare's Canonisation**.

Support & Wellbeing

RISE

A vital new community initiative, **RISE** is dedicated to supporting the families, friends and loved ones of those living with addiction.

 **Sunday 13th September**

 **12 noon - 4 pm**

 Everglades Hotel, Derry

The gathering aims to bring together people who may feel isolated, overwhelmed or unaware of the support structures available to them as they navigate a loved one's addiction.

The foundational message of RISE is that **recovery and healing involve the whole family**. The day is designed to serve as a safe, welcoming space where people can share experiences, build meaningful connections and discover where they can turn for help.

To secure your place, send a direct message via Facebook Messenger to the official page.

Family Carers Ireland

Family Carers Ireland are running **1:1 support clinics remotely every Tuesday in August** for carers, offering you a space and time to talk over the phone in the comfort of your own home.

 **086 8363842**

 Donegalcs@familycarers.ie

Alzheimer's Society — Carers' Information Support Programme

The Alzheimer's Society is running a **Carers' Information Support Programme (CRISP)** for family, carers and friends of people living with dementia in the Omagh area.

The programme is run over two sessions and attendees should attend both afternoons.

 **7th & 8th September 2026**

 **3 - 5 pm**

 Conference Room, Silver Birch Hotel, 5 Gortin Road, Omagh

To register, please contact **Julie-Anne, Senior Dementia Adviser**.

 **07889 604702**

Registration is required prior to attendance.

Vacancies

Derry Diocesan Trust — Job Opportunity

Administrative & Financial Officer

 Waterside Parish, Derry

 **18 hrs pw**

 **£12.88 - £13.50 per hour**

For further information:

 recruitment@derrydiocese.org

 **028 71262302**

Closing date: 24/8/26

Personal Assistants Wanted

The Churches Trust is recruiting people for flexible part-time work supporting and befriending elderly people living independently at home.

No experience required – **training and support provided.**

A full clean driving licence and access to a vehicle are required.

 For more information, call **02871 311322.**

Fundraising

Lough Derg Annual Fundraising Draw

Help ensure **Station Island remains open for future generations.**

 **Single ticket: €10**

 **Book of 6: €50**

Buy a full book and you're entered into a **sellers' draw.**

Return a complete book for the **Early Bird Draw on 28/8/26.**

 **Main Draw: 23/10/26**

Tickets from loughderg.org/store/c3/annualdraw

 +353 (0) 71 9861518

 info@loughderg.org

Pilgrimage

Medjugorje Pilgrimage

 **23rd - 30th September**

 **Cost: €775 pps**

A Thought for the Week

“You are the Messiah, the Son of the living God.” — Matthew 16:16

May we recognise Christ, own our faith, commit ourselves to His calling and keep standing firm in Him.

R • O • C • K ?

Parish of Ardstraw East (Newtownstewart)

New Parishioner Form

If you are new to the Parish OR if you have changed your address please complete this form and post it through the Presbytery door

Full Name:			
Address:			
Telephone No:			
Mobile No:			
Email address:			
Number of Children			
Child's Name	Date of Birth	Date Baptised	Current School
Your Special Interests/Expertise? Do you have any particular expertise or interest with which you would be willing to help the Parish? If so, please note them here			
Your Needs? Do you have any needs with which the Parish can help? If so, please note them here			
Notes			
Date Received			
Contacted by Parish			

BALLINASCREEN & DESERTMARTIN PARISHES

23_AUGUST_2026

No. 43 ~ TWENTY-FIRST SUNDAY IN ORDINARY TIME

PARISH CONTACT DETAILS

Fr. Peter Madden PP VF

31 Sixtowns Road

Telephone: 79628376

Email: ballinascreenparish@gmail.com

Fr Michael McCaul CC

50 Tobermore Road, Desertmartin

Telephone: 79632196

Email: desertmartinparish@gmail.com

PARISH OFFICES

Ballinascreen:

9 High Street

Phone: (028)79628248

Email: ballinascreenparish@gmail.com

Opening Hours: Monday, Tuesday and Thursday: 8.45 am - 3.30 pm. Wednesday: 8.45 am - 3.00 pm.

Desertmartin:

St Patrick's Keenaught

Phone: (028)79397047

Email: desertmartinparish@gmail.com

Opening Hours: Wednesday and Thursday 10.30 am to 3.00 pm.

SAFEGUARDING

Safeguarding Contact Information

If you have any concerns with regard to the safeguarding of children within the Church, please contact:

Marie O'Kane - Diocesan Designated Liaison Person (DLP) Tel.: +44 7596 500793 or Email: dlp@derrydiocese.org

Northern Ireland Emergency Services

- PSNI (Police Service of Northern Ireland): 101
- Social Services:
 - Gateway Services, Western HSC Trust: 028 7131 4090 (ask for the Duty Social Worker)
 - Gateway Services, Northern HSC Trust: 028 9442 4459
 - Regional Emergency Social Work Services: 0800 1979 995

LIFELINE

Tel: 0808 808 8000 / Textphone 18001 0808 808 8000.

www.lifelinehelpline.info

SVP HELPLINE

Helpline telephone number: 07710838050

GAMBLING HELPLINE

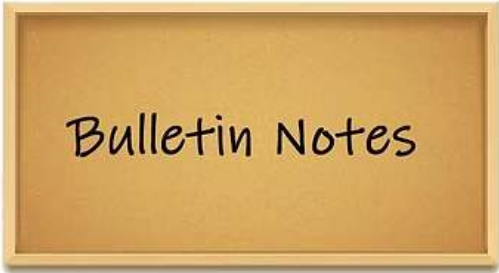
Help is available, phone: 02871351329

SPERRIN FOODBANK

Tel: 07543420639

BALLINASCREEN COMMUNITY SUPPORT GROUP

Please click the link <https://www.parishofballinascreen.com/ballinascreen-community-support-gro> for full details of Ballinascreen Community Support Group.

A rectangular wooden sign with a light brown background and a dark brown border. The words "Bulletin Notes" are written in a black, cursive-style font in the center of the sign.

Bulletin Notes

NOTICES FOR THE BULLETIN

Notices for the Bulletin should be received by 1.00 pm on Wednesday, preferably by email.

Email: ballinascreenparish@gmail.com

Email: desertmartinparish@gmail.com

VIGIL MASSES FOR SUNDAY - SATURDAY 25 JULY

Holy Rosary: 6.00 pm

St Patrick's, Keenaught: 7.30 pm

SUNDAY MASSES - SUNDAY 26 JULY

St Columba's, Straw: 9.00 am

St Mary's, Coolcalm: 10.00 am

St Patrick's, Sixtowns: 11.00 am

St Eugene's, Moneyneena: 12 noon

MASSES FOR THIS WEEK

Monday ~ 24 August

10.00 am ~ Holy Rosary Church.

Tuesday ~ 25 August

10.00 am ~ St. Mary's, Coolcalm. DDS Mass.

Wednesday ~ 26 August

10.00 am ~ Holy Rosary Church.

Thursday ~ 27 August

10.00 am ~ St Mary's, Coolcalm

Friday ~ 28 August

10.00 am ~ St. Mary's, Coolcalm.

7.30 pm ~ Holy Rosary.

CONFESSIONS

Ballinascreen: Holy Rosary 5.30 pm - before Vigil Mass.

Desertmartin: Keenaught, Saturday 6.30 pm until 7.10 pm.

FEASTS OF THE WEEK

Monday 24 August: St Bartholomew, apostle.

Thursday 20 August: St Monica.

Friday 28 August: St Augustine bishop & doctor of the Church.

Saturday 29 August: The Passion of St John the Baptist.

DEATHS

We extend our prayerful sympathy to the family and relatives of:

Sean Lagan, Magherafelt;

Mary Patricia Kealey, Ballymaguigan;

Patsy McPeake Greenlough.

MONTH'S MIND MASS

Month's Mind Mass for Bernadette Regan, St Patrick's Street, on Friday 28 August at 7.30 pm in Holy Rosary Church.

Month's Mind Mass for Joe Joe McGuigan, Moykeeran, on Friday 28 August at 7.30 pm in Holy Rosary Church.

Month's Mind Mass for Joe Burke, Glenelly Villas, on Friday 28 August at 7.30 pm in Holy Rosary Church.

Month's Mind Mass for Francie Donnelly, Ranaghan Road, on Friday 28 August at 7.30 pm in Holy Rosary Church.

Month's Mind Mass for Madge Cullinan, Moykeeran on Friday 28 August at 7.30 pm in Holy Rosary Church.

ANNIVERSARIES

Ballinascreen:

First Anniversary:

Georgina McGlone, Glenelly Villas.

Anniversaries:

Joseph Duffy, Cavanreagh Road;

John Convery Gortnari;

Brendan McPeake, Cahore Terrace;

Mary McCullagh, Bancran Road;

Cathal McWilliams, Fivemilestraight;

Rosaleen Murray Dunlogan Road;

Mary Henry, Cahore Terrace and Ballinascreen Fold.

Desertmartin:

First Anniversary:

Johnny Donnelly, Magherafelt & Brackalislea.

Anniversaries:

Brendan McElhennon;

Bernard Donnelly;

Paddy Henry;

Bridget Henry;

Matilda Donnelly;

John Donnelly;

Mickey Donnelly;

Kathleen Donnelly;

Rose Donnelly;

Emily Murray.

BAPTISMS

We welcome into God's family through the Sacrament of Baptism:

Natalia Aoife McGuigan, Astudillo, Valencia;

Eadaoin McKeown, Cloane Lane;

Ceadach Francis Glass, Drumard Road.

WEDDING

Congratulations and best wishes for the future to:

Mary-Louise McBride and Conor McWilliams who were married recently in St. Patrick's Church, Sixtowns.

PARISH COLLECTIONS

Ballinascreen:

Weekly Collection - £1849

Renovation Collection - £2196

Desertmartin:

Weekly Collection - £1,175

Renovation Collection - £25

Thank you for your generous support which is greatly appreciated.

SUMMER BONANZA DRAW WINNERS ~ WEEK 1 & WEEK 2

Week 1

£1000 ~ Clinona and Charlie Conway,

£200 ~ Shane Toner, Cahore Road,

£100 ~ Niamh McCullagh, Coolnasillagh Road.

Week 2

£1000 ~ Katie, Rose, Michael and Jack Millar, Drumard Lane,

£200 ~ Jack and Noah Higgins, Moneyneena Road,

£100 ~ Natasha McEldowney, Mulnavoo Road.

You may still purchase a ticket to be entered in the draw for the two remaining weeks!

Week 4 (29 August): 1st Prize ~ £1000, 2nd Prize ~ £200, 3rd Prize ~ £100.

Week 5 (5 September): 1st Prize ~ £2000, 2nd Prize ~ £500, 3rd Prize ~ £300.

ST PIO KNOCK PILGRIMAGE

National Knock Pilgrimage in honour of St Pio of Pietrelcina on Sunday September 20. Coach will leave from Holy Rosary Church at 7.00 am, pickup at St Mary's Coolcam (7.10 am) returning at 10.00 pm approx. Fare £35 (includes breakfast) payable on booking. All welcome. To book please contact: 07836366949 or 07732125316 or 07769720546.

OUTDOOR SERVICE AT ST ANNE'S CHURCH SIXTOWNS

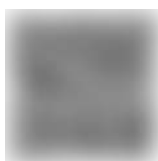
Today, Sunday 23 August at 4.00 pm, conducted by Rural Dean, Rev Gary Millar. The church has been closed since December 2023 and is still awaiting repairs. All are very welcome to this outdoor service.

MICHAEL ENGLISH CONCERT ~ SPONSORSHIP

Any business or company who would like to be one of the sponsors for the Michael English Fundraising Concert should please contact Fr Madden: Tel.: 028 79628376 or Email either Parish [Office \[desertmartinparish@gmail.com\]\(mailto:desertmartinparish@gmail.com\)](mailto:desertmartinparish@gmail.com) or ballinascreenparish@gmail.com. All sponsorship will be gratefully received and acknowledged.

MICHAEL ENGLISH & BAND LIVE CONCERT

Enjoy a rare and intimate evening with Michael English, one of Ireland's most popular entertainers. This exclusive acoustic performance of uplifting music filled with hope, faith and community spirit takes place on Friday 2 October, at 8.00 pm in St. Patrick's Church, Keenaught. All proceeds from this special fundraising concert will go to towards the Parish of Desertmartin, Church Renovation Fund. Tickets £30 each are now available to buy from Heron's Gift Shop, Moneyneena Post Office, both Parish Offices, or online (**Click Here**) with Eventbrite or use this QR code:



KNOCKNAGIN HALL

Chair Exercises: Tuesdays 10.00 am to 11.00 am. A fun and exciting way to get exercise and improve your wellbeing, all welcome. Adm £4.

Irish Dancing Lessons: Tuesday 5.30 pm to 7.00 pm to register, please contact Nicola 07518 207458.

Line Dancing Classes: Wednesdays from 7.30 pm, suitable for all ages from beginners to experts. A fun way to get exercise, improve your mental health and develop your dancing skills! Adm £5. All welcome.

OUT & ABOUT COMMUNITY TRANSPORT

This registered charity has been providing an accessible rural transport service in the old Magherafelt District Council Area since 1999. This organisation continues to provide affordable and safe transport for the community. All their buses are fully accessible for a range of mobility needs. Transport is provided to a range of services including medical appointments, visiting family, essential shopping, social outings, community events and training and employment. If you or anyone you know would benefit from this very worthwhile service, please phone 028 79300123 or visit www.outandaboutct.org

SIXTOWNS DANCE

Monthly Social Dance in Sixtowns Cross Community Centre on Friday 28 August at 9.30 pm. Music by Kieran McAree. Everyone welcome.

CORMAC Ó CEALLAIGH CCÉ MUSIC CLASSES.

Were you at the best Fleadh Cheoil ever in Belfast? Were you wishing that you or your children were able to play or sing like all those musicians at the Fleadh? Maybe you played as a child and are now inspired to pick up your instrument again? There is an answer to all these questions!

Classes in fiddle, tin whistle, concertina, harp, banjo/mandolin, guitar, traditional singing and bodhran start at end of September.

There will also be an adult only mixed instrument class, for all lapsed players, who want to start playing again.

Two new classes will also be offered: drumming (for beginners) and Seisiún tunes repertoire (for the more advanced musicians).

Please register early to avoid disappointment as classes are kept small. Preference will be given to current members.

Registration closes on 5 September to allow time to organise tutors. Further details and the Klubfunder link to register for classes are on Cormac Ó Ceallaigh CCÉ Facebook page.

BUNCRANA GARDEN FETE 2026

Today Sunday, 23 August from 3.00 pm to 6.00 pm at Scoil Mhuire, Buncrana F93 PN53. Fun for all the family. All welcome.

BALLINASCREEN GAC

Irish Language and Culture Night at 7.00 pm on Friday 18 September. More details to follow on Ballinascreen GAC social media pages.

Ballinascreen GAC hope to enter teams in the Junior Scór Dhoire in October. Contact John on 07471374398 to register or for any queries.

KILCRONAGHAN CENTRE

Vintage Rally, Craft Fair and Family Fun Day, on Saturday 26 September from 11.00 am to 3.00 pm. For more details, please see Kilcronaghan Facebook page or ring 028 79627826.

CATHOLIC MOTHERS IRELAND – FAMILY DAY

Annual National Mass on Sunday 6 September at Termonbacca Retreat Centre, Derry. Mass at 2.00 pm, celebrated by Bishop McKeown, followed by refreshments, children's activities, and a talk for parents.

This promises to be a lovely day for the whole family. For more details and to book please email info@catholicmothers.ie. All welcome.

BLESSING OF BIKERS AND MOTORCYCLES

Sunday 13 September in St Aengus' Chapel, Burt, at 1.30 pm. All welcome to attend the brief service and blessing, after which all are welcome to join the run to Ned's Point RNLI Station, to present the donation to the RNLI.

Please note, Mass will be celebrated on Sunday 13 September at 11.30 am in **St Patrick's Church, Dungiven**, for deceased bikers, especially those who have died in the past year.

LEGION OF MARY ~ CONFERENCE FOR YOUNG ADULTS

Conference on faith and culture for young adults (18-40) with talks, prayer, Mass, confession, workshops, food and social in Legion of Mary Headquarters De Montfort House, North Brunswick Street, Dublin 7, on Saturday 29 August, 9.30 am to 6.00 pm, social after. Tickets €20 can be booked online at Eventbrite under '*Embrace the Grace*'. Any queries can be emailed to deusetpatria@gmail.com

ST JOSEPH MEN'S CAMINO

Every Camino changes us in ways we don't expect, every man needs one.

25km pilgrimage through the Boyne Valley, beginning in Drogheda on Saturday 12 September. The day includes Mass, Adoration, Rosary, Confessions, fraternity, lunch and dinner. Open to men aged 18+. Cost: €65 /student €55. Registration and more details please visit

www.dominicans.ie/events or email op.evangelisation@gmail.com

FREE ONLINE STRESS CONTROL CLASSES

Next block of classes commence at 9.00 am on Monday 7 September at <https://ni.stresscontrol.org/>. Any questions or queries, please email stress.control@northerntrust.hscni.net

PARISH BAPTISMS 2026

Ballinascreen Parish:

All bookings to be made via Ballinascreen Parish Office on 02879628248 or Email: ballinascreenparish@gmail.com

Baptisms will be held at 3.00 pm on the following dates:

23 August, Moneyneena.

30 August, Holy Rosary.

Saturday 5 September, Sixtowns.

13 September, Straw.

4 October, Holy Rosary.

Saturday 17 October, Sixtowns.

1 November, Straw.

Desertmartin Parish:

To book a baptism, contact Fr McCaul on 02879632196 or Desertmartin Parish Office on 02879397047. Baptisms can be held in either church and are held at 1.30 pm on the following dates:

September 6 & 27 2026

October 4 & 18 2026

November 8 & 22 2026

December 6 & 20 2026

January 10 & 24 2027

February 7 & 21 2027

March 7 & 14 2027

DERRY DIOCESAN SOCIETY

If you wish to enrol someone in the society, please contact the parish office. The fee for a living or deceased member is £20.

NOTICES FOR THE BULLETIN

Notices should be received by **1.00 pm on Wednesday**, preferably emailed to ballinascreenparish@gmail.com

PARISH ANNIVERSARY MASS & MONTH'S MIND MASSES

If you wish to have a deceased loved one prayed for at any Anniversary Friday Mass, please email their name to the Parish Office by **1.00 pm on Wednesday** of the relevant week. Notices for First Anniversary and Month's Mind Masses should be received before **1.00 pm on Wednesday of the previous week** so that, they may be printed in the Bulletin the weekend before the Anniversary Mass.

PRAYER FOR VOCATIONS

In this Sunday's gospel Peter acknowledges Jesus as the Christ, the Son of the living God, and Jesus confers on Peter ‘..the keys of the Kingdom..’ an image reflected in the First Reading where the Lord says He will ‘..place the key of David..’ on the shoulder of those called to lead His people, those who will be called ‘father’.

PARISH OF BANAGHER

13th Sunday in Ordinary Time 28th June 2026

Mass Times

Weekly Mass Times:

Monday: St. Joseph's Church, Fincairn: 9.30am
 Tuesday: St. Mary's Church, Altinure: 10.00am
 Wednesday: St. Peter's & St. Paul's Church, Foreglen: 7.00pm
 Thursday: St. Mary's Church, Altinure: 10.00am
 Friday: St. Joseph's Church, Fincairn: 9.30am

Weekend Mass Times for Sunday 5th July 2026

St. Joseph's Church, Fincairn: 7.00pm Vigil
 St. Mary's Church, Altinure: 10.30am
 St. Peter's & St. Paul's Church, Foreglen: 12.00pm Noon

Confessions

St. Mary's Church, Altinure: Thursday 10.30am
 St. Joseph's Church, Fincairn: Friday 10.00am
 St. Joseph's Church, Fincairn: Saturday 6.30pm

Adoration of the Blessed Sacrament and Divine Mercy Chaplet

St. Mary's Church, Altinure: Thursday 10.30am – 11.30am.
 St. Joseph's Church, Fincairn: Friday 10.00am – 11.00am.

Rest in Peace: We offer our sincerest sympathies to the family and friends of Gerard Moore, RIP, Belfast, (formerly of Rallagh Road) who was buried during the week.

A First Anniversary Mass will be celebrated for the happy repose of the souls of Gerard Lockhart RIP and Liam McCormick RIP, at St. Joseph's Church, Fincairn on Saturday 4th July at 7.00pm.

OFFERTORY COLLECTION

20th & 21st June 2026

St. Joseph's Church, Fincairn: £605 St. Mary's Church, Altinure: £565
 St. Peter's & St. Paul's Church, Foreglen: £455

Please consider online contributions and Gift Aid. Online Contributions to:
Parish of Banagher Sort Code: 950306 A/c 51052659
Thank you for your continued generosity.

July	St Joseph's Church, Fincairn		St Mary's Church, Altinure
	7.00pm	9.15am	10.30am
Readers	Elain Loughery	Liam Campbell	Betty McAteer
Eucharistic Ministers	Patsy McDermott	Breige O'Neill	Alfie Dallas
Flowers	Joey McDermott, Sheila Brolly		Teresa Devine
Cleaning	Bernie Lynch, Kathleen Lynch & Carol Anne McGinty		Donna O'Kane, Catherine Loughery, Rosie Dallas
Counters	Liam & Siobhan Campbell, Pat McCullagh, Bernie McCullagh, Vincent McCloskey, Geraldine McCloskey		Christine McGaughey, Celine McGaughey,
Collectors	Marty McGrellis, Vincent McCloskey	Paul McDermott, Jackie Hasson	Stephen Gormley, Tony Gormley, Shaun McElhinney Shane McElhinney

Banagher Parish Hope Camp 2026 (6th – 10th July): We wish the children of the parish who are participating in the Hope Camp this year all the best for their week of fun and faith activities. Please God the weather stays this good!

Our Lady of Lourdes Pilgrimage Society: 7 Night Annual Pilgrimage to Lourdes, 8th to 15th July, from Belfast International Airport staying at Hotel Agena - £949 based on 2 people sharing. Contact Kathleen McCann on 028 7963 2205 or 077 1970 1925.

Fr. Mike Schmitz Parables Tour for Young People on 20th July in Dublin: Derry Youth Ministry is inviting young people aged 16+ to join them for the Fr. Mike Schmitz Parables Tour taking place on 20th July 2026 in the National Stadium Dublin. Fr. Mike is an American priest and digital evangelist, who will present the message of the Gospel in a novel, energetic and engaging style that speaks into young people's lives today. There will be a special Mass for youth attending from all over Ireland to begin the evening celebrations. Cost is £45 for ticket and transport. Bus departs Derry at 12noon, with pick-ups in Strabane and Omagh. To secure your place or for more information, contact bethany.doherty@derrydiocese.org or call 028 7126 4087.

ATU St. Angela's is inviting applications for the following programme beginning Autumn 2026: Part-Time Certificate in Religious Education for Primary School, with Online Delivery. The programme is open to: Qualified primary school teachers; Qualified post-primary school teachers who wish to transfer to primary school teaching. Parents, sacramental preparation teams and parish catechists who have a specific interest in the area of primary religious education may also apply. Closing date for Applications is Friday 14th August. For further information, contact Mary Kearns, Senior Administrator, Education Department, ATU St. Angela's, Lough Gill, Sligo. Email: mary.kearns@atu.ie or visit Website: www.atu.ie.

Diocese of Derry Lough Derg Pilgrimage 2026: The Diocese of Derry Three-Day Pilgrimage to Lough Derg will take place from Friday 24th July to Sunday 26th July 2026. Lough Derg continues to welcome people seeking prayer, peace, reflection and renewal in the midst of busy lives. A bus will travel from St. Eugene's Cathedral, via Strabane and Lifford. Cost: £95 / €110 including bus transport. You are welcome, of course, to use your own means of transport. Full details available at: derrydiocese/lough-derg.

Accord Derry Marriage Preparation Workshops for September and November 2026 - September 25th/26th and November 20th/21st. These courses are in person and are now available for booking online at www.accordni.com. Please note that Accord Derry will NOT be facilitating courses during October or December 2026.

Feast Days

Monday 29th June: St. Peter and St. Paul were important apostles of Jesus Christ, with distinct backgrounds and roles. St. Peter, an ordinary man, one of the original twelve disciples, was chosen by Jesus and considered the 'rock' upon which the Church was to be built. St. Peter was martyred in Rome, likely during Nero's persecution. St. Paul, initially a persecutor of Christians, underwent a dramatic conversion and became 'Apostle to the Gentiles', a zealous missionary spreading Christianity and a prolific writer whose scripts and letters are foundational to Christian theology. St. Paul was martyred in Rome, likely around the same time as St. Peter. Their joint feast signifies their remarkable commitment to spreading the Gospel; their grace and courage to bear witness and the wisdom to shape the early Church.

Tuesday 30th June: The First Martyrs of the See of Rome

When the city of Rome had been devastated by fire in the year 64, the Emperor Nero launched a persecution against the Christians, who were thrown to the wild beasts in the arena or soaked in tar and used as living torches. Their deaths are documented in the writings of the Roman historian Tacitus and in Pope St. Clement's letter to the Corinthians. Their feast was celebrated the day after the feast of Saints Peter and Paul.

COMMUNITY NEWS

SAVE THE DATE: The SVP outing will be on Thursday 20th August to Doagh Famine Village, Ballyliffin, Co. Donegal. More details regarding pick up times, places and itinerary will follow closer to the time. A contribution of £20 p.p. will be much appreciated. Please make contact with a conference member if you are interested in joining us for the outing on that day ...We would look forward to having you... Thank you for your continued support. SVP Banagher.

St. Mary's GAC, Banagher: Lotto numbers for 23.06.26 were 6, 19, 24 & 26. Winning £10 each were Bridget Kealey, Breidge Doherty, Richard McGrisken, Marie O'Neill, Kateri Lynch, Raicheal O'Kane, Karen Milligan x 2, Danielle McGlynn, and Ramon McLaughlin. Next week's jackpot is £9,200.

Glenshane House: Floral Candle Holder Workshop facilitated by Pauline on Tuesday 30th June 11.00am – 1.00pm and 7.00pm – 9.00pm. Fee including all materials only £5. To book either workshop, tel. 028 7774 2494.

Learmount Community Development Group: Monday 29th June: Time for Me Ladies - Bus leaving at 10.15am from outside the Community Centre for summer outing; Dementia Social Group (10.30 am - 12.30pm); Ladies Yoga: (7 - 7.45 pm); Men's Yoga (8 - 8.45 pm), Painting Class (7.30 - 9.30 pm); **Tuesday 30th June:** Craft & Crochet Club (10.30 am - 12.30 pm), Men's Hobby Work Shed (10.30 am - 12.30 pm), Advice NW (2 - 4 pm), **Thursday 2nd July:** Post Office (9 am - 12 pm), Painting for Pleasure: (10.30 am - 12.30 pm), Funky Feet kids dance class: (4.30 pm - 5.30 pm); **Friday 3rd July:** Learmount Walking Group (10.30 am).

For further information on groups, classes, events or workshops, contact Karen on 028 7778 1881 / 077 5111 8656 / DM / email: admin@learmountgroup.

Privacy Notice: The Diocese of Derry complies with GDPR regulations. A privacy notice is available on the Parish Website or by contacting the Parish Office. Live stream and recordings of Mass and Services in St. Joseph's Church, Fincairn, St. Mary's Church, Altinure and St. Peter's & St. Paul's Church, Foreglen are available online. Please note that the first three rows of seats are visible online in St. Joseph's Church, Fincairn and St. Peter's & St. Paul's Church, Foreglen, and the first six rows of seats in St. Mary's Church, Altinure.

The Parish Webcams are now available to view on the Firestick. If you search for the iTech Media App and download it to your Firestick, you can then search for the Church.

- There will be **NO Sunday Bulletins** during the months of **July and August** •

PARISH CLERGY

Fr. Dermot McGirr, P.P.

42 Glenedra Road, Feeny, BT47 4TW

Tel: 028 7778 1223 Email: banagherparish@derrydiocese.org

CONTACT US

To arrange a Baptism, Wedding or Anniversary Mass, please call Fr. Dermot or the secretaries on 028 7778 1223 or email banagherparish@derrydiocese.org.

Please note: Parish Office opening hours will be subject to change over the summer holidays to accommodate annual leave.

Mass is Live on the Webcam at www.banagherparish.com

SVP Confidential Helpline: 075 9395 4973

Bellaghy Parish Office: info@bellaghyparish.com 02879386259/ 07703444280

Office hours: Mon, Wed & Thurs 9am—3pm, Fri 8am—11am.

Office closed Tuesday. Website: www.bellaghyparish.com

St Vincent de Paul 07508549588

Greenlough Parish Office: greenloughparish@gmail.com

Tel: 02825821190 Website: www.greenlough.com

Marriage Enrichment Weekend: Marriage Encounter Ireland invites married couples to a residential Weekend from Fri 2 to Sun 4 Oct 2026 at the Focolare Centre, Curryhills, Prosperous, Co. Kildare. Visit www.marriageencounter.ie

Poor Clares Galway, Half-Day Retreat for women 18-40 with Women's spirituality speaker Louise Mc Guinness. An opportunity to encounter God's love and deepen your life of prayer and communion with God. The event will take place from **2pm to 6pm on Sun 6 Sep**. For information and to register: <https://cherisheddaughters.eventbrite.ie>

Blessing of Bikers and Motorcycles will take place on Sun 13 Sep in St Aengus' Chapel, Burt, Co Donegal, at 1:30. All are welcome to attend the brief service and blessing. Please note, Mass will be celebrated on Sun 13 Sep in St Patrick's Chapel, Dungiven at 11:30am for deceased bikers, especially those who have died in past year.

Catholic Mothers Ireland – Family Day: Catholic Mothers Ireland will hold its Annual National Mass on **Sunday, 6 September** at **Termonbacca Retreat Centre, Derry**. The day will begin with **Mass at 2.00pm**, celebrated by **Bishop Donal McKeown**, followed by refreshments, children's activities, and a talk for parents. This promises to be a lovely day for the whole family. For more information and booking details, please email info@catholicmothers.ie. All are welcome.

Legion Of Mary: Wednesday at 6.15pm in the Prayer Room of St Mary's Church. All are welcome.



The Legion of Mary are organising a Day Trip to knock on Sunday 27 September. Anyone interested please get in touch with Kathleen Madine Tel:07733431538 or email: kmadine@hotmail.com

St Mary's, Bellaghy/St Joseph's, Ballyscullion. 23 August 2026 Twenty-First Sunday in Ordinary Time.

St. Mary's, Bellaghy:

Mon 24 & Wed 26, 9.30am

Fri 28, 7pm

Adoration, Friday, 10am—7pm (Rosary, 6.30pm)

Sat, 5.30pm (Streamed from Greenlough)

Sun, 11am (Streamed to Greenlough)



St. Oliver Plunkett, Clady:

Tues 25, No Mass

Fri 28, 9.30am

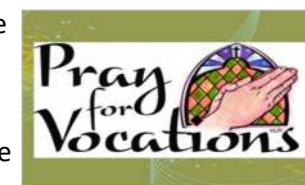
Adoration, Thursday, 9am—5pm.

Sat, Vigil, 5.30pm (Streamed to Bellaghy)

Sun, 11am (Streamed from Bellaghy)

St. Joseph's, Ballyscullion: Sun, 9.45am.

In this Sunday's gospel Peter acknowledges Jesus as the Christ, the Son of the living God, and Jesus confers on Peter "...the keys of the Kingdom..." an image reflected in the First Reading where the Lord says He will "...place the key of David..." on the shoulder of those called to lead His people, those who will be called "father."



The Parish Office will be closed from Monday 24 August and will reopen Thursday 3 September.

Deaths: We offer our sympathy to the family of **Patsy McPeake** (Mullaghnemoyagh Road), **Manus McShane** (Ballyscullion Lane) and **Gregory McErlain** (Philadelphia formerly Loughbeg Road) who died recently.

Anniversaries:

Sat/Sun 22/23: Rosaleen Cudden (Anniversary Mass at 11am), Maureen Friel (Anniversary Mass at 11am), Sean Diamond (Anniversary Mass Fri 28 Aug at 7pm), James Diamond, PJ Mulholland, Frank Ferran, Hugh Devlin, Maureen Friel, Susan O'Neill, Annie Shivers, Tommy Scullion, Sadie Blaney, Colm McCartney, Sean Farmer, Lawrence Mulholland, Mary Ann O'Neill, Jim McLarnon, Jim Shivers, Tom Mawhinney, Jeannie O'Neill, Don McCann, Martin McCann.

Sat/Sun 29/30: Sinead & Clodagh Rose Milne (Anniversary Mass at 11am), Tommy McCann, Annie Diamond, Mary Woulahan.

May they rest in peace.

Last week's Collection: £1,420.00 **Thank you.**



Recent Baptisms:

We welcome into God's family through Baptism:

Orla McQuillan, Poets Walk.

Ellen-Rose Josephine McGouran, The Meadows.

Esme Olivia Moore, William Street.

Rosie Ellen O'Neill, Bawnmore.

Daire Michael McFall, Ballydermot Road.

Annie Teresa McErlean, Riverdale Pk, Portglenone.

Róise Willis, William Street.

Croía Sadie Mary O'Neill, Abbey Grange, Portglenone.

Shay O'Kane, Glencombe Wood, Portglenone.

Rory Cian Feeney, Bawnmore.

Oisín Roddy Kearney, Killyberry Road.



September Schedules:

St Mary's:

Readers: 11.00am: Madeline Scullion

Weekdays: Mon: M Scullion Wed: A Scott

Church Cleaners: Maria McMullan & Tracy McErlean

Stewards: 11am: Bernard McKenna & Patrick McKenna.

Altar Society: Marie Glancy.

Volunteers Needed.

Would you be willing to help with cleaning the Church?

Please contact Sally-Ann or Fr Pat 02879386259.

St Joseph's:

Eucharistic Minister: Dolores McErlean

Reader: Neil Duffin **Collector:** Danny Duffin

Altar Society: Barbara Carey

**Church Island Sunday will take place
this year on
Sunday 30 August at 2pm.**



BAPTISM DATES: JULY—DECEMBER

BELLAGHY

Sep 26, 1pm

Oct 10, 1pm

Nov 7, 1pm

Dec 5, 1pm

GREENLOUGH

Aug 22 4.15pm

Sep 13, 12.30pm

Oct 24, 4.15pm

Nov 28, 4.15pm

Dec 19, 4.15pm

Buncrana Parish Newsletter

ST. MARY'S HALL & CINEMA

Last week’s collection totalled €5,475. The collection on 15th August totalled €1,400. We gratefully acknowledge a donation from Pancake Headquarters of €2649.87 raised for St Mary’s Hall, and three donations of €150, €200 and €300 towards the Garden Fete. <i>Sincere thanks.</i> Anniversary Masses & Times ST MARY’S ORATORY Masses streamed on churchservices.tv/buncrana Monday 24 Aug - Mass at 10am Special Intention Tuesday 25 Aug - Mass at 10am Miriam O’Brien, Charles Hegarty, plus Evelyn Fletcher (30th A) Wednesday 26 Aug - Mass at 10am Mary Bradley, plus Bridie Doherty Thursday 27 Aug - Mass at 10am Colm Hegarty Saturday 29 Aug - Mass at 4:30pm Sunday 30 Aug - Mass at 8:30am Sunday 30 Aug - Mass at 12:30pm Brigid Duffy (1st A) ST. MARY’S, COCKHILL Masses streamed on churchservices.tv/cockhill Friday 28 Aug - Mass at 7pm Special Intention Sunday 30 Aug - Mass at 11am Kathleen Bradley (8th A), plus Owen Kavanagh (1st A) STAR OF THE SEA, DESERTEGNEY Masses streamed on www.youtube.com/@BuncranaParish Sunday 30 Aug - Mass at 9:45am DEATHS Your prayers are asked for James Love Danny Bradley who were died recently and for their families & friends saddened by their loss. SVP PILGRIMAGE TO KNOCK The Vincentian Pilgrimage to Knock will take place on Sat 12 Sept 2026. The cost per person is €55. This includes travel by bus, breakfast and dinner in The Central Hotel, Donegal Town. If you would like to book a seat, please contact Fiona on 0863517177 by 25 August. LEGION OF MARY Pilgrimage to Knock on Sunday 27 September leaving from Buncrana. More details to follow. PRAYER FOR VOCATIONS In this Sunday's gospel Peter acknowledges Jesus as the Christ, the Son of the living God, and Jesus confers on Peter "...the keys of the Kingdom..." an image reflected in the First Reading where the Lord says He will "...place the key of David..." on the shoulder of those called to lead His people, those who will be called "father." PRIVACY NOTICE: The Diocese of Derry complies with GDPR regulations. A Privacy Notice is available on the Parish Website or by contacting The Parish Office. Live stream and recordings of Mass and Services in St Mary’s Oratory and St Mary’s Cockhill are available online. Parishioners should note that the first two rows of seats are visible online in St Mary’s Oratory and the first seven rows of seats are visible in St Mary’s Cockhill.	Priest on Call 074 9361253 Email: buncranaparish@gmail.com Website: www.buncranaparish.com Twenty-First Sunday in Ordinary Time 23 August 2026 GARDEN FETE 2026 The Annual Garden Fete will take place today (Sunday) from 3pm-6pm in the grounds of Scoil Mhuire. This is a great family day out before the new terms starts. There are Bouncy Castles, Face-painting, Children’s Races, Mechanical Bull, Human Whack-a-Mole, Tractor and Digger challenges, Bingo, Rickety Wheel and more. Blue Badge holders must use St Oran’s Road Entrance. Cash only on the day - no card facilities available. DRAW CARDS Any promoter who has outstanding cards/money is asked to bring them to the Fete on Sunday. CALLING OUT TO ALL BAKERS Bakers required to provided goods for the tea/coffee. Please leave any goods in the Convent kitchen anytime from 11am onwards on the day. READINGS FOR 21ST SUNDAY IN ORDINARY TIME First Reading: Is 22: 19-23. Shebna, master of the royal palace, having climbed to become master of King Hezekiah’s palace had become proud and self-important. In the interest of good governance, he is replaced by Eliakim. The metaphor of ‘the key of the House of David on his shoulder’ is borrowed from an ancient Egyptian custom. (What may be Shebna’s actual, elaborate tomb was recently discovered at Siloam cemetery in Jerusalem.) Second Reading: Rom. 11:33-36. At the end of three chapters setting out how pagans and Jews have been part of God’s plan of salvation, Paul composes this triumphant hymn to the wisdom of God. As Creator He has an overview of all time and place. Who could ever teach him? Who could ever be his counsellor? Gospel: Mt. 16:13-20. By a special divine grace Peter declares timelessly that Jesus is “the Messiah and Son of the living God." Jesus now gives him a hitherto unknown personal name - ‘petros’ - meaning ‘rock’. The new name emphasises his new role as the strengthener of his brothers’ faith and foundation of unity for his church. This is also a watershed moment. From this time on, Jesus began to speak of his coming passion. ONE DAY PILGRIMAGE TO LOUGH DERG The Parish is running a one-day pilgrimage to Lough Derg on Saturday 5 September. Bus leaving The Oratory at 7:30am for arrival at the island at 9:30am. Cost for the day including return bus, boat fare, day pilgrimage and meal on way home is €85. For more info and booking please contact the Parish Office. Spaces on a first-come first-served basis. CLIMB TO THE EUCHARISTIC CROSS, SCALP on Sun 30 Aug meeting at the Water Tank at 1.30pm. The Rosary will be said on the way up. All Welcome. MARRIAGE ENRICHMENT WEEKEND Marriage Encounter Ireland invites married couples to a residential Weekend from Fri 2 to Sun 4 Oct 2026 at the Focolare Centre, Curryhills, Prosperous, Co. Kil-dare. Step away from daily distractions to deepen your communication, renew your love, and rediscover the joy of your marriage. Visit www.marriageencounter.ie	Fr Bradley 9363455 Fr Walsh 9361393 Fr Baker 9360151 Parish Office 9361253 Parish Catechist 086 785 3726 ADORATION CHAPEL Please consider spending an hour in the Adoration Chapel Sunday 2pm - 10pm Monday - Wednesday 6am - 10pm Friday 6am - 10pm GUIDED HOLY HOUR The Holy Hour in honour of the Holy Face of Jesus continues this Sunday at 6pm in St Mary’s Oratory. All Welcome. ROSARY The Rosary is said in the Oratory at 9.30am before Mass Monday to Thursday. DONEGAL DOWN SYNDROME ASSOCIATION Annual church-gate collection will take place on the weekend of 29 /30 Aug. Any-one interested in helping on the day can contact the Donegal Down Syndrome Association office by calling 0857870075 or email info@donegal.downsyndrome.ie ST JOSEPH MEN'S CAMINO Every Camino changes us in ways we don't expect, every man needs one. Join men from across Ireland on Sat 12th Sept for a 25km pilgrimage through the Boyne Valley, beginning in Drogheda. The day includes Mass, Adoration, Rosary, Confessions, fraternity, lunch and dinner, with after-dinner speaker Fr. Mark Quinn. Open to men aged 18+. Cost: €65 (student € 55). Registration, accommodation and details: www.dominicans.ie/events Enquiries: op.evangelisation@gmail.com. BLESSING OF BIKERS AND MOTORCYCLES takes place on Sun 13 Sept in St Aengus’ Chapel, Burt at 1:30pm. All welcome to attend the brief service and blessing. Following the blessing all are welcome to join the run to Ned’s Point RNLI Station, to present the donation to the RNLI. Please note, Mass will be celebrated on Sun 13 Sept in St Patrick’s Chapel, DUNGIVEN, at 11:30am for deceased bikers, especially those who have died in past year. ACKNOWLEDGEMENT Maeve McGinley, Mary McCarron, Bill McLaughlin wish to thank everyone who helped make the fundraiser event “Tea On The Terrace” such a success. An incredible amount of €5,450.45 was raised in aid of the Irish Lung Fibrosis Association and in memory of ‘ Big John’. Thank you to all those who volunteered, made tea, provided food & plants, sponsored prizes, attended and donated so generously.	PARISH DRAW Friday 14 August: Week 9 1st Prize: €500 Vincent Deehan, Lisowen Ave Promoter: Marie Deehan 2nd Prize: €300 Kathleen Porter, Rockytown Promoter: Kathleen Porter 3rd Prize: €150 Tessie Doherty, Kinnego Promoter: Tessie Doherty EMBRACE THE GRACE YOUNG ADULT CATHOLIC CONFERENCE 29 Aug 2026 - Legion of Mary: 'Embrace the Grace' is a conference on faith and culture for young adults (18-40) with talks, prayer, Mass, confession, workshops, food and social in the historic Legion of Mary headquarters at De Montfort House, North Brunswick Street, Dublin 7 from 9.30am to 6pm with a social after. Tickets €20 and can be booked on the eventbrite website by looking up 'Embrace the Grace'. Any queries email deusetpatria@gmail.com. MICHAEL ENGLISH CHURCH CON-CERT An evening of Faith, Hope and Inspiration. The concert takes place on Fri 2 Oct at 7.15pm, in St Patrick's Church, Keenaught, Desertmartin. Tickets are €30, and available to buy at Herons Gift Shop, Draperstown, Moneyneena Post Office, Ballinascreen and Desertmartin Parish offices, or online with Eventbrite: https://www.eventbrite.co.uk/e/michael-english-band-fundraising-concert-tickets-1996641829460 CATHOLIC MOTHERS IRELAND – FAMILY DAY Catholic Mothers Ireland will hold its Annual National Mass on Sun 6 Sept at Termonbacca Retreat Centre, Derry. The day will begin with Mass at 2pm, celebrated by Bishop Donal McKeown, followed by refreshments, children's activities, and a talk for parents. This promises to be a lovely day for the whole family. For info and booking, please email info@catholicmothers.ie. All welcome. COFFEE MORNING for the Niall Mellon Township Trust on Sat 5th Sept 10am to 2pm in The Fowler Hall Tooban. All proceeds will help raise funds to support Paul Bradley, Gerard Curran, Kieran Toner and Oisin Bradley to travel to South Africa with the Niall Mellon Township Trust to help build a school for impoverished children. Everyone welcome. BRIDGE CLASSES starting Wed 23 Sept in Buncrana Youth Club. For details contact John 0870562188 or Mary 0860608588 LIFELINE INISHOWEN Domestic Violence Support Services have free counselling sessions available for Women & Children. We also offer support, drop-in and outreach services. Contact us on our HELPLINE 074 9373232 or 086 0065035330 between 10am - 1.30pm RACHEL’S VINEYARD Have you been affected or hurt by abortion? Please contact Michelle on 00447871765181	BUNCRANA CINEMA See all show times www.thecinemabuncrana.com The End Of Oak Street 15A 100Mins Sat 22 & Sun 23Aug - 8.15pm Mon 24 - Thurs 27 - 8.15pm Paw Patrol: Dino Movie G 88mins Sat 22 Aug - 5pm Sun 23rd - 3pm COMING NEXT WEEK Harry Potter And The Philosopher's Stone 25th Anniversary 28 - 30 Aug COMING SOON Movies & Tea Holy Days - Tues 1st Sept. Adm €10 incl Afternoon Tea. Carers go free. BINGO St Mary’s Hall Fridays at 8pm Single book €11 Double €17 Snowball: €5000	Community Corner SLIABH SNEACHT CENTRE Drumfries Walking Group will be meeting on Fri 28 Aug at the Famine Village carpark, at 10am everyone welcome. Weekly drop in Craft Class starts back on Wed 9 Sept. (Sewing / Embroidery/ Knitting) no tutor, just a group of like minded people supporting each other while enjoying a cup of tea and a chat, bring your own materials and sewing machine. €3 per class. Contact the centre on 0749361742 for more info. Chair Yoga with Marie starts back on Mon 7 Sept at 11:15am, also an evening Yoga class starting on 7 Sept at 7pm. To book a place on either of these classes contact Marie on 0872962646. THE CHILD BEHAVIOUR CONSULTANCY Roisín Doherty - Behaviour Analyst consults with parents of children 3-12 years of age (with or without a diagnosis) to help their child accept ‘no’, listen, regulate their big emotions etc. Contact 0894511432 to get a consultation set up. ALCOHOLICS ANONYMOUS Amazing Grace Group, Buncrana have 5 meetings per week as follows: Sun 8pm, Tues 8pm, Thurs 11.30am, Fri 8pm & Sat 11.30am. If you think you may have a problem with alcohol, come along. Meeting in St Teresa’s Room. AL-ANON GROUP (for anyone whose life is or has been affected by someone else’s drinking) meet in St Teresa’s Room on Thurs at 6:45pm. GAMBLERS ANONYMOUS weekly meeting in St Teresa’s Room each Sun 5pm-6.30pm for anyone struggling with a gambling addiction. GAMBLERS ANONYMOUS HELPLINE Is gambling affecting your life? We would like to help. Pick up the phone and ring 048 7135 1329. THE PLAZA Dance Classes starting back on Tues 25 August from 10:30am. From Wed 26 August: Junior Line Dancing & Jiving Class 5pm-6pm. Beginners Line Dancing 6:15pm-7:15pm. Advanced Line Dancing 7:30pm-8:30pm. From Mon 31 Aug: A Beginners Line Dancing and Jiving Class at the Laurentic 7:30pm -9pm. Social Dances: Sat 22 August Michael Cleary and Jackie Bannon; Sat 29 August Trevor Loughery. Doors 9pm, Dancing 9:30pm. Admission €10. Hall available for hire & for children’s birthday parties. Contact Ursula on 0877538317 INISHOWEN MEDICAL Hearing loss? Earache? Blocked ears? It could just be wax. Inishowen Medical can help with that. We can offer both our patients and non-patients microsuction. Microsuction is a newer and more patient friendly way of clearing wax from ears. It is considered comfortable for the patient and can be used in every ear, even if there is a history of perforations. The fee is €60 for all patients including medical card & GP Visit card holders. Get your hearing back today by calling Inishowen Medical to make an appointment on 074 93 61800 or 074 76173. PIANO LESSONS Beginner piano lessons available in the Buncrana area, contact Lauren on 0864558483 for more details. NOWDOC Phone Number: 0818400911 SAFEGUARDING NOTICE: If you have any concerns with regards to Safeguarding Children or adults in need of protection within the Church please contact Marie O’Kane, the Diocesan Designated Liaison Person (DLP) at 0044 7596500793, or at dlp@derrydiocese.org or Garda Síochána, Buncrana 074 9320540, Letterkenny HQ 074 9167100 or TUSLA Family & Child Agency 00353 749102233 ROI Vetting Office: 074 93 63108
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**Parishes of Camus, Clonleigh and Leckpatrick
Twenty-First Sunday in Ordinary Time – Year A – 23rd August 2026**

Parish Clergy

Fr Michael McCaughey, PP: (028) 71882274 / (028) 71882215

Fr Declan Boland (priest in residence)

Email: leckpatrickparish@derrydiocese.org; **Website:** www.leckpatrickparish.com

Email: strabaneparish@derrydiocese.org; **Website:** www.camusparish.com

Email: clonleighparish@derrydiocese.org; **Website:** www.clonleighparish.com

Thoughts on the Gospel (Matthew 14:13-21)

In today's gospel, Jesus asks His disciples a very personal question about who they believe He is. Many people had different opinions about Him, but Jesus wanted His followers to speak from their own faith and experience. Peter answers with confidence, recognising Jesus as the promised Saviour and the Son of God.

This passage reminds us that faith cannot depend only on what others believe. We may learn about God from our parents, teachers, friends or church community, but each of us must eventually make our own response to Jesus. The word **ROCK** helps us remember the message. We are called to **RECOGNISE** Jesus as Lord and Saviour, **OWN** our faith through daily choices, **COMMIT** to the calling God gives us, and **KEEP** standing firm when life becomes difficult.

Peter was not perfect, yet Jesus still used him for a great purpose. In the same way, God can work through our weaknesses and help us become part of His mission. When we build our lives on Christ, our faith becomes stronger, our hope grows deeper, and our lives show the answer to Jesus' question. Our response should not be seen only in our words, but also in how we love, forgive, serve, and remain faithful. Christ is the true foundation, and when we stand on Him, life's storms may shake us, but they cannot destroy the hope He gives.

Lord Jesus, you are the Messiah, the Son of the living God. Strengthen our faith to confess You with courage. May nothing overcome the hope we have in You.

Camus / Leckpatrick Parish Draw is on Thursday 27th August at 7.30 pm in the Parochial House, Ballymagorry. Outstanding payments can be made to your promoter or at pastoral office. Good luck everyone and thanks for all the support.

Parish Bingo and Lucky Four A warm welcome to all to St Patrick's Hall every Thursday at 8.00 pm for bingo and lucky four. Come along for some fun and excitement and of course slight competition.

Donegal Down Syndrome Association Annual Church Gate Collection takes place on 29th/30th August at St Patrick's Murlog. Anyone interested in helping can contact info@donegal.downsyndrome.ie or 0857870075. Your financial support for this important fundraising event would be greatly appreciated and will help in continuing to provide vital services and supports to children and adults with Down syndrome and their families across Donegal. Thank you.

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John Duncan, Church View, Strabane
Michael (Mixer) McCrossan, Marian Park, Strabane
Jane Friel, Drumbuoy, Lifford
Anthony McGillian, Innisfree Gardens, Strabane
Stephen Hannigan, Castlevue, Newtown Stewart
Gerard McShane, Belfast / Strabane

Anniversaries Paul Bradley, Columba Burns, Packie Conwell, Davy Crotty, Agnes Deazley, Elizabeth Devine, Dennis Devlin, Rosaleen Doherty, Gillian Gallagher, Moya Gallagher, Philomena Gallagher, James Houston, Sr Magdalene Joyce, Harry Kielty, Michael (Micky) Lynn, Mary McConnell, Agnes McCosker, George McCosker, Ken McCrory, Arthur McDaid, Edward McDaid, Patsy McElroy (Snr), Susan McGinnis, George McLaughlin, Joan McNulty, Tommy Melaugh, Jim Montague, Betty O'Doherty, Kathleen Tinney

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Gospel: Matthew 16:21-27

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Sacred Heart, Derry Road: Sunday: **12.15 pm**

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Weekday Mass Schedule

Monday: **8.00 am:** Sacred Heart Church, Derry Road

10.00 am: St Patrick's Church, Lifford

Tuesday: **10.00 am:** Immaculate Conception Church, Strabane

Wednesday: **8.00 am:** Sacred Heart Church, Derry Road

(followed by **Eucharistic Adoration** until 5.30 pm).

10.00 am: St Patrick's Church, Lifford

Thursday: 10.00 am: Immaculate Conception Church, Strabane
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Weddings Please contact the parish office. At least 6 months' notice required.

Baptisms: Parent(s) are asked to contact the parish office.

The Parish Pastoral Area Office, 27 Butcher St, Strabane covers all 3 parishes.
Office hours: Monday – Thursday: 9.30 am - 4.30 pm; Friday: 9.30 am - 12.30 pm.
Please feel free to call in or phone on 028 7188 2215.

Reminder that the deadline for parish bulletin notices is 2 pm on Wednesdays.

A Small Collection of Candles is available for purchase at the Pastoral Office.

A gentle reminder that we can only accept cash or cheque payments. Thank you.

Safeguarding (Northern Ireland) If you have any concerns with regard to the Safeguarding of Children or Adult at risk of harm or Adult in need of protection within the Church please contact Marie Gormley, the Diocesan Designated Liaison Person (DLP) on 07596 500793 or at marie.gormley@derrydiocese.org To report a safeguarding suspicion, concern, knowledge or allegation directly to the statutory authorities please contact PSNI on 101, Western HSCT Children's Gateway Services on 028 71 314090, WHSCT Adult Gateway Services on 028 71 611366 or the Regional Emergency Social Work Service on 028 95 049999.

Safeguarding (Republic of Ireland) If you have any concerns with regard to the Safeguarding of Children or Vulnerable Adults within the Church please contact Marie Gormley, the Diocesan Designated Liaison Person (DLP) on +44 7596 500793 or at marie.gormley@derrydiocese.org To report a safeguarding suspicion, concern, knowledge or allegation directly to the statutory authorities please contact Garda Síochána Buncrana on 074 93 20540, Garda Síochána Letterkenny on 074 91 67100, TUSLA (ROI) Child and Family Agency on 074 91 02233 or HSC Adult Safeguarding, Donegal on 071 983 4660.



Sacred Heart Church

Carndonagh

*22nd & 23rd August 2026
(21st Sunday Ordinary Time)*

Mass Times

Friday	7.00 pm
Saturday Vigil	7.00 pm
Sunday	9.00 am & 11 am

Baptism

Saturday	6.00 pm
Sunday	12.00 noon

Rosary

Sunday	6.30pm
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Deaths: We wish to express our deepest sympathy to the family and friends Anthony Paradiso. His Funeral Mass and Interment of Ashes took place on Saturday.

Anniversary and Month's Mind Masses

Sat 22 nd Aug	Joseph Callaghan, The Buildings, (Month's Mind) 7 pm
Sun 23 rd Aug	Mary Jo Lafferty, Malin Rd 9am
Fri 28 th Aug	Owen McGuinness, Malin Rd (Month's Mind) 7pm
Sat 29 th Aug	Mary Browne, Hollymount (Month's Mind) 7pm
Sun 30 th Aug	John Collins, Gortin (30 th Anniv) 9am
Wed 2 nd Sep	Mary Doyle, Benduff 10am
Mon 7 th Sep	Danny Doherty (Newman), Ballyloskey 9am

Anniversaries at this time

Gabriel Doherty, Gortyarn



Baptisms: We welcome into God's family: Darla Rose McLaughlin, Churchtown & Clara Niamh Bambrick, Rashenny.

**Weekly Collection amounted to € 2544.87 & Stg £ 71.16
Thank you for your generosity.**

Good As New for Church funds will be re-opening on Monday 7th September. All washed and clean donations are welcome. Tel. Bernie on 0861734977 or Don on 0868554796.

Vocations: In this Sunday's gospel Peter acknowledges Jesus as the Christ, the Son of the living God, and Jesus confers on Peter "...the keys of the Kingdom..." an image reflected in the First Reading where the Lord says He will "...place the key of David..." on the shoulder of those called to lead His people, those who will be called "father."

Anam Cara is very pleased to announce our first Bereavement Information Evening especially dedicated to supporting surviving siblings this autumn. As part of our commitment to supporting everyone following the death of a child, we are exploring opportunities to further support the entire family. This event is the first of that commitment. This event is open to all parents whose child or children have died and we are also opening this Bereavement Information Evening to bereaved adult siblings over 18. **Tuesday 15 September at 7pm.** register here:

<https://us02web.zoom.us/join/zoom/register/of6tRhtRju5bzN9fQuIVQ#/registration>

Catholic Mothers Ireland – Family Day: Catholic Mothers Ireland will hold its Annual National Mass on Sunday, 6 September at Termonbacca Retreat Centre, Derry. The day will begin with Mass at 2.00pm, celebrated by Bishop Donal McKeown, followed by refreshments, children's activities, and a talk for parents. This promises to be a lovely day for the whole family. All are welcome. For more information and booking details, please email info@catholicmothers.ie.

BUNCRANA GARDEN FETE 2026: The Annual Garden Fete will take place this Sunday, 23 August, from 3.00 - 6.00pm in the grounds of Scoil Mhuire, Buncrana F93 PN53. Fun for all the family with Bouncy Castles, Mechanical Bull, Petting Farm, Facepainting, Bingo, Rickety Wheel, Children's Games, Raffle Prizes and more. Entry €5pp or €15 per family (cash only). All welcome.

Blessing of Bikers and Motorcycles will take place on Sunday 13 September in St Aengus' Chapel, Burt, Co Donegal, at 1:30. All are welcome to attend the brief service and blessing. Following the blessing all are welcome to join the run to Ned's Point RNLI Station, to present the donation to the RNLI. Please note, Mass will be celebrated on Sunday 13 September in St Patrick's Chapel, DUNGIVEN, at 11:30am for deceased bikers, especially those who have died in past year.

Masses and Baptisms: If you wish to book Masses or Baptisms please call into the Sacristy before or after any Masses or telephone **0860577273**. Parish Office, Macartan's, Carndonagh, Co. Donegal. [Tel:\(074\)9374104](tel:0749374104) [Email:sacredheartchurchcarn@gmail.com](mailto:sacredheartchurchcarn@gmail.com)

SUNDAY 23 AUGUST 2026

Twenty First Sunday Ordinary Time

NEWSLETTER FOR THE PARISHES OF THE WEST TYRONE PASTORAL AREA:
Aghyaran ♦ Ardstraw West & Castlederg ♦ Drumquin

REV PAUL FRASER PP, Tel:028 816 71393; REV THOMAS CANNING CC, Tel: 028 82831 225

SCHEDULE FOR THIS WEEK:

DAY	AGHYARAN	ARDSTRAW WEST & CASTLEDERG	DRUMQUIN
Monday 24 August		Mass, Castlederg: 7.30pm	Mass, 10.00am Rosary, 8.00pm at Grotto
Tuesday 25 August	Mass, 10.00am		
Wednesday 26 August			Mass, 10.00am
Thursday 27 August	Mass, 10.00am		
Friday 28 August		Mass, Castlederg: 10.00am	
Saturday 29 August	Vigil Mass, 7.30pm	Vigil Mass, Castlederg, 6.15pm	Vigil Mass: 5.00pm
Sunday 30 August	Mass, 11.00am	Mass: Dregish, 9.30am Castlederg, 11.00am Drumnabey, 12.30pm	Mass, 11.00am

THANK YOU for your generosity in last week's collection:

AGHYARAN: £844 & €30. **Church Restoration Fund:** £790 & €66.

ARDSTRAW WEST & CASTLEDERG: £1,576 & €36, made up of:

Castlederg £680 & €15, **Drumnabey** £598 & €21, **Dregish** £298. **DRUMQUIN:** £826.

Thank you, as always, to all who contribute by Standing Order. In July, these amounted to:

Aghyaran: £855 & €20. **CRF** £592. **Ardstraw West & Castlederg:** £2,481. **Drumquin:** £3,005.

ARANDERG CCE - QUIZ NIGHT: Sportsman's Inn, Castlederg, Friday 28 August, at 8.00pm. £20 per table with teams of four. Pre-book by contacting Aranderg CCE Facebook or just come along on the night. See you there!

SONGS FROM HOME - learn to sing songs written about Tyrone by people who were born here. Perform them as part of a song and story path in the Ulster American Folk Park, Omagh, Sat 11 October, 10.30am – 2.00pm. A variety of Rehearsal dates: contact Claire on 07751 371800 or Fionnuala on 07966 409372 for details. Everyone welcome!

TEAM HOPE FUNDRAISING GARDEN PARTY – Friday 4 Sept, 2.00 – 7.00pm, 30 Lurganbuoy Road, Castlederg. Live music with Macdara O'Dwyer. Tea, coffee, treats, raffle, garden games, fun for children and families. Deborah Lowry wishes you to know that everyone is welcome - drop in at any time during the afternoon or evening.

Please remember in prayer our young parishioners, family members and friends who are making important choices and decisions at this time, having received exam results:

**We pray, O Lord, that they be guided by the Holy Spirit
as they seek to plan their future, whether
at school, in third-level education or in the workplace.**

**Grant that the path they choose in life will bring them happiness and fulfilment.
May Your love be upon them, O Lord, as they place all their trust in You. Amen.**

†

We pray for the happy repose of the soul of Michael Harper, Castlefin Road, whose Funeral Mass took place in Castlederg on Wednesday. We offer our sympathy and our prayerful support to his family and to all who mourn his death. May he rest in peace.

Parishes of Camus, Clonleigh and Leckpatrick

Twenty-First Sunday in Ordinary Time – Year A – 23rd August 2026

Parish Clergy

Fr Michael McCaughey, PP: (028) 71882274 / (028) 71882215

Fr Declan Boland (priest in residence)

Email: leckpatrickparish@derrydiocese.org; **Website:** www.leckpatrickparish.com

Email: strabaneparish@derrydiocese.org; **Website:** www.camusparish.com

Email: clonleighparish@derrydiocese.org; **Website:** www.clonleighparish.com

Thoughts on the Gospel (*Matthew 14:13-21*)

In today's gospel, Jesus asks His disciples a very personal question about who they believe He is. Many people had different opinions about Him, but Jesus wanted His followers to speak from their own faith and experience. Peter answers with confidence, recognising Jesus as the promised Saviour and the Son of God.

This passage reminds us that faith cannot depend only on what others believe. We may learn about God from our parents, teachers, friends or church community, but each of us must eventually make our own response to Jesus. The word **ROCK** helps us remember the message. We are called to **RECOGNISE** Jesus as Lord and Saviour, **OWN** our faith through daily choices, **COMMIT** to the calling God gives us, and **KEEP** standing firm when life becomes difficult.

Peter was not perfect, yet Jesus still used him for a great purpose. In the same way, God can work through our weaknesses and help us become part of His mission. When we build our lives on Christ, our faith becomes stronger, our hope grows deeper, and our lives show the answer to Jesus' question. Our response should not be seen only in our words, but also in how we love, forgive, serve, and remain faithful. Christ is the true foundation, and when we stand on Him, life's storms may shake us, but they cannot destroy the hope He gives.

Lord Jesus, you are the Messiah, the Son of the living God. Strengthen our faith to confess You with courage. May nothing overcome the hope we have in You.

Camus / Leckpatrick Parish Draw is on Thursday 27th August at 7.30 pm in the Parochial House, Ballymagorry. Outstanding payments can be made to your promoter or at pastoral office. Good luck everyone and thanks for all the support.

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Monday: 8.00 am: Sacred Heart Church, Derry Road

10.00 am: St Patrick's Church, Lifford

Tuesday: 10.00 am: Immaculate Conception Church, Strabane

Wednesday: 8.00 am: Sacred Heart Church, Derry Road

(followed by **Eucharistic Adoration** until 5.30 pm).

10.00 am: St Patrick's Church, Lifford

Thursday: 10.00 am: Immaculate Conception Church, Strabane

Friday: 8.00 am: Sacred Heart Church, Derry Road

10.00 am: Immaculate Conception Church, Strabane

Weddings Please contact the parish office. At least 6 months' notice required.

Baptisms: Parent(s) are asked to contact the parish office.

The Parish Pastoral Area Office, 27 Butcher St, Strabane covers all 3 parishes. **Office hours:** Monday – Thursday: 9.30 am – 4.30 pm; Friday: 9.30 am – 12.30 pm. Please feel free to call in or phone on 028 7188 2215.

Reminder that the deadline for parish bulletin notices is 2 pm on Wednesdays.

A Small Collection of Candles is available for purchase at the Pastoral Office.

A gentle reminder that we can only accept cash or cheque payments. Thank you.

Safeguarding (Northern Ireland) If you have any concerns with regard to the Safeguarding of Children or Adult at risk of harm or Adult in need of protection within the Church please contact Marie Gormley, the Diocesan Designated Liaison Person (DLP) on 07596 500793 or at marie.gormley@derrydiocese.org To report a safeguarding suspicion, concern, knowledge or allegation directly to the statutory authorities please contact PSNI on 101, Western HSCT Children's Gateway Services on 028 71 314090, WHSCT Adult Gateway Services on 028 71 611366 or the Regional Emergency Social Work Service on 028 95 049999.

Safeguarding (Republic of Ireland) If you have any concerns with regard to the Safeguarding of Children or Vulnerable Adults within the Church please contact Marie Gormley, the Diocesan Designated Liaison Person (DLP) on +44 7596 500793 or at marie.gormley@derrydiocese.org To report a safeguarding suspicion, concern, knowledge or allegation directly to the statutory authorities please contact Garda Síochána Buncrana on 074 93 20540, Garda Síochána Letterkenny on 074 91 67100, TUSLA (ROI) Child and Family Agency on 074 91 02233 or HSC Adult Safeguarding, Donegal on 071 983 4660.



clonmanyparish.ie



Clonmany Parish Newsletter



PARISH MASS AND PRAYER SCHEDULE

ST MARY'S CHURCH, CLONMANY

- Monday—Thursday 9:30am Mass
- Friday 7:30pm—Confessions from 7pm
- Saturday 6:30pm V Mass—Confessions from 6pm
- Sunday 11:30am
- Wednesday: *Exposition of The Blessed Sacrament 2:30pm—3:30pm in the room behind the Sanctuary*

ST MICHAEL'S CHURCH, URRIS

- Sunday: 10am Mass
- Friday: *Exposition of the Blessed Sacrament 3-6pm*

ORATORY OF THE ASSUMPTION, BALLYLIFFIN

- Tuesday: *Exposition of the Blessed Sacrament 7:30—8:30pm*

MASS INTENTIONS

10am Mass—Philip Devlin, Letter & Manchester
11:30am Mass—Jim Hart, Carndonagh

ANNIVERSARIES

Isabell Grant, Upper Annaugh
Seamus Doherty (Tim), Tullagh

RECENT DEATH

Paddy Doherty, Sydney, Australia, formerly of Clougherna, Clonmany.

SAINTS OF THE WEEK

Monday: St Bartholomew, Apostle
Tuesday: St Louis of France & St Joseph Calasanz
Thursday: St Monica
Friday: St Augustine, bishop and doctor of the Church
Saturday: The Passion of St John the Baptist

BAPTISMS

We welcome into God's family through holy baptism
Croia Bridget McHale, Straid & Alexander Ruairi Gilmore, Ballyliffin.

SYMPATHY

We offer sincere sympathy to the family and friends of John Gill, Gortfad and David Gill, Annaugh & Wexford who died during the week. May they rest in peace.

ROSARY

The Rosary continues on Wednesday at 8:30pm at the Grotto in St Mary's Church, Clonmany—All welcome as we pray for peace.



CHURCH GATE COLLECTION

Annual collection for Down Syndrome will be taken up after all masses next weekend Aug 29 & 30.

PARISH DRAW

Promoters are asked to make return this week for the draw on Friday

NOWDOC—6pm Friday—8am Monday—Call 0818400911

Fr John McDevitt PP Tel 0749376273 or 085 8237119
Fr Karl Haan CC Tel 0749379107
Parish Office Tel 0749376114 Email: clonmanyparish1@outlook.com



COLLECTIONS

Parish collection last weekend amounted to €2,395.
Collection for upkeep of the cemeteries amounted to . . .
Clonmany: €1,695 & €96,
Urris: € 1,093 & €68,
Cleagh: €529 & €34.
Thank you all for your generosity to the above collections.

VOCATIONS

In this Sunday's gospel Peter acknowledges Jesus as the Christ, the Son of the living God, and Jesus confers on Peter "...the keys of the Kingdom..." an image reflected in the First Reading where the Lord says He will "...place the key of David..." on the shoulder of those called to lead His people, those who will be called "father."

LEGION OF MARY

Bus trip to Knock of Sunday Sept 27—for more details or to book contact James on 086 1256357.

CLONMANY TUG-O-WAR GROUP

Will hold their AGM on Friday September 18 in Clonmany Tug-of-war clubhouse at 8pm. All welcome.

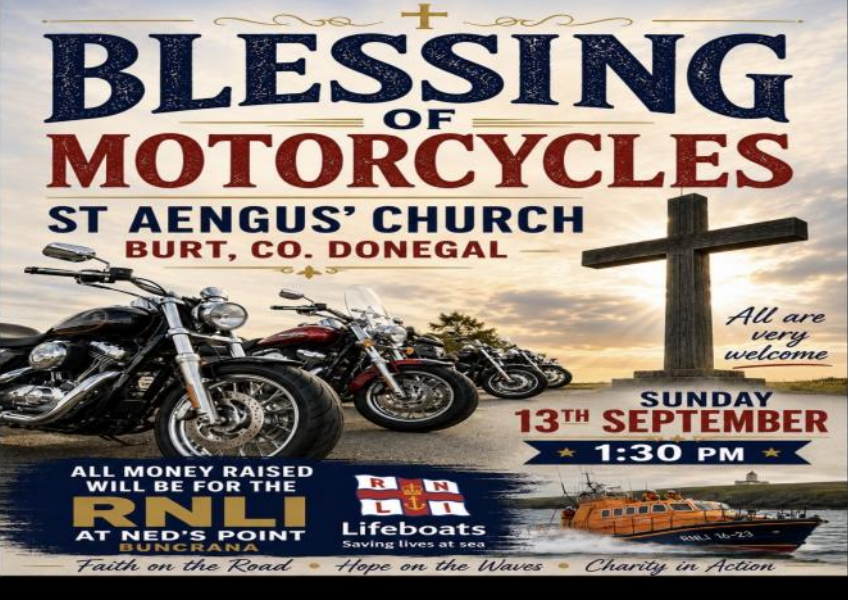
CATHOLIC MOTHERS IRELAND

Family Day: Catholic Mothers Ireland will hold its Annual National Mass on Sunday Sept 6 at Termonbacca Retreat Centre, Derry. The day will begin with Mass at 2pm celebrated by Bishop Donal McKeown, followed by refreshments, children's activities, and a talk for parents. This promises to be a lovely day for the whole family. For more information and booking details, please email info@catholicmothers.ie. All are welcome.

BUNCRANA GARDEN FETE 2026: The Annual Garden Fete will take place this Sunday, 23 August, from 3.00 - 6.00pm in the grounds of Scoil Mhuire, Bunrana F93 PN53. Fun for all the family with Bouncy Castles, Mechanical Bull, Petting Farm, Facepainting, Bingo, Rickety Wheel, Children's Games, Raffle Prizes and more. Entry €5pp or €15 per family (cash only). All welcome.

SLIABH SNEACHT CENTRE NOTES

Walkers will meet on Friday August 28 at the Famine Village car-park, at 10am—everyone welcome.
Weekly drop in Craft Class starts back on Wed Sept 9.(Sewing / Embroidery/ Knitting) no tutor, just a group of like minded people supporting each other while enjoying a cup of tea and a chat. Bring your own materials and sewing machine. €3 per class. Contact the centre on 0749361742 for more information.
Chair Yoga with Marie starts back on Mon Sept 7 at 11:15 and Yoga class on Monday Sept 7 at 7pm. To book a place on either of these classes contact Marie on 0872962646.



MARRIAGE ENRICHMENT WEEKEND

Marriage Encounter Ireland invites married couples to a residential Weekend from Friday 2—Sunday 4 October at the Focolare Centre, Curryhills, Prosperous, Co. Kildare. Step away from daily distractions to deepen your communication, renew your love, and rediscover the joy of your marriage. Visit www.marriageencounter.ie

HEARING LOSS?

Earache? Blocked ears? It could just be wax. Inishowen Medical can help with that. We can offer both our patients and non-patients microsuction. Microsuction is a newer and more patient friendly way of clearing wax from ears. It is considered comfortable for the patient and can be used in every ear, even if there is a history of perforations. The fee is €60 for all patients including medical card & GP Visit card holders. Get your hearing back today by calling Inishowen Medical to make an appointment on 074 93 61800 or 074 76173.

ALONE

Is seeking volunteers for the Clonmany and surrounding areas for any of our Befriending service which include:
Visitation support and Befriending volunteer
Telephone support and Befriending volunteer
National support and referral line volunteer
We ask if you have an hour to spare a week, please get in contact as that hour can make a world of difference to someone suffering with looniness, isolation and detachment from community life.

CLONMANY SHAMROCKS NEWS

Lotto Numbers on 13/08/2026—06,13,21,30. No jackpot winner
€20 Prizes went to: Tricia Barr, Gaddyduff; Edward McLaughlin, Dunaff; Sara Doherty, Chapel Glen. Next draw on 20/08/2026.
Jackpot €15,000. Online link Klubfunder: <https://hub.klubfunder.com/>
August 200 Club Draw will take place on Monday August 31
Can all promoters make their returns before this date—thank you.

The gospel this morning suggests that Jesus was not too concerned about numbers. The gospels for the last four Sundays have been taken from chapter 6 of John's gospel where Jesus speaks of himself as the Bread of Life and of the need to eat his flesh and drink his blood in order to have life. In this morning's gospel some of Jesus' own disciples express their unease with this language. 'This is intolerable language', they say, 'How could anyone accept it?' Jesus is portrayed in that reading as being very aware that some of his followers were complaining. Yet, he did not make any effort to soften his teaching in order to hold on to his numbers. Rather, he insists that the words he has been speaking, all his words, are spirit and life. As a result, the gospel tells us that 'many of his disciples left him and stopped going with him.' Jesus suddenly lost a whole swathe of his following. From the perspective of the culture of the time and of our own culture he was suddenly less successful. According to the gospel, Jesus even turned to the Twelve apostles, his core group, and asked them, 'What about you? Do you want to go away too?' He was prepared to suffer a haemorrhage from that core group rather than compromise on the teaching that he had given. It seems that numbers were not important to him. What was important to him was proclaiming the truth as he had heard it from God his Father. On this occasion Jesus held onto the Twelve. Peter, their spokesperson, grasped the moment to declare their faithfulness to Jesus, 'Lord, to whom shall we go? You have the message of eternal life.' Yet, Jesus would go on to lose even some the Twelve. At the time of his passion Judas betrayed him and Peter denied him. If success is to be measured by numbers, by the end of his earthly life, Jesus was a total failure.

Charity walk. From Carn to Malin on Sunday
13th September at 12pm. Meeting in the diamond
in Carn at 11:45 am.
Adults : €10, Kids : €5, Family : €20
All proceeds in aid of Malinwood, The Field
Group.
Get your walking shoes on and join in the fun !!!

CULMORE PARISH NEWSLETTER

Sunday, 23rd August 2026

21st Sunday in Ordinary Time

Thoughts on the Gospel

“You are Peter, and on this rock I will build my Church.” — Matthew 16:18

In today’s Gospel, Jesus asks His disciples a very personal question about who they believe He is. Many people had different opinions about Him, but Jesus wanted His followers to speak from their own faith and experience.

Peter answers with confidence, recognising Jesus as the promised Saviour and the Son of God.

This passage reminds us that faith cannot depend only on what others believe. We may learn about God from our parents, teachers, friends or church community, but each of us must eventually make our own response to Jesus.

Remember the word **ROCK**

R — RECOGNISE Jesus as Lord and Saviour.

O — OWN our faith through our daily choices.

C — COMMIT to the calling God gives us.

K — KEEP standing firm when life becomes difficult.

Peter was not perfect, yet Jesus still used him for a great purpose. In the same way, God can work through our weaknesses and help us become part of His mission.

When we build our lives on Christ, our faith becomes stronger, our hope grows deeper, and our lives show the answer to Jesus’ question. Our response should not be seen only in our words, but also in how we love, forgive, serve and remain faithful.

Christ is the true foundation, and when we stand on Him, life’s storms may shake us, but they cannot destroy the hope He gives.

Prayer

Lord Jesus, you are the Messiah, the Son of the living God. Strengthen our faith to confess You with courage. May nothing overcome the hope we have in You.

Liturgy & Prayer

Readings for Sunday 30th August

1st Reading: Jeremiah 20:7-9

Psalm: 62:2-6, 8-9

2nd Reading: Romans 12:1-2

Gospel: Matthew 16:21-27



Saints of the Coming Week

Monday: St Bartholomew, Apostle

Tuesday: St Joseph Calasanz, priest; St Louis

Thursday: St Monica

Friday: St Augustine, bishop & doctor of the Church

Saturday: The Passion of St John the Baptist, martyr



Faith & Spiritual Life

Embrace the Grace

Legion of Mary Young Adult (18-40) Catholic Conference



Saturday 29th August



9.30 am - 6 pm



De Montfort House, Morning Star Ave, Dublin, D07 VA03

Tickets from Eventbrite. Search **“Embrace the Grace.”**



Please Pray for Vocations

Visit **derryvocations.org**



Sharing the Good News

Visit **theway.ie/ezine-2/** for the weekly ezine.



Lough Derg Day Retreats

August: 29 & 31

September: 5, 6, 9, 12, 15, 19 & 20

Take time away from the busyness of life for a day of guided prayer, quiet reflection and spiritual renewal in the peaceful surroundings of Lough Derg.

Visit **loughderg.org**

St Joseph's Men's Camino 2026

A day of **pilgrimage, prayer, brotherhood and renewal.**

Saturday 12th September

Step away from the demands of everyday life and spend a day walking with Christ alongside other Catholic men.

Inspired by the ancient tradition of pilgrimage, St Joseph Men's Camino is a **25km guided pilgrimage along the beautiful Boyne Valley Camino.**

Open to men aged 18 and over.

Cost: €65 (includes lunch & dinner)

Students: €55

Visit **dominicans.ie**

Contemplative Prayer Group

The Contemplative Prayer Group meets on **Mondays at 8 pm** in the Prayer Room in the Parochial House, Barrack St.

All welcome.

Family & Marriage

Catholic Mothers Ireland Family Day

Sunday 6th September

 Termonbacca Retreat Centre, Derry

 Beginning with the **National Mass at 2 pm**, celebrated by Bishop McKeown.

The Mass will be followed by refreshments, children's activities and a talk for parents. This promises to be a lovely day for the whole family.

For information / to book: info@catholicmothers.ie

All welcome.

Accord Derry Marriage Preparation

Marriage Preparation Course for those getting married in **late 2026 / early 2027.**

Next dates:

- September 25th/26th 2026
- November 20th/21st 2026

Please note that Accord Derry will **NOT** be facilitating courses during October or December 2026.

Register online at **accordni.com**

Marriage Enrichment Weekend

Marriage Encounter invites married couples to a residential weekend:

 **2nd - 4th October**

 Focolare Centre, Prosperous, Kildare

Step away from daily distractions to deepen your communication, renew your love and rediscover the joy of your marriage.

Visit **marriageencounter.ie**

Parish & Community Notices

Buncrana Annual Garden Fete

Today (Sunday), 3 - 6 pm

 Grounds of Scoil Mhuire, Buncrana, F93 PN53

Fun for all the family with Bouncy Castles, Mechanical Bull, Petting Farm, Facepainting, Bingo, Rickety Wheel, Children's Games, Raffle Prizes, etc.

Entry: €5pp / €15 per family (*cash only*)

All welcome.

Coffee Morning in Aid of Foyle Hospice

 **Friday 25th September**

 **9.30 am - 12.30 pm**

 Murphy's on the Green

Prize draw: £1 per line.

All welcome.

Michael English Church Concert

An Evening of Faith, Hope and Inspiration

 **Friday 2nd October**

 **7.15 pm**

 St Patrick's Church, Keenaught, Desertmartin

Tickets: £30

Available at Heron's Gift Shop, Draperstown, Moneyneena PO, Ballinascreen, Desertmartin Parish or through Eventbrite.

Reflections Through Poetry

Reflections Through Poetry by **Fr John P Forbes** is available in the Pastoral Office.

Cost: £10

Proceeds to **Children in Crossfire** and **Cause for Sr Clare's Canonisation**.

Support & Wellbeing

RISE

A vital new community initiative, **RISE** is dedicated to supporting the families, friends and loved ones of those living with addiction.

 **Sunday 13th September**

 **12 noon - 4 pm**

 Everglades Hotel, Derry

The gathering aims to bring together people who may feel isolated, overwhelmed or unaware of the support structures available to them as they navigate a loved one's addiction.

The foundational message of RISE is that **recovery and healing involve the whole family**. The day is designed to serve as a safe, welcoming space where people can share experiences, build meaningful connections and discover where they can turn for help.

To secure your place, send a direct message via Facebook Messenger to the official page.

Family Carers Ireland

Family Carers Ireland are running **1:1 support clinics remotely every Tuesday in August** for carers, offering you a space and time to talk over the phone in the comfort of your own home.

 **086 8363842**

 Donegalcs@familycarers.ie

Alzheimer's Society — Carers' Information Support Programme

The Alzheimer's Society is running a **Carers' Information Support Programme (CRISP)** for family, carers and friends of people living with dementia in the Omagh area.

The programme is run over two sessions and attendees should attend both afternoons.

 **7th & 8th September 2026**

 **3 - 5 pm**

 Conference Room, Silver Birch Hotel, 5 Gortin Road, Omagh

To register, please contact **Julie-Anne, Senior Dementia Adviser**.

 **07889 604702**

Registration is required prior to attendance.

Vacancies

Derry Diocesan Trust — Job Opportunity

Administrative & Financial Officer

 Waterside Parish, Derry

 **18 hrs pw**

 **£12.88 - £13.50 per hour**

For further information:

 recruitment@derrydiocese.org

 **028 71262302**

Closing date: 24/8/26

Personal Assistants Wanted

The Churches Trust is recruiting people for flexible part-time work supporting and befriending elderly people living independently at home.

No experience required – **training and support provided.**

A full clean driving licence and access to a vehicle are required.

 For more information, call **02871 311322.**

Fundraising

Lough Derg Annual Fundraising Draw

Help ensure **Station Island remains open for future generations.**

 **Single ticket: €10**

 **Book of 6: €50**

Buy a full book and you're entered into a **sellers' draw.**

Return a complete book for the **Early Bird Draw on 28/8/26.**

 **Main Draw: 23/10/26**

Tickets from loughderg.org/store/c3/annualdraw

 +353 (0) 71 9861518

 info@loughderg.org

Pilgrimage

Medjugorje Pilgrimage

 **23rd - 30th September**

 **Cost: €775 pps**

A Thought for the Week

“You are the Messiah, the Son of the living God.” — Matthew 16:16

May we recognise Christ, own our faith, commit ourselves to His calling and keep standing firm in Him.

R • O • C • K ?

**Parish of Dunboe, Macosquin and
Aghadowey**

Sunday 23rd August 2026
Year A Psalter Week I



Rev Neil Farren PP. Chapelfield, 59 Laurel Hill
Road, Coleraine BT51 3PY Tele: 028 7034 3130
Parish Secretary: Clare White at Chapelfield
Office hours This week:
Monday 24th Aug – 09.00 – 1.00pm
Tuesday 25th Aug – 09.30 – 1.00pm

Parish Email: cpdma@btinternet.com
Parish Website: www.dmaparish.com

SVP Helpline: Tel: 07752017340
Safeguarding Officer: Mrs Bernadette Eastwood

Emergency Calls: Father Neil Farren - 07710860966

Age Concern Tele 02870357966
Good morning, Causeway For elderly and vulnerable
people. Tele 02870558005
Lifeline Crisis Response Helpline 0808 808 8000
North Coast Community Transport Tele 02870321234
Samaritans Tele 116123
St Vincent de Paul Tele 07752017340
Wave Trauma Centre for Mental Health and Wellbeing
Tele 0282766990 Women's Aid Tele 02870356
**Onus – Men & Women affected by domestic or
sexual abuse in NI – 0808 802 1414 (Freephone 24hr)**

Anniversaries

Joe Bonnar, Loretta Mulgrew-McNeill, Colum
Holloway, Samuel Boyland, Willie John McIlroy,
Peter Brennan, Annie Bridgid Kirby

Parish Collections 15th & 16th August 2026

	St Johns	Aghadowey	Dunboe
Weekly:	£617.09	£242.50	£45.00
Loose:	£326.18	£130.45	£31.00
Total:	£1392.22		

Masses - week commencing 24th August

Church	St Johns	Dunboe	Aghadowey
Monday	10am		
Tuesday	10am		
Wednesday			
Thursday	10am		
Friday	10am		
Saturday	6pm	7.30pm	
Sunday	11am		9.45am

Dunboe Reader/ Offertory Rota

Saturday 22nd August – Brenda / Offertory – Liam &
Ann

Saturday 29th August – Catherine / Offertory – Seamus
& Linda

Saturday 5th September – Philomena / Offertory –
Alice & Michael

Dunboe Eucharistic Minister Rota

Saturday 22nd August – Karen

Saturday 29th August – Maggie

Saturday 5th September – Vincent

Saturday 12th September - Linda

Dunboe Cleaning & Flowers Rota

August– Martina Doherty

St Johns Eucharistic Minister

Saturday 29th August – Patricia Mullan

Sunday 30th August – Liam McLaughlin

St Johns Minister of the Word August

Vigil: Carmel

Sunday Mass: Phaedra

Aghadowey Offertory

Sunday 23rd August – Christopher & Kathleen Owens

Sunday 30th August – Paddy & Violet Dempsey

Sunday 6th September – Don & Mary McNicholl

Catholic Mothers Ireland – Family Day:

Catholic Mothers Ireland will hold its Annual National
Mass on **Sunday, 6 September** at Termonbacca Retreat
Centre, Derry.

The day will begin with **Mass at 2.00pm**, celebrated
by **Bishop Donal McKeown**, followed by refreshments,
children's activities, and a talk for parents.

This promises to be a lovely day for the whole family. For
more information and booking details, please
email info@catholicmothers.ie.

**ST JOSEPH
MEN'S CAMINO
(BOYNE VALLEY)**
25KM • ONE DAY • ONE PILGRIMAGE

A pilgrimage that will test the body,
enlighten the mind and
strengthen the soul


Saturday, 12 September
Drogheda, Co. Louth

Holy Mass Adoration Confessions Fraternity

Walking the historic Boyne Valley route.
AFTER DINNER SPEAKER Fr Mark Quinn,
founder of Men of St Joseph
Tuam archdioceses

COST
€65 (includes
lunch and dinner)
Students: €55
Men aged 18+ only

Book now and find full details at:
Dominicans.ie

Organised by the Dominican Friars and Friends.

We Pray

In this Sunday's gospel Peter acknowledges Jesus as the Christ,
the Son of the living God, and Jesus confers on Peter "...the
keys of the Kingdom..." an image reflected in the First Reading
where the Lord says He will "...place the key of David..." on the
shoulder of those called to lead His people, those who will be
called "father."

**FUNDRAISING
CONCERT**

**MICHAEL
ENGLISH
& BAND**

Book online with Eventbrite
(<https://www.eventbrite.co.uk/>)
Search for:
Michael English, Keenaught.

**ST PATRICK'S CHURCH
KEENAUGHT**

FRIDAY 2ND OCTOBER 2026

8PM
DOORS OPEN 7:15PM
TICKETS £30

Tickets available from: Heron's Gift Shop, Draperstown;
Moneyneena Post Office; Desertmartin Parish Office and
Ballinascreen Parish Office.

Jazz at St. Patrick's
Thursday 27th August 12.30pm

Alistair Kinghan - Piano • Peter McIlreavy - Saxophone
Kevin Smith - Acoustic Bass • Andrew Collins - Percussion

Voluntary donations on the day for St. Patrick's restoration fund.

**BLESSING
OF
MOTORCYCLES**

**ST AENGUS' CHURCH
BURT, CO. DONEGAL**

*All are
very
welcome*

**SUNDAY
13TH SEPTEMBER
1:30 PM**

**ALL MONEY RAISED
WILL BE FOR THE
RNLI
AT NED'S POINT
BUNCRANA**

Lifeboats
Saving lives at sea

Faith on the Road • Hope on the Waves • Charity in Action

**Poor Clares Galway, Half-Day Retreat for women
18-40**

with Women's spirituality speaker Louise Mc Guinness,
An opportunity to encounter God's love and deepen
your life of prayer and communion with God.

The event will take place from **2pm to 6pm** on
Sunday the 6th of September

For more information and to register:
<https://cherisheddaughters.eventbrite.ie>

BABY MASSAGE & REFLEXOLOGY CLASSES

Next Block of Classes start in September 2026.
Reflexology Treatments Available for all ages.
Location: Ballerin.

Contact Diane on 07761054666 or
diane@groundedsoles.org for more information

SUNDAY 23 AUGUST 2026

Twenty First Sunday Ordinary Time

NEWSLETTER FOR THE PARISHES OF THE WEST TYRONE PASTORAL AREA:

Aghyaran ♦ Ardstraw West & Castlederg ♦ Drumquin

REV PAUL FRASER PP, Tel:028 816 71393; REV THOMAS CANNING CC, Tel: 028 82831 225

SCHEDULE FOR THIS WEEK:

DAY	AGHYARAN	ARDSTRAW WEST & CASTLEDERG	DRUMQUIN
Monday 24 August		Mass, Castlederg: 7.30pm	Mass, 10.00am Rosary, 8.00pm at Grotto
Tuesday 25 August	Mass, 10.00am		
Wednesday 26 August			Mass, 10.00am
Thursday 27 August	Mass, 10.00am		
Friday 28 August		Mass, Castlederg: 10.00am	
Saturday 29 August	Vigil Mass, 7.30pm	Vigil Mass, Castlederg, 6.15pm	Vigil Mass: 5.00pm
Sunday 30 August	Mass, 11.00am	Mass: Dregish, 9.30am Castlederg, 11.00am Drumnabey, 12.30pm	Mass, 11.00am

THANK YOU for your generosity in last week's collection:

AGHYARAN: £844 & €30. **Church Restoration Fund:** £790 & €66.

ARDSTRAW WEST & CASTLEDERG: £1,576 & €36, made up of:

Castlederg £680 & €15, **Drumnabey** £598 & €21, **Dregish** £298. **DRUMQUIN:** £826.

Thank you, as always, to all who contribute by Standing Order. In July, these amounted to:

Aghyaran: £855 & €20. **CRF** £592. **Ardstraw West & Castlederg:** £2,481. **Drumquin:** £3,005.

ARANDERG CCE - QUIZ NIGHT: Sportsman's Inn, Castlederg, Friday 28 August, at 8.00pm. £20 per table with teams of four. Pre-book by contacting Aranderg CCE Facebook or just come along on the night. See you there!

SONGS FROM HOME - learn to sing songs written about Tyrone by people who were born here. Perform them as part of a song and story path in the Ulster American Folk Park, Omagh, Sat 11 October, 10.30am – 2.00pm. A variety of Rehearsal dates: contact Claire on 07751 371800 or Fionnuala on 07966 409372 for details. Everyone welcome!

TEAM HOPE FUNDRAISING GARDEN PARTY – Friday 4 Sept, 2.00 – 7.00pm, 30 Lurganbuoy Road, Castlederg.

Live music with Macdara O'Dwyer. Tea, coffee, treats, raffle, garden games, fun for children and families. Deborah Lowry wishes you to know that everyone is welcome - drop in at any time during the afternoon or evening.

Please remember in prayer our young parishioners, family members and friends who are making important choices and decisions at this time, having received exam results:

We pray, O Lord, that they be guided by the Holy Spirit

as they seek to plan their future, whether

at school, in third-level education or in the workplace.

Grant that the path they choose in life will bring them happiness and fulfilment.

May Your love be upon them, O Lord, as they place all their trust in You. Amen.



We pray for the happy repose of the soul of Michael Harper, Castlefin Road, whose Funeral Mass took place in Castlederg on Wednesday. We offer our sympathy and our prayerful support to his family and to all who mourn his death. May he rest in peace.

**Twenty-First Sunday in
Ordinary Time**

23rd August 2026



Parish of Drumragh

**Sacred Heart Church, Omagh
St Mary's Church, Drumragh
028 82242092**

Weekend Mass Schedule

Sacred Heart Church, Omagh

Vigil: 5.30pm

Sunday Mass: 10am & 12.30pm

St. Mary's Church, Drumragh

Sunday Mass: 10.30am

Confessions:

Sacred Heart Church: Saturday's after morning Mass unless there is a funeral.

Christ the King, Strathroy:

Saturday 6.15pm-6.45pm

Weekday Mass Times this week

10.00am Monday, Tuesday & Wednesday in St. Mary's, Killyclogher
10.00am Wed, Thurs, Fri & Sat.

in Sacred Heart Church

7.30pm Wednesday Sacred Heart
Rosary before 7.30pm Mass

**NO Eucharistic Adoration on
Wednesday**

The knowledge of Jesus as Lord and personal Saviour should become a living, personal experience for each Christian. This is made possible by our listening to Jesus through the daily, meditative reading of the Bible, by our talking to Jesus through daily, personal and communal prayers, by our offering our lives on the altar with Jesus whenever we attend Holy Mass, and by our leading a Sacramental life. The next step is the surrender of our lives to Jesus by rendering humble, loving service to Him in Himself and in all others, with the strong conviction that Jesus is present in every person. The step after that is to praise and thank God in all the events of our lives, both pleasant and painful, realizing that God's loving hands are behind everything.

"Do you know who I am?" The bishop wanted to pray for and share his love with the residents of a local nursing home. As he entered the lobby of the nursing home, he saw a ninety-year-old lady sitting in a wheelchair. He faced her and asked her whether she knew who he is. She said, *"Sir, if you do not know who you are, go to the front desk and ask the receptionist. It is always better to know who you are before visiting old folks like me!"*

Parish Office will re-open on Monday 24th August at 9am.

Parish email: info@drumraghparish.com

Fr Kevin McElhennon P.P: 028 8225 8108 / k.mcelhennon@derrydiocese.org

Fr Malachy Gallagher C.C: 028 8225 1055 / malachy.gallagher@derrydiocese.org

Parish Office, Omagh 028 8224 2092 / info@drumraghparish.com

Parish Office Open Mon/Tues/Thursday 9-2pm 02882242092

Parish email: info@drumraghparish.com

Sacred Heart Church Mass Intentions

Wednesday 26th August 7.30pm Gerard Convey - 1st Anniversary

**Saturday 29th August 5.30pm Mark McCormack - 1st Anniversary
Lawrence McSwiggan - 1st Anniversary**

Sacrament of Baptism

We welcome new members of our Parish Community who received the

Sacrament of Baptism:

Saorla Aoibh Canavan

Rosa Meabh Canavan

Zoey Kelly McCarney



Recently Deceased

Anne Marie Brown

Violetta Sobolewska

Aileen McKernan

May they rest in peace



Study Theology Online, is this for you?

The Priory Institute provides online Theology courses to degree level. Attend Saturday lectures in Tallaght or from the comfort of your own home. Register now to begin on 19 September.

Find out more on our website, prioryinstitute.com

VOCATIONS

In this Sunday's gospel Peter acknowledges Jesus as the Christ, the Son of the living God, and Jesus confers on Peter "...the keys of the Kingdom..." an image reflected in the First Reading where the Lord says He will "...place the key of David..." on the shoulder of those called to lead His people, those who will be called "father."

'Embrace the Grace' Young Adult Catholic Conference - 29th August 2026

Legion of Mary: 'Embrace the Grace' is a conference on faith and culture for young adults (18-40) with talks, prayer, Mass, confession, workshops, food and social in the historic Legion of Mary headquarters at De Montfort House, North Brunswick Street, Dublin 7. It will be a chance to build faith in friendship with young adults from across the country. This event takes place on Saturday 30th August from 9.30am to 6.00pm with a social afterwards. Tickets cost €20 and can be booked on the eventbrite website by looking up 'Embrace the Grace'.

Any queries can be directed towards deusetpatria@gmail.com.

Blessing of Bikers and Motorcycles will take place on Sunday 13th September in St Aengus' Chapel, Burt, Co Donegal, at 1:30. All are welcome to attend the brief service and blessing. Following the blessing all are welcome to join the run to Ned's Point RNLI Station, to present the donation to the RNLI.

Please note, Mass will be celebrated on Sunday 13th September in St Patrick's Chapel, DUNGIVEN, at 11:30am for deceased bikers, especially those who have died in past year.

MICHAEL ENGLISH CHURCH CONCERT: An evening of Faith, Hope and Inspiration. The concert takes place on Friday 2 October at 7.15pm, in St Patrick's Church, Keenaught, Desertmartin. Tickets are £30, and available to buy at Herons Gift Shop, Draperstown, Moneyneena Post Office, Ballinascreen and Desertmartin Parish offices, or online with Eventbrite: <https://www.eventbrite.co.uk/e/michael-english-band-fundraising-concert-tickets-1996641829460>

BINGO in St. Joseph's Hall Tuesday 25th August at 8.30pm

St Mary's Cemetery – Important Notice

We have received several concerns from parishioners regarding grass cuttings being left on graves during recent maintenance at St Mary's Cemetery, Drumragh.

To help protect the dignity of all graves, please note that **extra care is taken when using trimmer's and blowers while cutting and clearing grass.** Thank you for your understanding and for helping us care for this Sacred

The Royal National institute of the deaf are holding their bimonthly free drop in event in Omagh Methodist church hall on **Thursday 27th August from 10-30 to 12.30.**

Come along and have your hearing checked and new batteries provided plus advise on how to get the best from your aids.

Alzheimer's society is running a Carers Information Support

Programme (CRISP) for family, carers and friends of people living with Dementia in Omagh area. The programme is run over 2 sessions; attendees should attend both afternoons. Dates are 7th and 8th September 2026 3-5pm In the Conference Room, Silver Birch Hotel, 5 Gortin Road, Omagh, Co Tyrone. To register please contact Julie-Anne, Senior Dementia Adviser. M:07889 604702.

Registration is required prior to attendance.

St Joseph Men's Camino

Every Camino changes us in ways we don't expect; every man needs one. Join men from across Ireland on Saturday 12th September for a 25km pilgrimage through the Boyne Valley, beginning in Drogheda. The day includes Mass, Adoration, Rosary, Confessions, fraternity, lunch and dinner, with after-dinner speaker Fr. Mark Quinn. Open to men aged 18+. Cost: €65 (student € 55).

Registration, accomodation and details: www.dominicans.ie/events.

Enquiries: op.evangelisation@gmail.com

SONGS FROM HOME

Come together with **Harmonise** and fellow local singers as we share Songs from Home. Participants must attend FREE five week choir practice followed by the Final Song Trail 10th October at Ulster American Folk Park. Refreshments provided.

EVERYONE WELCOME - **Contact Claire Sharkey for more details 07751371800**

Dates

August 30th	1pm-4pm – Dromore Sports Complex
September 23rd	7.30-10pm – Silverbirch Hotel
September 30th	7.30-10pm – Dromore Sports Complex
October 7th	7.30pm-9.30pm – Silverbirch Hotel

Blessing of Bikers and Motorcycles will take place on Sunday 13 September in St Aengus' Chapel, Burt, Co Donegal, at 1:30. All are welcome to attend the brief service and blessing. Following the blessing all are welcome to join the run to Ned's Point RNLI Station, to present the donation to the RNLI.

Please note, Mass will be celebrated on Sunday 13 September in St Patrick's Chapel, DUNGIVEN, at 11:30am for deceased bikers, especially those who have died in past year.

Al-Anon Family Group	028 9068 2368	Notices for Weekly Bulletin If you wish to submit an article for this bulletin please do so, <u>by email to - info@drumraghparish.com before 5pm on Wednesday.</u> Notes relating to the Church and articles relating to Parish events will always be given priority, and other material, such as local charity events will be accepted, space providing.
Alcoholics Anonymous	028 9035 1222	
Aware	028 7126 0602	
Care for Cancer	028 8224 6599	
Gamblers Anonymous	028 7135 1329	
Drug Awareness	0800 7766 00	
Legion of Mary	07733551846/07864926719	
Pioneers	07775 810297	
Safeguarding Team	07596 500793	
Samaritans	028 8224 4944	
SVDP Thrift Shop	028 8225 2000	
SVDP Helpline	07738837991	

Celebration of Christian Marriage

Any couple intending to celebrate their marriage in the church are advised to have their

- (1) Pre-nuptial Enquiry Forms (canonical church papers) completed no later than 3 months prior to their wedding.
- (2) Your pre-marriage course with Accord should also be completed before your papers are signed (info@accordni.com).
- (3) The Marriage Schedule (civil documents) (Ref GRO 446 v06/22) should also be “served with the Registrar at least 28 days before the date of the intended marriage”. (It is recommended that all civil and canonical papers are completed no later than 3 months prior to the wedding).

MARRIAGE ENRICHMENT WEEKEND:

Marriage Encounter Ireland invites married couples to a residential Weekend from Friday 2nd to Sunday 4th October 2026 at the Focolare Centre, Curryhills, Prosperous, Co. Kildare. Step away from daily distractions to deepen your communication, renew your love, and rediscover the joy of your marriage. Visit www.marriageencounter.ie

BUNCRANA GARDEN FETE 2026: The Annual Garden Fete will take place this Sunday, 23rd August, from 3.00 - 6.00pm in the grounds of Scoil Mhuire, Buncrana F93 PN53. Fun for all the family with Bouncy Castles, Mechanical Bull, Petting Farm, Facepainting, Bingo, Rickety Wheel, Children's Games, Raffle Prizes and more. Entry €5pp or €15 per family (cash only). All welcome.

Catholic Mothers Ireland – Family Day:

Catholic Mothers Ireland will hold its Annual National Mass on Sunday, 6th September at Termonbacca Retreat Centre, Derry.

The day will begin with Mass at 2.00pm, celebrated by Bishop Donal McKeown, followed by refreshments, children's activities, and a talk for parents.

This promises to be a lovely day for the whole family. For more information and booking details, please email info@catholicmothers.ie.

**DIOCESAN SAFEGUARDING
REPRESENTATIVE**
Marie O’Kane DLP 07596500793
dlp@derrydiocese.org

GAMBLERS ANONYMOUS:

Is gambling affecting your life? We would like to help. Pick up the phone and ring 028 7135 1329.

23rd August 2026 Dungiven Parish Bulletin No 1857

Fr. Gerard Sweeney P.P. Tel: 777 41219.

Parish Office Tel: 777 40702. Email address

dungivenparish@derrydiocese.org

Parish Website <https://www.parishofdungiven.com>**SUNDAY MASS TIMES****Sat. 4.30 pm. - Gortnaghey****Sat. 6.00 pm. - Dungiven****Sun. 9.00 am. - Dungiven****Sun. 10.15 am. - Drumsurn****Sun. 11.30 am. - Dungiven****WEEKDAY MASS TIMES****St. Patrick's:** Monday, Tuesday & Wednesday 10.00 am. **Thursday 7.00 pm.** Friday 10.00 am.**FIRST ANNIVERSARY MASSES**For Kevin O'Neill on Thursday 27th August at 7.00 pm. in St. Patrick's.
For Frances Toner on Saturday 29th August at 6.00 pm. in St. Patrick's.**MONTH'S MIND MASS**For Patrick McNicholl, Boviell Road, on Thursday 3rd September at 7.00 pm. in St. Patrick's.**CONFESSIONS**

Will take place in St. Patrick's at 11.00 am. on Saturday.

THE ROSARY

Monday, Tuesday, Wednesday & Friday at 9.30 am. in St. Patrick's.

LAST WEEK'S COLLECTION: £2,811.*Thank you to all who contributed.***BAPTISM** – We welcome into our Christian Community: Leonora Elizabeth Owens, Chapel Road.**BAPTISM** - *Godparents must be over 16 years of age, one male and one female and a practicing Catholic.*

S.V.P. HELPLINE 079 2792 9923

Baptisms will take place in St. Patrick's Church at 3.00 pm. *Two weeks' notice must be given for all Baptism bookings.***The Baptism Course:** Places must be booked through the Parish Office. **Next Course: Wednesday 26th August at 7.30 pm. in the Committee Room.****BLESSING OF BIKERS AND MOTORCYCLES**Will take place on Sunday 13th September in St. Aengus' Chapel, Burt, Co. Donegal, at 1.30 pm. All are welcome to attend the brief service and blessing. Following the blessing all are welcome to join the run to Ned's Point R.N.L.I station, to present the donation to the R.N.L.I.Please note! Mass will be celebrated on Sunday 13th September in St Patrick's Chapel, DUNGIVEN, at 11.30 am. for deceased bikers, especially those who have died in past year.**ST. PADRE PIO HEALING MASS****Dates for your Diary:** Thursday 24th September, Thursday 22nd October, Thursday 19th November and Thursday 17th December.**CHARISMATIC PRAYER GROUP**Meeting Thursday 27th August at 7.30 pm. in the Emmaus.**CLEANERS – ST. PATRICK'S CHURCH**
Voluntary cleaners required to clean the church on a monthly rota basis. Please leave your name in the parish office.**LEGION OF MARY**The Legion of Mary hopes to organise a Day Pilgrimage to Knock Shrine on **Sun. 28th Sept.**, subject to sufficient interest.If you would like to travel, please register your interest by texting **Mary McKnight** on **07548 887 853**, or by leaving your name with the Parish Office. The approximate bus fare will be **£25 per person.****BENEDY COMMUNITY ASSOCIATION**We wish to employ a person for 6 hours on a Monday for catering duties. Start date: Monday 7th September 2026. For full details, including rate of pay, contact Sabina on 07742217929.**VOCATIONS**

In this Sunday's gospel Peter acknowledges Jesus as the Christ, the Son of the living God, and Jesus confers on Peter "...the keys of the Kingdom..." an image reflected in the First Reading where the Lord says He will "...place the key of David..." on the shoulder of those called to lead His people, those who will be called "father".

ALTAR SERVER – ST. PATRICK'S CHURCH
If there are any children (In P5 and those who made their First Communion) who would like to be an Altar Server. Please make contact with Fr. Sweeney.**KEVIN LYNCH H. C.**Lotto no's: 2, 12, 15 & 28. Lucky dip: Elaine McDonnell. Jackpot: £2,125. *Bingo: Fridays 8.00 pm. in Wanes World.***DUNGIVEN LIBRARY**To finish off our Big Summer Read, on Friday 28th August at 12.00 noon, the children can come and get crafty in our **Animal Mask Mania** activity.

Each activity takes place in our library junior section, and no booking is required.

ANNUAL BENEDY TRACTOR RUN & FAMILY FUN DAYOn Saturday 29th August. Registration of tractors starting at 11.00 am. and leaving centre at 1.00 pm. Cost £20 per tractor, £10 per vintage car/motorbike, to include refreshments/hot food. Family Fun Day: Admission £5 for adults, children free. Bouncy Castle, Live Petting Farm, Nerf Gun Activity (weather permitting) & Games. Hot food available from 1.30 – 4.00 pm. Burgers £3 & Hot Dogs £2 Bar & Ice Cream available. Live music from 6.00 pm. Raffle tickets on sale for draw at 4.00 pm. Super prizes! Tickets £1.00 per strip. Everyone welcome.**PUBLIC RIGHT OF WAY INVESTIGATION**
Members of the public who use the pathways on Benbradagh Mountain or who can give information about the use of the pathways are invited to complete the Public Right Of Way user form as part of the council's investigation. To request a form please contact Causeway Coast & Glens Council or save Benbradagh at savebenbradagh@gmail.com**FREE EVENING CLASS FOR LADIES**We will be running the Financial Resilience Programme on Wednesdays in Hands That Talk for 8 weeks from 6.00 - 8.00 pm. Dates: 9th, 16th, 23rd & 30th September and 7th, 14th, 21st & 28th October.

Twenty - First Sunday in Ordinary Time (Year A)

Errigal Parish News - 23rd August 2026

Weekday Masses: St. Mary's Church: - Monday, Tuesday, and Thursday at 10am.

St. Joseph's Church: - Wednesday at 10am.

St. Mary's Church - (Vigil): Anniversary Mass -

Anniversary Mass: For Adrian Robinson on Sunday 30th August at 10am.

St. Joseph's Church - (Vigil) - DDS Mass for deceased members on Saturday 22nd August at 6pm.

Anniversary Mass -

Saturday Vigil Mass 6pm - St. Joseph's Church in August.

Eucharistic Adoration: - Adoration on Monday after Mass until 2.30pm.

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Requiescant In Pace: We extend our sympathy to the family and relatives of Tommy Johnson, formerly Lyttlesdale who died during the week.

Baptism: We welcome into the parish community Donnacha Robert O'Loughlin, 16 Churchtown Road who was baptised last weekend.

Parish Pastoral Group: Next meeting to prepare for the Parish Mission will take place on Tuesday 1st September in the Parochial House at 8.30pm.

Parish Mission: Parishioners may have heard that the parish will hold a mission in September of this year. It will be delivered by the Dominican Order. As you know it has been some time since the last Mission in the parish. Whilst members of the Parish Pastoral Group continue to organise it, it would be helpful to have a few interested individuals from each end of the parish to help with the organisation. Time commitment should not be great - a few hours between now and September and some input during the week itself. This is a great opportunity to get involved in a significant event for the parish, and if you are interested, please contact Fr. Crowley.

Parish Mission - Sunday 27th September - Friday 2nd October.

Errigal SVP: School Uniform Support: As the new school year approaches, we know that the cost of school uniforms can place a significant financial burden on many families. If you or someone you know needs assistance with the cost of school uniforms, please don't hesitate to contact your local **St Vincent de Paul (SVP Errigal)** in confidence.

Telephone: 07563595868 All enquiries will be treated with sensitivity, respect and complete confidentiality.

Errigal SVP: Could You Spare a Little Time to Help Others? As we prepare to celebrate the Feast of St Vincent de Paul (27th September), the Errigal St Vincent de Paul (SVP) Conference need a couple of volunteers to join our local team. This is a wonderful opportunity to put your faith into action, give something back to our community, and make a real difference to the lives of local individuals and families who are struggling. No previous experience is necessary. You will be warmly welcomed and fully supported by our local SVP Volunteers, with guidance and training provided. If you would like to find out more, please contact us on 07563595868. We'd be delighted to hear from you. For more details, please see <https://www.svp.ie/northern-ireland/>

Errigal: Through Our Eyes - Summer Youth Photography Project: Starting Monday 6th July, all young people under 18 are invited to join Errigal: Through Our Eyes, a summer photography project. The theme is "See what matters. See where God is." This will celebrate the beauty, faith, kindness, and everyday life of our parish. Pick up an entry form, then send up to three photos taken within the parish boundaries and a short reflection to the parish email (with parent/guardian consent for under-16s). There are 1st, 2nd and 3rd place prizes in both Primary and Secondary categories, with certificates for everyone. **Update Deadline - Please note that the closing date for entries has been postponed until the end of September. We warmly encourage all our young people to take part and share their photographs and reflections. More details will follow soon.**

Baptism Dates: The next Baptism dates are Saturday 5th September in St. Mary's Church at 5pm and St. Joseph's Church on Sunday 13th September at 12.30pm. The Baptismal Programme for parents/guardians will take place in the Parochial House on Wednesday 2nd September at 7pm. Please register to attend the Baptismal Programme by Saturday 28th August using the parish email address, this will indicate to the Baptismal Team the numbers who will attend the Baptismal Programme.

Diocesan Schools' Religious Education Conference 2026 - 'Drawing New Maps of Hope' The Derry Diocesan Catechetical Centre is delighted to be hosting its third Diocesan Schools' Religious Education Conference - 'Drawing New Maps of Hope'. The conference will take place over two days in Saint Columb's College, Derry, with over 1200 delegates attending. Tuesday 25th August is the day for Post-Primary Schools and Wednesday 26th August is the day for Primary Schools. We are delighted to welcome Dr Melodie Wyttenbach, Executive Director, Roche Centre for Catholic Education, Boston College as our keynote speaker. Bishop Donal McKeown will celebrate the Eucharist at the beginning of the conference each day. Alongside Dr Wyttenbach's keynote address, there will be 20 workshops, a panel discussion and the opportunity for attendees to meet and share their experiences and good practice.

Michael English Church Concert: An evening of Faith, Hope and Inspiration. The concert takes place on Friday 2nd October at 7.15pm, in St Patrick's Church, Keenaught, Desertmartin. Tickets are £30, and available to buy at Herons Gift Shop, Draperstown, Moneyneena Post Office, Ballinascreen and Desertmartin Parish offices, or online with Eventbrite: <https://www.eventbrite.co.uk/e/michael-english-band-fundraising-concert-tickets-1996641829460>

Gift Aid/Census Cards: Can we please request the return of Gift Aid and Census cards recently circulated so that parish records can be updated during the summer months.

Rosary and Exposition of the Blessed Sacrament: Will continue through the summer months on the first Monday of each month. St. Joseph's Church - 7pm.

Diocesan Schools' Religious Education Conference 2026 - 'Drawing New Maps of Hope'

- The Derry Diocesan Catechetical Centre is delighted to be hosting its third Diocesan Schools' Religious Education Conference - 'Drawing New Maps of Hope'. The conference will take place over two days in Saint Columb's College, Derry. Tuesday 25th August is the day for Post-Primary Schools and Wednesday 26th August is the day for Primary Schools. We are delighted to welcome Dr Melodie Wyttenbach, Executive Director, Roche Centre for Catholic Education, Boston College as our keynote speaker. Bishop Donal McKeown will celebrate the Eucharist at the beginning of the conference each day. Alongside Dr Wyttenbach's keynote address, there will be 20 workshops, a panel discussion and the opportunity for attendees to meet and share their experiences and good practice. If you would like to register your intention to attend, please complete the form below. Once you have registered, you will receive a list of workshops to choose from.

<https://forms.office.com/e/wskcEL79LY?origin=lpLink>

Monday Adoration Adorers: We request if you are available on Monday from after the morning Mass to participate in the rota for Adoration of the Blessed Sacrament which takes place until 2.30pm. If interested, please leave your name/contact number in the sacristy and we will follow up.

Parish Collections - Thank you. 183 boxes of envelopes in circulation.

Returns (Pink/Yellow - 85 White - 65)

St. Mary's - Parish: £400 Renovation: £110

St. Joseph's - Parish: £450 Renovation: £450

Ballerin GAA Lotto: There was no winner of the lotto jackpot the numbers are 8, 25, 27, 28. Jackpot is £2500. Lucky Dip Winner £50 - Knight Family.

Glenullin GAA Lotto: There was no winner of the lotto jackpot the numbers are 3, 15, 22, 29. Jackpot £10,000. £25 winners - Majella McCloskey, Peter Doherty, Joanne O'Kane, Gerard McAfee, and Edel Mullan.

Readers & Eucharistic Ministers

St. Mary's Church - Church Readers - 29th/30th August

Saturday Vigil -

Sunday Morning - Seamus O'Kane.

If anyone is interested in becoming a Reader in St. Mary's Church, please give your name to Fr. Crowley training will be provided.

Eucharistic Ministers - 29th/30th August

Saturday Vigil -

Sunday Morning - Martina Bradley & Gillian O'Neill.

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Readers & Eucharistic Ministers

St. Joseph's Church - Church Readers - 29th/30th August

Saturday Vigil - Gerard O'Kane.

Sunday Morning - Michael Leadon.

If anyone is interested in becoming a Reader in St. Joseph's Church, please give your name to Fr. Crowley or Mairead Mc Nicholl (Lector Co-Ordinator), training will be provided.

Eucharistic Ministers - 29th/30th August

Saturday Vigil - Rosellen O'Kane & Mary Conway.

Sunday Morning - Ursula Mullan & Nadine McNicholl.

Feasts during the Week: Monday - St. Bartholomew: Name occurs in the Synoptic Gospels only in the list of the apostles. He is probably to be identified with Nathanael of Cana, whom Philip brings to our Lord. Preached the Gospel in India. **Tuesday - St. Louis (1214 - 70):** King of France, father of eleven children, Franciscan tertiary, man of integrity, died in Tunisia on his second Crusade. He is the Patron of the French Monarchy. **Thursday - St. Monica (332 - 87):** Converted her pagan husband, Patricius, to the faith, and by her prayers and tears brought her son St. Augustine to Christianity and a moral life. Patron saint of mothers. **Friday - St. Augustine (354 - 430):** Bishop of Hippo, where he lived with a community until his death. His theological influence has been most significant in the Church, especially on the understanding of God's grace. Patron of theologians. **Saturday - Passion of John the Baptist:** He is found worthy of a martyr's death, his last and greatest act of witness to Christ.

Diocesan Vocations: In this Sunday's gospel Peter acknowledges Jesus as the Christ, the Son of the living God, and Jesus confers on Peter "...the keys of the Kingdom..." an image reflected in the First Reading where the Lord says He will "...place the key of David..." on the shoulder of those called to lead His people, those who will be called "father."

For further information, please contact the Diocesan Vocations Director, Fr Pat O'Hagan, at pgoh2111@gmail.com

Anniversaries: It is advisable where possible to book well in advance in the case of anniversaries. These are arranged with a sacristan as the anniversary book is kept in the sacristy. Also, please indicate in the Anniversary book that the Mass is booked for the stated intention - we would appreciate an acknowledgment of the booking by email if possible. **In the case of a booked Anniversary Mass please inquire of the sacristan before the Mass begins that the Mass is offered for the intention you request.** Names to be added to the weekend anniversary list need to be added to the anniversary book by informing the sacristan - this can be done in advance of the date requested.

Parish Readers/Eucharistic Ministers: If you are unable to attend the schedule allocated to you, it would be much appreciated if you can get a replacement to step in for you. (It may be possible to exchange a rotation with another group member - there is also the opportunity to seek cover via the Whatsapp messaging facility if available to your group). I also ask Readers please to conclude the readings with - '**The Word of the Lord**' as directed in the Missalette, and not 'This is the Word of the Lord' as stated in the Lectionary. We have previously discussed this at our reader meetings.

Look out Leaflets...Are now available for children at the back of both churches in the parish focusing on the liturgy of the word each week. Enjoy!

Teach us to Pray Booklet - It can be downloaded at:
<https://www.derrydiocese.org/news/teach-us-to-pray>.

Why Sunday Matters! The Irish Catholic Bishops' Conference have published a pastoral message titled '*Why Sunday Matters*' - an invitation to reflect on Sunday Mass. To access this resource and watch a four-part video series titled Sunday Mass - 'Digging Deeper', visit at CatholicBishops.ie

TheWay.ie: Is a new digital platform set up by the Irish Bishops Conference dedicated to sharing the 'Good News' and the witness of the Catholic Church in Ireland. It is intended to help people discover the faith, live the faith and pass on the faith. It is for both seekers and followers. Follow us on Facebook, Instagram, X and YouTube.

St. Joseph's Church - A YouTube camera link is now available for services from St. Joseph's Church, Glenullin. The link can be accessed - <https://youtube.com/@parishoferrigalderry>.

The Net: As always, it features a wide variety of news, interesting and inspiring interviews, articles, and photos from parishes across the diocese. You can read the Diocesan newspaper on-line at: www.derrydiocese.org/news/categories/the-net. or a paper copy is available at the back of the church. Donations welcome.

Prayer for Peace in the Middle East: God of mercy and compassion of grace and reconciliation, pour your presence upon all your children in the Middle East: Jews, Muslims, Christians, Palestinians, and Israelis. Let hatred be turned into love, fear to trust, despair to hope, oppression to freedom, occupation to liberation. That violent encounters may be replaced by loving embraces, and peace and justice maybe experienced by all. Amen.

St. Joseph's Church: We present a dual gauge to initiative funds in our parish for the on-going costs associated with the renovation of St. Joseph's Church. The gauge on the left indicates the funds we require to complete the refurbishment. The gauge on the right reflects the loans we have received from other parishes. (Gauge also available on website and Facebook page). **Thanks - Donations to date** - Current figure £235,400.00.

Providing compassionate care at the end of life - To address the sensitive issue of compassionate care at the end of life, and in response to the need to inform the faithful of Catholic teaching on this important life issue that affects so many families, the Bishops of Ireland have published the pastoral letter: Freedom to Live Fully, Until Death Comes. You are invited to read this letter and view the accompanying video Through the Valley, which offers personal testimonies by carers and people with terminal illness. The key message of both letter and video asserts that every person possesses inherent, infinite dignity that remains intact regardless of their circumstances. In this context, bishops strongly oppose the Oireachtas Committee's proposal to Government to legislate for assisted suicide and call on support for healthcare workers who uphold the sanctity of life. To read Freedom to Live Fully, Until Death Comes and to watch Through the Valley, visit the following link: <https://www.catholicbishops.ie/2024/06/24/bishops-statement-on-end-of-life-care-freedom-to-live-fully-until-death-comes/>

The Catholic Communications Office of the Irish Bishops Conference: Produces a five-story weekly ezine Sharing Good News that reports on stories associated with the Bishops' Conference, activities in parishes and dioceses, and that celebrates Church life generally. If you

do not currently subscribe to receiving it and you wish to subscribe to receive Sharing Good News, please register your email address on <https://catholicnews.ie/newsletter/>

Errigal Hall Volunteers: For this hospitality to continue in the community, we need new volunteers to come forward and help in this voluntary service to the parish. If you are interested, please contact Melinda Robinson. If enough volunteers come forward a rota can be put in place via a WhatsApp group, so that the same people are not required at each function.

Errigal Hall: Parishioners who borrow items from the hall need to sign for their removal from the hall and when they are returned. The signing book is in the kitchen of the hall.



St. Joseph's Church: Choir Practice will take place each Tuesday at 7pm in the church. New members from Primary 4 up are very welcome. Any queries contact Roisin McIlvar [07841407154](tel:07841407154).

St. Mary's Church Choir: If you are interested in joining the choir, you are welcome to attend the practice in the church on a Wednesday evening at 7pm. Or contact any choir member.

Derry Diocesan Society (DDS): In each of the parishes of the diocese Mass is offered alternating in each parish (list at the back of each church) for deceased and living members who are registered in the society. The deceased members registered are remembered in the anniversary list for three consecutive weekends each quarter (three months). Registration is £20 and can be given to a sacristan or Fr. Crowley - please ensure name and address of the person to be enrolled is included and whether it is for a living or deceased member.

Maternity Blessing: Expectant mothers are welcome to receive a blessing in any of the sacristies following Mass - and a prayer card for their pregnancy.

Stamps: For the missions can be left at the back of each church.

Synodal Pathway: Find attached the final versions of the National Synthesis for the Church in Ireland, which is the fruit of the recent process of listening and consultation; it is based on the syntheses produced by the 26 dioceses in Ireland, as well as those submitted by religious congregations and other interested groups. Also attach appendix document from survivors of abuse and the Irish Bishops' Conference Cover Letter, which have all been forwarded to the General Secretariat of the Synod of Bishops. Press Release also attached. We are requested to bring the Report to the attention of your parishioners and to share it on your social media

outlets. It will be a useful tool as parishes move forward on the synodal journey in the autumn. **The Report is now available on the website of the Synodal Pathway of the Church in Ireland website: www.synod.ie**



Parish Envelopes: Following previous discussion with the Parish Finance Committee we encourage consideration for those who use envelopes infrequently to consider the use of a standing order, (through this medium you have full control), of the donation at your disposal. **Further information is available from the parish website.**

If you advance the standing order, (it can be processed on-line with your bank), or alternatively bring the completed mandate to your bank. We request that when you are issuing your instruction to the bank, that you do so with your personal name, in doing so we can therefore identify from whom the standing order has been authorised. It is with your authorisation that the standing order is either processed weekly or monthly. Also, you can withdraw the mandate at your own discretion. We would appreciate an acknowledgement of this transaction (via the parish email) when it is activated, so that we can have a copy for the parish records. In the information forwarded we will require your address and telephone number.

Several parishioners recently have set up a standing order, however we do not know who these parishioners are because they have not provided an address. We ask please that you follow the instructions above and email the parish to inform us who has authorised the standing order.

We request now that the boxes are delivered, if you have not previously returned or updated a parish Census card, please complete the card in the back of the box and return in the collection envelope. Also, the Gift Aid card needs to be signed and returned if you are a taxpayer.

Those who avail of Standing Orders are also asked to complete a Census card and Gift Aid card. These can be collected in each sacristy and returned at your convenience.

Details of Parish Accounts for Standing Orders:

(Errigal Ballerin: Sort Code - 950346 - Account No. 40067059 is the No 1 a/c) **Errigal Development:** Sort Code - 950346 - (Account No. 90042358 is the Renovation a/c).

(Errigal Glenullin: Sort Code - 950346 Account No. 90062596 is the No 1 a/c) **(Errigal Parish:** Sort Code 950689 - Account No. 90083712 is the Renovation a/c).

Parish Finance: If you wish to contribute to the parish by standing order - forms can be forwarded upon request by sending an email to - errigalparish@gmail.com or they are available on the parish website. At the end of each month, we shall include in the collection figures the amounts relating to the increase in standing orders, these figures are stated in brackets.

Parish Census: In the recent distribution of collection envelopes, we request that at your earliest convenience you might return the census card with your family details for parish registration. Also, the Gift Aid card needs to be updated and signed so that the parish can claim Gift Aid if you are a taxpayer, this does not affect your personal details or taxation. If your tax circumstances change, please inform us, if you are no longer a taxpayer.

Census cards are available in each sacristy, once completed they can be returned in a sealed envelope via the collection box at the back of each church. If you have previously registered, you do not have to do so again, unless your household occupation has changed.

Church Cleaners: Cleaners are required to join the existing monthly groups who clean each church. The more that participate the less occasions that individuals will be required to cover. If interested, please leave your name/contact phone number in each sacristy or alternatively give details to a sacristan.

Mass Cards/Mass Bouquets: Are available for sale at the back of each church please put the money in the candle box.

ACCORD - Counselling: If you need to speak, to an experienced couples and relationships counsellor during this time of unprecedented stress and pressure on family life, please contact 95680151. This is a free helpline service available from 9am - 8pm. Monday to Friday. All calls charged at local rate.

ACCORD DERRY: Virtual Interactive Marriage Preparation Programme (limited to 15 couples per course). Booking now online at www.accordni.com

Radio Maria Ireland: <https://www.radiomaria.ie/radio-maria-ireland/> is an Irish-run Catholic Talk-Radio Station with commercial-free broadcasting of Prayer, Catechesis, Music, Talks, Interviews and Testimonies.

Church Safeguarding: If you have any concerns with regard to Safeguarding children or adults in need of protection within the Church please contact: Mrs Marie O’Kane (Designated Liaison Person), Diocesan Pastoral Centre, 164 Bishop Street, Derry. Tel: 02871 - 362475/07596500793. Email: dlp@derrydiocese.org - or PSNI (Police Service of Northern Ireland) 101 or Social Services Tel: 02871-314090.

Parish Representatives - Tracey McGilligan and Clare Mullan.

Errigal Privacy Notice: The Diocese of Derry complies with GDPR regulations. A privacy notice is available on the Parish Website or alternatively it is available from the Parish Office. Live stream of Mass and Services in St. Mary’s Church and a Utube streaming in St. Joseph’s Church are available online. Parishioners should note that the first three rows of seats are visible in St. Mary’s Church.

BUNCRANA PARISH GARDEN FETE The Garden Fete will take place on Sunday 23rd August in the grounds of Scoil Mhuire from 3pm-6pm. See their Facebook page for more details. All welcome

ADORATION IN ST MURA'S PARISH CHURCH on Friday after the 10am Mass. All welcome.

PRAYER FOR VOCATIONS That the men called to priesthood will "...have a care for justice [and] act with integrity..." as they preach the message of God's salvation for everyone, the Good News that the Church is "...a house of prayer for all the peoples."

MARRIAGE ENRICHMENT WEEKEND hosted by Marriage Encounter Ireland takes place at the Focolare Centre, Curryhills, Prosperous, Co. Kildare, from Fri 2 to Sun 4 October. This is not a retreat in the traditional sense but is a positive, joy-filled experience, guided by presenting couples and a priest, in an atmosphere of warmth, prayer, and deep Christian faith. Couples are invited to register online at www.marriageencounter.ie

EMBRACE THE GRACE Young Adult Catholic Conference - 29 August 2026 - Legion of Mary: 'Embrace the Grace' is a conference on faith and culture for young adults (18-40) with talks, prayer, Mass, confession, workshops, food and social in the historic Legion of Mary headquarters at De Montfort House, North Brunswick Street, Dublin 7. This event is on Sat 30 August from 9.30am to 6pm with a social afterwards. Tickets cost €20 and can be booked on the eventbrite website by looking up 'Embrace the Grace'. Any queries can be directed towards deusetpatria@gmail.com.

ABIDE IN HIS LOVE WOMENS CONFERENCE The Great Northern Hotel, Bundoran, 20–22 Nov. Join women from across Ireland for a faith-filled weekend with inspiring speakers including Sarah Swafford, Danielle Noonan, Fr Mark Wharton, Fr Barry Braum, Fr Oisín Martin, the Dominican Sisters of Nashville, Bishop Fintan Gavin, and more. A conference not to be missed! Register now: <https://abideinhislove.eventbrite.com/>

THE NATIONAL NOVENA TO OUR LADY OF KNOCK takes place at Knock Shrine from Thursday 13 to Friday 21 August. Novena ceremonies will be celebrated daily at 3pm and 8pm, with workshops and guided prayer sessions also taking place throughout the nine days. This year's theme is **"Sheltered in God's Love."** See the full programme at: <https://www.knockshrine.ie/national-novena-2026-guest-speakers-and-programme/>

DONEGAL DOWN SYNDROME ASSOCIATION Annual church-gate collection will take place on the weekend of 29 /30 Aug. Anyone interested in helping on the day can contact the Donegal Down Syndrome Association office by email at info@donegal.downsyndrome.ie or call 0857870075. Your financial support for this important fundraising event would be greatly appreciated and will help in continuing to provide vital services and supports to children and adults with Down Syndrome and their families across Donegal.

BURT BINGO every Tuesday in St. Marys Hall, Burt at 9pm.

BURT'S BIG BINGO will take place Sunday 30th August at 3.00 pm in St. Mary's Hall, Burt. Two top prizes of €100. All other lines and houses are €25 and €50 respectively, except for the 9th page which is €50 for the line and €100 for the house. The sheet is €25 for the line and €100 for the house. Great raffle prizes drawn after every house. Book €12 and sheet €2. Proceeds to Parish funds. If you would like to donate prizes for the raffle contact Carmel, Ellen or contact Kathleen on 086 3931426

BURT GAA LOTTO 9-14-16-24-26 Mary Doherty and Mary Gallagher €50

LINE DANCING CLASS in St. Mary's Hall Burt every Thursday at 7.30pm. €7 per class.

SWILLY CEP are looking for grounds worker for Burt, Inch and Fahan graveyard. For information ring 0879392767

A HISTORY IN STONES This year Fahan Heritage Group invite you to explore our ancestry as told by stone on August 23 at 2.30pm at the old graveyard. After a guided tour seeing St Mura's Cross enjoy a talk on the rich history of the village dating back more than 1,000 years and its famous inhabitants and houses, followed by refreshments in St Mura's Church.

A FEAST OF FOLK MUSIC every Tuesday at 8pm. Song, story and Irish dance in the Cairn Greencastle Tel 074 9381104

Now Doc Phone Number: 0818400911. Have your Eircode handy.

PRIVACY NOTICE: The Diocese of Derry complies with GDPR regulations. A Privacy Notice is available on the Parish Website or by contacting The Parish Office. Live stream and recordings of Mass and Services in St Mura's Church and St Aengus' are available online. Parishioners should note that the first two rows of seats are visible online for both Churches.

Fahan Parish Newsletter

Weekly Collection
Burt €1009
Inch €628
Fahan €1099
Sincere Thanks

fahanparish@derrydiocese.org
www.fahanparish.com
16th August 2026
Twentieth Sunday In Ordinary Time

Fr Bradley 9363455
Fr Baker 9360151
Parish Office 9360151
(Mon-Thurs 10am-12:30pm)

Mass Schedule

St. Aengus' Burt
(churchservices.tv/burt)
Monday 17th Aug Mass at 10am
Saturday 22nd Aug Mass at 6.30pm
Mickey Donnelly 10th Anniversary Mass

Sunday 23rd Aug Mass at 10.15am
Paddy Whoriskey, Tillie Forshaw and Noel Sweeney
Anniversary Mass

St Mura's Church, Fahan
(churchservices.tv/fahan)
Wednesday 19th Aug Mass at 7pm
Daniel Breslin 1st Anniversary Mass

Friday 21st Aug Mass at 10am
Sunday 23rd Aug Mass at 11:30am
Martin Strain 11th Anniversary Mass
Michael Ryan 14th Anniversary Mass

Our Lady of Lourdes, Inch
Sunday 23rd Aug Mass at 9am

Chapel Of Ease, Fahan
Thursday 20th Aug Mass at 10am

JOB OPPORTUNITIES **Derry Diocesan Trust -**

Administrative & Financial Officer (18 hours per week), Waterside Parish,
Parochial House, 32 Chapel Road, Derry. Rate of pay: £12.88 per hr - £13.50 per hr.
For application packs please email: recruitment@derrydiocese.org or tel 048 7126 2302.
Completed applications must be returned to Personnel, Bishop's House, St Eugene's Cathedral, Francis Street, Derry, BT48 9AP or via email to recruitment@derrydiocese.org no later than 12 noon Monday 24 August 2026.
Derry Diocesan Trust is an Equal Opportunities Employer. We welcome applications from all men and women and from members of all communities.

CLIMB TO THE EUCHARISTIC CROSS

on Sunday 30th August meeting at the Water Tank at 1.30pm.
The Rosary will be said on the way up. All Welcome.

BAPTISMS

We welcome into God's family the following children who were baptised:
Arthur Edward Faulkner, Castle Park, Buncrana
Luca Christopher Brett, Baranduda, Victoria, Australia.
May God guide and protect our children always

DEATHS

Your prayers are asked for
Margaret Curran (nee Barr) Speenogue, Burt and
Vera McLaughlin, Tooban, Burnfoot
We pray for their families and friends saddened by their loss.

SAFEGUARDING NOTICE: If you have any concerns with regards to Safeguarding Children or adults in need of protection within the Church please contact Marie O'Kane, the Diocesan Designated Liaison Person (DLP) at 0044 7596500793, or at dlp@derrydiocese.org or **Garda Sióchána, Buncrana** 074 9320540 Letterkenny HQ 074 9167100 or **TUSLA Family & Child Agency** 07491 02233

Rev. Chris McDermott. Adm.

Tel: (028) 79401236

Email: christopher.mcdermott@derrydiocese.org

www.granaghanparish.com



Twenty-First Sunday in Ordinary Time

Sunday 23rd August 2026

PARISH OF GRANAGHAN

St Vincent De Paul Helpline: 07927900310

MASS TIMES FOR THE COMING WEEK:

Monday, Wednesday & Friday Mass
at 09:15am
Saturday (Vigil) at 4pm
Sunday Mass at 11am

GAMBLERS ANONYMOUS: Is gambling affecting your life? *We would like to help you.* Please pick up your phone and make contact - Tel: 028 7135 1329.

Drumnaph Nature Reserve

Forest Bathing Join us at Drumnaph for an immersive experience through guided sensory meditations, reconnect with the natural world and weave yourself back into nature! **Saturday 29 August | 10am - 12pm | £10**

An Carn

Irish Language Classes with an emphasis on conversational Irish and building self-confidence starting on **21st September in An Carn**. Classes in high demand. Booking online essential.

Introduction to Willow Weaving: Berry Basket Perfect for those looking to make their own Berry Basket just in time for Foraging season. **Saturday 5 September**

We welcome **Páidí Cameron** as a member of **God's Family**



Catholic Mothers Ireland - Family Day: Catholic Mothers Ireland will hold its Annual National Mass on Sunday, 6 September at Termonbacca Retreat Centre, Derry.

The day will begin with Mass at 2.00pm, celebrated by Bishop Donal McKeown, followed by refreshments, children's activities, and a talk for parents. This promises to be a lovely day for the whole family. For more information and booking details, please email info@catholicmothers.ie. **All are welcome.**

Diocesan Schools' Religious Education Conference 2026 - 'Drawing New Maps of Hope' The Derry Diocesan Catechetical Centre is delighted to be hosting its third Diocesan Schools' Religious Education Conference - 'Drawing New Maps of Hope'. **Tuesday 25th August** is the day for **Post-Primary Schools** and **Wednesday 26th August** is the day for **Primary Schools**. We are delighted to welcome **Dr Melodie Wyttenbach, Executive Director, Roche Centre for Catholic Education, Boston College** - keynote speaker. Bishop Donal McKeown will celebrate the Eucharist at the beginning of the conference each day. Alongside Dr Wyttenbach's keynote address, there will be 20 workshops, a panel discussion and the opportunity for attendees to meet and share their experiences and good practice. The conference begins at 9.30am and concludes at 3.00pm. **You are most welcome to call in to the conference at any stage over the two days.**

MARRIAGE ENRICHMENT WEEKEND - Hosted by **Marriage Encounter Ireland** will take place at the Focolare Centre, Curryhills, Prosperous, Co. Kildare, from Friday 2 to Sunday 4 October 2026. This Weekend is not a retreat in the traditional sense but is a positive, joy-filled experience, guided by presenting couples and a priest, in an atmosphere of warmth, prayer, and deep Christian faith. Couples are invited to register online

In this Sunday's gospel Peter acknowledges Jesus as the Christ, the Son of the living God, and Jesus confers on Peter "...the keys of the Kingdom..." an image reflected in the First Reading where the Lord says He will "...place the key of David..." on the shoulder of those called to lead His people, those who will be called "father." **Fr Pat O'Hagan**

GRANAGHAN & DISTRICT WOMEN'S GROUP

We are delighted to confirm that we have organised another fabulous Upcycling Furniture DEMO on Wednesday evening, September 9th, 7-9pm, approximately. The Demo will be delivered by Sandra Hyndman. This Demo is part of our Housing Executive funded "Upcycling Our Active Community!" project and is totally FREE to all attendees! Places however are limited and booking essential. Phone Ann McNicholl to enquire or book: 07714757643

Weekly Collection for Sunday 16th
Weekly: £1,103.90
Thank you
for your
generous support

Comhaltas Ceoltóirí Éireann, An Suaitreach - Musicians of Ireland

Registration now open for music classes beginning Wednesday 23rd September. Scan the code to find out more and to complete the registration form.

Closing date 11th September. To find out more and to complete the registration form. Contact - Comhaltas Ceoltóirí Éireann

Please note: Bulletin will not be printed for Sunday 30th August

Catholic Faith Sharing

GREENLOUGH PARISH. Mass Schedule/Notices: 24 - 30 August 2026**Twenty First Sunday in Ordinary Time****GREENLOUGH**

Tuesday 25 August: NO MASS; 7.30pm: Rosary
Thursday 27 August: 9.00am - 5.00pm Adoration
Friday 28 August: 9.30am Mass

Twenty Second Sunday in Ordinary Time

Saturday 29 August: 5.30pm (*Streamed to Bellaghy*)

Anniversary Mass for Kathleen McCloskey

50th Anniversary Mass for John Joseph McErlean

Sunday 30 August: 11.00am (*Streamed from Bellaghy*)

BELLAGHY

Monday 24 August: 9.30am Mass; **Wednesday 26 August:** 9.30am Mass
Friday 28 August: Adoration 10am - 7pm; Rosary at 6.30pm
Friday 28 August: 7.00pm Mass

Saturday 29 August: 5.30pm (*Streamed from Greenlough*)

Sunday 30 August: 11.00am (*Streamed to Greenlough*)

BALLYSCULLION

Sunday 30 August: 9.45am

Deaths: We offer our sympathy to the family and friends of Patsy McPeake, Mullaghnemoyagh Road, Manus McShane, Ballyscullion Lane and Gregory McErlean, USA, formerly Loughbeg Road, who died recently.

Anniversaries: Kelly Maria McGoldrick, Joe Picken, Patricia Campbell, Geraldine Maguire.

Vocations: In this Sunday's gospel Peter acknowledges Jesus as the Christ, the Son of the living God, and Jesus confers on Peter "...the keys of the Kingdom..." an image reflected in the First Reading where the Lord says He will "...place the key of David..." on the shoulder of those called to lead His people, those who will be called "father."

Greenlough Collections: 16/8/2026. Weekly/Monthly/Cash - £1121.86.

Catholic Mothers Ireland – Family Day: Catholic Mothers Ireland will hold its Annual National Mass on Sunday, 6 September at Termonbacca Retreat Centre, Derry. The day will begin with Mass at 2.00pm, celebrated by Bishop Donal McKeown, followed by refreshments, children's activities, and a talk for parents. For more information and booking details, please email info@catholicmothers.ie All are welcome.

Poor Clares Galway, Half-Day Retreat for Women 18-40 with Women's spirituality speaker Louise Mc Guinness, An opportunity to encounter God's love and deepen your life of prayer and communion with God. The event will take place from 2pm to 6pm on Sunday 6 September. For more information and to register: <https://cherisheddaughters.eventbrite.ie>

The Parish Office is currently closed but you can contact us via phone: 028 2582 1190. Email: greenloughparish@gmail.com or message us on our parish Facebook page.

Parish Newsletter: Please send Notices & Anniversaries in writing or via email to the parish office by 10.00am on Wednesday.

Blessing of Bikers and Motorcycles will take place on Sunday 13 September in St Aengus' Chapel, Burt, Co Donegal, at 1:30pm. All are welcome to attend the brief service and blessing. Following the blessing all are welcome to join the run to Ned's Point RNLI Station, to present the donation to the RNLI. Please note, Mass will be celebrated on Sunday 13 September in St Patrick's Chapel, DUNGIVEN, at 11:30am for deceased bikers, especially those who have died in past year.

OUR LADY OF MONTLIGEON PRAYER GROUP- praying for all the souls in Purgatory meets in Termonbacca, on the last Wednesday each month at 12:30pm. Also in St Joseph's Church Galliagh every Monday after 11am Mass.

RACHEL'S VINEYARD: Have you been hurt by abortion? Tel Michelle 07871765181.

GAMBLERS ANONYMOUS: Is gambling affecting your life? We would like to help. Pick up the phone and ring 028 7135 1329.

Accord Derry Marriage Preparation Workshops September 25th/26th November 20th/21st 2026 These courses are now online for booking at www.accordni.com

'Embrace the Grace' Young Adult Catholic Conference - 29 August 2026 - Legion of Mary: 'Embrace the Grace' is a conference on faith and culture for young adults (18-40) with talks, prayer, Mass, confession, workshops, food and social in the historic Legion of Mary headquarters at De Montfort House, North Brunswick Street, Dublin 7. It will be a chance to build faith in friendship with young adults from across the country. This event takes place on Saturday 30 August from 9.30am to 6.00pm with a social afterwards. Tickets cost €20 and can be booked on the eventbrite website by looking up 'Embrace the Grace'. Any queries can be directed towards deusetpatria@gmail.com.

MARRIAGE ENRICHMENT WEEKEND: Marriage Encounter Ireland invites married couples to a residential Weekend from Friday 2 to Sunday 4 October 2026 at the Focolare Centre, Curryhills, Prosperous, Co. Kildare. Step away from daily distractions to deepen your communication, renew your love, and rediscover the joy of your marriage. Visit www.marriageencounter.ie

SAFEGUARDING Any concerns with regard to the Safeguarding of children and Vulnerable Adults within the Church please contact Marie O'Kane, the Diocesan Designated Liaison Person (DLP) on +447596500793 or email: dlp@derrydiocese.org Northern Ireland emergency services PSNI (Police Service of Northern Ireland) 101 Social Services: Gateway Services, Western HSC Trust, 028 7131 4090 (and ask for the Duty Social Worker) Gateway Services, Northern HSC Trust 028 9442 4459 Regional Emergency Social Work Services 0800 1979 99

PRIVACY NOTICE The Diocese of Derry complies with GDPR regulations. A privacy notice is available on the Parish Website Live stream and recordings of Mass and Services in Holy Family Church are available on line. Parishioners should note that the first 2 rows of seats are visible on line.

Sun 23rd Aug

Vol 44 No 34

MASSES

Saturday Vigil 6.00pm

Sunday 9.30am, 11.00am, 12.30pm

Mon ,Wed ,Fri, Sat 10.00am Tues and Thurs 7.15pm

CONFESSIONS

Saturdays from 10.30am-11.30am & 5.15pm-5.50pm Tues ,Thurs 6.45pm – 7.10pm

Divine Mercy 3pm Monday– Friday

BAPTISMS

Saturday at 4.30pm

MARRIAGES

Three months notice and marriage preparation necessary

PAROCHIAL HOUSE

71267070

1 Aileach Road Ballymagroarty BT48 0AZ

Email: office@holyfamily-parish.com

Website: www.holyfamily-parish.com

Webcam: Click on website and follow the links

Parish Office 9.45am-1.45pm Mon– Fri

Parish Priest:
Fr Joseph Gormley

Curate
Fr Kevin Mulhern

CHILD SAFE GUARDING REFRESHER TRAINING

In 2023 all Parish Volunteers, Clergy and Employees received Child Safe guarding Training. It is necessary that this training is refreshed every three years. With this in mind all Parish Volunteers and Clergy and Employees are asked to attend refresher training in Holy Family Primary School on Thursday 10th September 2026 at 8.00pm. Please leave your name in the Parish Office to indicate your availability to attend.

SYMPATHY We offer our sympathy to the family of Charlene Tracey Dundrum Park who died during the week. May she rest in peace

BAPTISMS Our Parish family welcomes: Emmie Freda Smith, Pinetrees Hope Kathleen Mary McCay, Yeats Court

ANNIVERSARIES We pray for those whose anniversaries occur at this time Peter Curran, Colum Holloway, Fr Joe Carolan, Fr Pat McBride, Sarah Jane Campbell

SUNDAY COLLECTION 16th August £2606.20 Standing Orders £400 and €142.02 Thank you for your generosity

PRAYER FOR VOCATIONS TO THE DIOCESAN PRIESTHOOD In this Sunday's gospel Peter acknowledges Jesus as the Christ, the Son of the living God, and Jesus confers on Peter "...the keys of the Kingdom..." an image reflected in the First Reading where the Lord says He will "...place the key of David..." on the shoulder of those called to lead His people, those who will be called "father."

MESSAGE FROM FR ANSELM MEO who was here a number of years ago. 'I am writing to you asking for your support for us. As you have known recently Flores island in Indonesia has been hit by earthquake in Saturday, August 15th, 2026. Up to now, the earthquake still going on and we live in tents due to the condition of the old parochial house. We are far away from the centrum of earthquake which is in Nagekeo Regency in central of Flores. I now work in Datak Parish of Labuan Bajo Diocese. Some of the members of my family are in Mbay and they all in refugees without home. I, therefore on behalf of me and our parishioners and the people in Archdiocese of Ende, come to you Father and the parishioners of Holy Family, asking for support'. Envelopes will be available at Masses next weekend for anyone who would like to contribute.

LEGION OF MARY meets on Wednesday evenings at 5.45pm. Anyone willing to do Our Lady's work is asked to call Patricia on 02871417867

ST JOSEPH MEN'S CAMINO Join men from across Ireland on Saturday 12th September for a 25km pilgrimage through the Boyne Valley, beginning in Drogheda. The day includes Mass, Adoration, Rosary, Confessions, fraternity, lunch and dinner, with after-dinner speaker Fr. Mark Quinn. Open to men aged 18+. Cost: €65 (student € 55). Registration, details www.dominicans.ie/events. Enquiries: op.evangelisation@gmail.com.

ANAM CARA Bereavement Information Evening especially dedicated to supporting surviving siblings Tuesday 15 September at 7pm. As part of our commitment to supporting everyone following the death of a child, we are exploring opportunities to further support the entire family. This event is the first, hopefully of many, of that commitment. This event is open to all parents whose child or children have died, regardless of the age of their child, circumstances of their death, or time since bereavement. We are also opening this Bereavement Information Evening to bereaved adult siblings over 18.

Blessing of Bikers and Motorcycles will take place on Sunday 13 September in St Aengus' Chapel, Burt, Co Donegal, at 1:30. All are welcome to attend the brief service and blessing. Following the blessing all are welcome to join the run to Ned's Point RNLI Station, to present the donation to the RNLI. Please note, Mass will be celebrated on Sunday 13 September in St Patrick's Chapel, DUNGIVEN, at 11:30am for deceased bikers, especially those who have died in past year.

MICHAEL ENGLISH CHURCH CONCERT: An evening of Faith, Hope and Inspiration. The concert takes place on Friday 2 October at 7.15pm, in St Patrick's Church, Keenaught, Desertmartin. Tickets are £30, and available Desertmartin Parish offices, or online with Eventbrite:

BUNCRANA GARDEN FETE 2026: The Annual Garden Fete will take place this Sunday, 23 August, from 3.00 - 6.00pm in the grounds of Scoil Mhuire, Buncrana. with Bouncy Castles, Mechanical Bull, Petting Farm, Facepainting, and other activities All welcome.

Catholic Mothers Ireland – Family Day: Catholic Mothers Ireland will hold its Annual National Mass on **Sunday, 6 September** at **Termonbacca**. The day will begin with **Mass at 2.00pm**, celebrated by **Bishop Donal McKeown**, followed by refreshments, children's activities, and a talk for parents. For more information and booking details, please email info@catholicmothers.ie. All are welcome.

IMPORTANT NOTICE - OUR DIOCESAN DESIGNATED PERSON
SAFEGUARDING REPRESENTATIVE IS: Marie O'Kane
Telephone: (044)7596500793. Email: dlp@derrydiocese.org

EXPOSITION OF THE BLESSED SACRAMENT: After the 10.00 a.m. Mass in Iskaheen on Tuesday until 2.00 p.m. **CHAPLET OF DIVINE MERCY:** After the 10.00 a.m. Mass in Muff on Thursday.

PARISH DRAW RESULTS - WEEK 43: €300 – Siobhan O'Hagan, Sappagh, €200 – Margaret Doherty, Ballyboe, €100 – Anne Marie McGill, Aught.

SCOIL NAOMH FIONÁN & SCOIL NAOMH BRÍD

Scoil Naomh Fionán and Scoil Naomh Bríd will re-open shortly for the New School Year. Welcome back to all the pupils and staff and a **BIG WELCOME** to our Junior Infants, and all new members of staff.

Blessing of Bikers and Motorcycles will take place on Sunday 13 September in St Aengus' Chapel, Burt, Co Donegal, at 1:30. All are welcome to attend the brief service and blessing. Following the blessing all are welcome to join the run to Ned's Point RNLI Station, to present the donation to the RNLI. Please note, Mass will be celebrated on Sunday 13 September in St Patrick's Chapel, DUNGIVEN, at 11:30am for deceased bikers, especially those who have died in the past year.

BUNCRANA GARDEN FETE 2026: The Annual Garden Fete will take place this Sunday, 23 August, from 3.00 - 6.00pm in the grounds of Scoil Mhuire, Bunrana F93 PN53. Fun for all the family with Bouncy Castles, Mechanical Bull, Petting Farm, Facepainting, Bingo, Rickety Wheel, Children's Games, Raffle Prizes and more. Entry €5pp or €15 per family (cash only). All welcome.

DONEGAL DOWN SYNDROME ASSOCIATION Annual church-gate collection will take place next weekend of 29 /30 August.

SIGNED MASS CARDS AND MASS BOUQUETS AVAILABLE IN ISKAHEEN PAROCHIAL HOUSE AND DRUNG SACRISTY.

To book Weddings, Baptisms, Month's Mind Masses, Anniversary Masses, contact Anne at the Parish Office on 9384037.

PARISH OF ISKAHEEN & UPPER MOVILLE

Iskaheen, Drung & Muff Churches
(*St. Patrick's, St. Columba's & Sacred Heart*)

Twenty-First Sunday in Ordinary Time

Parish Priest: Fr. John Farren P.P. - Tel: 9384037
Parish Secretary: Mrs Anne Clarke 10.00 a.m.- 2.00 p.m.
(Tuesday to Friday - Tel: 9384037)

E-mail: iskaheenparish@derrydiocese.org

Websites: www.iskaheenparish.com & www.stcolumbasdrung.net

Live Streaming www.mcn.live

Scoil Naomh Fionán, Principal: Mr Patrick Patton - Tel: 9383228.

Scoil Naomh Bríd, Principal: Mr Gary Foster - Tel: 9384136.

(Drung Saint Vincent de Paul Telephone Number: 086 4079904)

(Muff Saint Vincent de Paul Telephone Number: 086 3040627)

23rd August 2026 - Year A - Schedule for the Coming Week

MASS TIMES:	DRUNG	ISKAHEEN	MUFF
Saturday: (Vigil):	5.00 p.m.	-----	6.30 p.m.
Sunday: (Morning)	10.15 a.m.	9.00 a.m.	11.30 a.m.

DRUNG	ISKAHEEN	MUFF
Monday 24 th August : 10.00 a.m.	-----	-----
Tuesday 25 th August: -----	10.00 a.m.	-----
Wednesday 26 th August: 10.00 a.m.	-----	-----
Thursday 27 th August: 12.00 p.m.	-----	10.00 a.m.
Friday 28 th August: 1.00 p.m.	-----	10.00 a.m.
Saturday 29 th August: 5.00 p.m.	1 pm /10 am. ES	6.30 p.m.

CONFESSIONS: DRUNG

Before 5.00 p.m. Mass on Saturday

CONFESSIONS: MUFF

Before 6.30 p.m. Mass on Saturday

NB THE NEXT ST. PEREGRINE NOVENA MASS & BLESSING WITH THE RELIC WILL BE HELD ON FRIDAY 11th SEPTEMBER IN ST. PATRICK'S CHURCH, ISKAHEEN AT 7.00 P.M.

Parish of Kilrea & Desertohill

Rev. Christopher McDermott
Parish Secretary: Mrs Kim Convery



Twenty-First Sunday of The Year

23rd August 2026

www.parishofkilrea.com

E-mail: parishofkilrea@btinternet.com

Facebook: *Parish of Kilrea & Desertohill*

Telephone: 028 29540343

Errigal: 028 29558251

Vigil Mass (Sat) 7pm at Saint Anne's Oratory – Sunday 10am at Drumagarner – Sunday 12noon at Craigavole

Weekday Masses

No Weekday Masses during week beginning
24th August.

Weekend Masses at usual times.

Weekday schedule resumes Monday 31st Aug.

In Remembrance of

May McKendry, Johnny Maxwell, Sarah
McCloskey, James Darragh, Tommy Cassidy,
Josephine Bradley and Marie O'Boyle.
whose anniversaries occur at this time.

Eternal rest grant unto them, O Lord.

Our parish family welcomes
Nuala Rose McWilliams
who was baptised recently.



May she always walk as a child the light!

Kilrea GAC News

Lottery result 13th August: 4,5,14,25.

No Winner £3,800

£25 – Declan McAlary (Lisgorgan)

£25 – Colleen Glendinning

Next Jackpot is £3,850.

Tickets on Klubfunder.

Last week's collection amounted to £2,190.

Thank You

First Anniversary Mass for **John Joe Cuning**

Sunday 06th September at 10am in
Drumagarner.

Vocations: In this Sunday's gospel Peter acknowledges Jesus as the Christ, the Son of the living God, and Jesus confers on Peter "...the keys of the Kingdom..." an image reflected in the First Reading where the Lord says He will "...place the key of David..." on the shoulder of those called to lead His people, those who will be called "father." ...Fr Pat O'Hagan.

MICHAEL ENGLISH CHURCH CONCERT

An evening of Faith, Hope and Inspiration. The concert takes place on Friday 2 October at 7.15pm, in St Patrick's Church, Keenaught, Desertmartin. Tickets are £30, and available to buy at Herons Gift Shop, Draperstown, Moneyneena Post Office, Ballinascreen and Desertmartin Parish offices, or online with Eventbrite: <https://www.eventbrite.co.uk/e/michael-english-band-fundraising-concert-tickets-1996641829460>

Blessing of Bikers and Motorcycles will take place on Sunday 13 September in St Aengus' Chapel, Burt, Co Donegal, at 1:30. All are welcome to attend the brief service and blessing. Following the blessing all are welcome to join the run to Ned's Point RNLI Station, to present the donation to the RNLI. Please note, Mass will be celebrated on Sunday 13 September in St Patrick's Chapel, DUNGIVEN, at 11:30am for deceased bikers, especially those who have died in past year.

Readers for

29th Aug/ 30th Aug

7pm:

Aileen McKee

10am:

Danny McMullan

12noon:

Helen McKenna

Eucharistic Adoration

Monday Exposition of
the Blessed Sacrament
will pause during July &
August for the summer
break.

Weekly adoration
resumes on Monday 7th
September.



Monday 24th August	9.15 am Mass
Wednesday 26th August	9.15 am Mass
Thursday 27th August	9.15 am Mass
Friday 28th August	9.15 am Mass

***Adoration will begin after morning Mass
and conclude at 5.00 pm.***

22nd Sunday in Ordinary Time

Saturday 29th August	5:15 pm - 5:45 pm - Confessions 6:00 pm Mass
Sunday 30th August	9:00 pm Mass 11:00 am Mass

ICE-CREAM SUNDAY

Saturday 5th & Sunday 6th September

All Weekend Masses will be celebrated
in Lavey/Termoneeny Centre.

All Proceeds in aid of Parish Funds.
All Welcome!



Parish Collections: Sunday 16th August

Weekly: **£1130.50**
Building: **£1067.00**
Loose Coin: **£525.40**

Thank you for your continued support!



Parishes of Camus, Clonleigh and Leckpatrick
Twenty-First Sunday in Ordinary Time – Year A – 23rd August 2026

Parish Clergy

Fr Michael McCaughey, PP: (028) 71882274 / (028) 71882215

Fr Declan Boland (priest in residence)

Email: leckpatrickparish@derrydiocese.org; **Website:** www.leckpatrickparish.com

Email: strabaneparish@derrydiocese.org; **Website:** www.camusparish.com

Email: clonleighparish@derrydiocese.org; **Website:** www.clonleighparish.com

Thoughts on the Gospel (Matthew 14:13-21)

In today's gospel, Jesus asks His disciples a very personal question about who they believe He is. Many people had different opinions about Him, but Jesus wanted His followers to speak from their own faith and experience. Peter answers with confidence, recognising Jesus as the promised Saviour and the Son of God.

This passage reminds us that faith cannot depend only on what others believe. We may learn about God from our parents, teachers, friends or church community, but each of us must eventually make our own response to Jesus. The word **ROCK** helps us remember the message. We are called to **RECOGNISE** Jesus as Lord and Saviour, **OWN** our faith through daily choices, **COMMIT** to the calling God gives us, and **KEEP** standing firm when life becomes difficult.

Peter was not perfect, yet Jesus still used him for a great purpose. In the same way, God can work through our weaknesses and help us become part of His mission. When we build our lives on Christ, our faith becomes stronger, our hope grows deeper, and our lives show the answer to Jesus' question. Our response should not be seen only in our words, but also in how we love, forgive, serve, and remain faithful. Christ is the true foundation, and when we stand on Him, life's storms may shake us, but they cannot destroy the hope He gives.

Lord Jesus, you are the Messiah, the Son of the living God. Strengthen our faith to confess You with courage. May nothing overcome the hope we have in You.

Camus / Leckpatrick Parish Draw is on Thursday 27th August at 7.30 pm in the Parochial House, Ballymagorry. Outstanding payments can be made to your promoter or at pastoral office. Good luck everyone and thanks for all the support.

Parish Bingo and Lucky Four A warm welcome to all to St Patrick's Hall every Thursday at 8.00 pm for bingo and lucky four. Come along for some fun and excitement and of course slight competition.

Donegal Down Syndrome Association Annual Church Gate Collection takes place on 29th/30th August at St Patrick's Murlog. Anyone interested in helping can contact info@donegal.downsyndrome.ie or 0857870075. Your financial support for this important fundraising event would be greatly appreciated and will help in continuing to provide vital services and supports to children and adults with Down syndrome and their families across Donegal. Thank you.

Embrace the Grace Legion of Mary Young Adult (18-40) Catholic Conference on Saturday 29th August from 9.30 am - 6 pm at De Montfort House, Morning Star Ave, Dublin, D07 VA03. Tickets from www.eventbrite. Search Embrace the Grace.

Requiescant in Pace We offer our sympathy to the family and friends of
John Duncan, Church View, Strabane
Michael (Mixer) McCrossan, Marian Park, Strabane
Jane Friel, Drumbuoy, Lifford
Anthony McGillian, Innisfree Gardens, Strabane
Stephen Hannigan, Castlevue, Newtown Stewart
Gerard McShane, Belfast / Strabane

Anniversaries Paul Bradley, Columba Burns, Packie Conwell, Davy Crotty, Agnes Deazley, Elizabeth Devine, Dennis Devlin, Rosaleen Doherty, Gillian Gallagher, Moya Gallagher, Philomena Gallagher, James Houston, Sr Magdalene Joyce, Harry Kielty, Michael (Micky) Lynn, Mary McConnell, Agnes McCosker, George McCosker, Ken McCrory, Arthur McDaid, Edward McDaid, Patsy McElroy (Snr), Susan McGinnis, George McLaughlin, Joan McNulty, Tommy Melaugh, Jim Montague, Betty O'Doherty, Kathleen Tinney

9.45am Mass on Sundays in Murlog Chapel is live on Finn Valley Community Radio.

Thank You for your generosity to last week's collections:

Leckpatrick: £1,509.91

Clonleigh: €1,257.95

Camus: £1,784.29

Thanks to those who pay by standing order.

Readings for Sunday 30th August:

1st Reading: Jeremiah 20:7-9

Psalm: 62:2-6,8-9

2nd Reading: Romans 12:1-2

Gospel: Matthew 16:21-27

Saints of The Coming Week:

Monday: St Bartholomew, Apostle

Tuesday: St Joseph Calasanz, priest; St Louis

Thursday: St Monica

Friday: St Augustine, bishop & doctor of the Church

Saturday: The Passion of St John the Baptist, martyr

Encounter School of Ministry Course is launching in All Saints Church, Newtowncunningham in Sept. This course draws from the richness of our Catholic heritage as we seek to teach, equip, and activate disciples to demonstrate the love of God through the power of the Holy Spirit in their spheres of influence. Please email donegal@encounterschool.org to attend or visit www.encounterschool.org

Derry Diocesan Trust Job Opportunity Administrative & Financial Officer (18 hrs pw), Waterside Parish, Derry. Rate of pay: £12.88 - £13.50 per hour. Please contact recruitment@derrydiocese.org or 028 71262302. Closing date: 24/8/26.

Personal Assistants Wanted The Churches Trust is recruiting people for flexible part time work supporting and befriending elderly people living independently at home. No experience required – training and support provided. Full clean driving licence and access to a vehicle is required. For more information, call 02871 311322.

Medjugorje Pilgrimage 23rd - 30th Sept. Cost: £775 pps. Dublin - Dubrovnik return. Single room £150. Call Anne 07736005396 to book / details.

NI Blood Transfusion Service will collect blood donations at Kilfennan Presbyterian Church, Rosstown Rd, Derry, BT47 6FP on Monday 7th September from 12.30 pm - 4.00 pm & 5.00 pm - 7.00 pm. Please freecall 08085534653 to book.

Lough Derg Annual Fundraising Draw to ensure Station Island remains open for future generations. Single ticket: €10. Book of 6: €50. Buy a full book and you're entered into a sellers' draw. Return a complete book for Early Bird draw on 28/8/26. Tickets from www.loughderg.org/store/c3/annualdraw or +353 (0) 719861518 or info@loughderg.org Draw date: 23/10/26.

Moneyglass Bowling Club will hold their singles tournament at Moneyglass Community Centre, 10 Loughbeg Rd, Toomebridge, BT41 3TN from 31st August - 5th September at 7.30 pm. Final on 5th September. To enter, contact Henry on 07784286048 or 028 79650382 or henrymarron65@gmail.com All welcome.

Gamblers Anonymous Tel 71351329. **Alcoholics Anonymous** Tel 90351222.

Please Pray for Vocations Visit <https://derryvocations.org>

Sharing the Good News Visit <https://theway.ie/ezine-2/> for the weekly ezine.

Family Carers Ireland are running 1:1 support clinics remotely every Tuesday in August for carers, offering you a space and time to talk over the phone in the comfort of your own home. Contact 0868363842 or Donegalcs@familycarers.ie

Lough Derg Day Retreats August 29 & 31; Sept 5, 6, 9, 12, 15, 19, 20. Take time away from the busyness of life for a day of guided prayer, quiet reflection and spiritual renewal in the peaceful surroundings of Lough Derg. Visit www.loughderg.org

Accord Derry Marriage Preparation Course for those getting married in late 2026 / early 2027. You can register online at www.accordni.com Next dates are September 25th/26th 2026 & November 20th/21st 2026. Please note that Accord Derry will NOT be facilitating courses during October or December 2026.

Marriage Enrichment Weekend Marriage Encounter invites married couples to a residential weekend from 2nd - 4th October at the Focolare Centre, Prosperous, Kildare. Step away from daily distractions to deepen your communication, renew your love, and rediscover the joy of your marriage. Visit www.marriageencounter.ie

St Joseph's Men's Camino 2026 A Day of pilgrimage, prayer, brotherhood and renewal on Saturday 12th September. Step away from the demands of everyday life and spend a day walking with Christ alongside other Catholic men. Inspired by the ancient tradition of pilgrimage, St Joseph Men's Camino is a 25km guided pilgrimage along the beautiful Boyne Valley Camino. Open to men aged 18 and over. Cost €65 (includes lunch @ dinner). Students: €55. Visit www.dominicans.ie

Coffee Morning in Aid of Foyle Hospice Join us on Friday 25th September from 9.30am - 12.30pm at Murphy's on the Green. Prize draw: £1 per line. All welcome.

Michael English Church Concert - An Evening of Faith, Hope and Inspiration on Friday 2nd Oct at 7.15 pm in St Patrick's Church, Keenaught, Desertmartin. Tickets (£30) available at Heron's Gift Shop, Draperstown, Moneyneena PO, Ballinascreen, Desertmartin Parish or from: <https://www.eventbrite.co.uk/e/michael-english-band-fundraising-concert-tickets-1996641829460>

Buncrana Annual Garden Fete today (Sunday) from 3 - 6 pm in grounds of Scoil Mhuire, Buncrana, F93 PN53. Fun for all the family with Bouncy Castles, Mechanical Bull, Petting Farm, Facepainting, Bingo, Rickety Wheel, Children's Games, Raffle Prizes, etc. Entry €5pp / €15 per family (cash only). All welcome.

Catholic Mothers Ireland Family Day takes place on Sunday 6th September at Termonbacca Retreat Centre, Derry, beginning with the National Mass at 2 pm, celebrated by Bishop McKeown, followed by refreshments, children's activities, and a talk for parents. This promises to be a lovely day for the whole family. For information / to book, please email info@catholicmothers.ie All welcome.

RISE A vital new community initiative, RISE is dedicated to supporting the families, friends, and loved ones of those living with addiction. A gathering takes place on Sunday 13th Sept - 12 noon - 4 pm in Everglades Hotel, Derry, aiming to bring together people who may feel isolated, overwhelmed, or unaware of the support structures available to them as they navigate a loved one's addiction. The foundational message of RISE is that recovery and healing involve the whole family. The day is designed to serve as a safe, welcoming space where people can share experiences, build meaningful connections, and discover where they can turn for help. To secure your place, send a direct message via facebook messenger to the official page.

The Contemplative Prayer Group meets on Mondays at 8 pm in the Prayer Room in the Parochial House, Barrack St. All welcome.

Reflections Through Poetry book by Fr John P Forbes available in Pastoral Office. Cost: £10. Proceeds to Children in Crossfire and Cause for Sr Clare's Canonisation.

Alzheimer's Society is running a Carers' Information Support Programme (CRISP) for family, carers and friends of people living with dementia in Omagh area. The programme is run over 2 sessions; attendees should attend both afternoons. Dates: 7th and 8th September 2026 3-5pm In the Conference Room, Silver Birch Hotel, 5 Gortin Road, Omagh. To register, please contact Julie-Anne, Senior Dementia Adviser. M:07889 604702. Registration is required prior to attendance.

Weekend Mass Schedule

Immaculate Conception: Saturday Vigil: **4.30 pm**; Sunday: **11.00 am**

Sacred Heart, Derry Road: Sunday: **12.15 pm**

St Patrick's, Clonleigh: Saturday Vigil: **6.30 pm**; Sunday: **9.45 am**

St Mary's, Cloughcor: Sunday: 8.30 am (23rd August - alternate Sundays – 6th Sept)

St Joseph's, Glenmornan: Sunday: 8.30 am (30th Aug - alternate Sundays - 13th Sept)

Weekday Mass Schedule

Monday: **8.00 am:** Sacred Heart Church, Derry Road

10.00 am: St Patrick's Church, Lifford

Tuesday: **10.00 am:** Immaculate Conception Church, Strabane

Wednesday: **8.00 am:** Sacred Heart Church, Derry Road

(followed by **Eucharistic Adoration** until 5.30 pm).

10.00 am: St Patrick's Church, Lifford

Thursday: 10.00 am: Immaculate Conception Church, Strabane
Friday: 8.00 am: Sacred Heart Church, Derry Road
10.00 am: Immaculate Conception Church, Strabane

Weddings Please contact the parish office. At least 6 months' notice required.

Baptisms: Parent(s) are asked to contact the parish office.

The Parish Pastoral Area Office, 27 Butcher St, Strabane covers all 3 parishes.
Office hours: Monday – Thursday: 9.30 am - 4.30 pm; Friday: 9.30 am - 12.30 pm.
Please feel free to call in or phone on 028 7188 2215.

Reminder that the deadline for parish bulletin notices is 2 pm on Wednesdays.

A Small Collection of Candles is available for purchase at the Pastoral Office.

A gentle reminder that we can only accept cash or cheque payments. Thank you.

Safeguarding (Northern Ireland) If you have any concerns with regard to the Safeguarding of Children or Adult at risk of harm or Adult in need of protection within the Church please contact Marie Gormley, the Diocesan Designated Liaison Person (DLP) on 07596 500793 or at marie.gormley@derrydiocese.org To report a safeguarding suspicion, concern, knowledge or allegation directly to the statutory authorities please contact PSNI on 101, Western HSCT Children's Gateway Services on 028 71 314090, WHSCT Adult Gateway Services on 028 71 611366 or the Regional Emergency Social Work Service on 028 95 049999.

Safeguarding (Republic of Ireland) If you have any concerns with regard to the Safeguarding of Children or Vulnerable Adults within the Church please contact Marie Gormley, the Diocesan Designated Liaison Person (DLP) on +44 7596 500793 or at marie.gormley@derrydiocese.org To report a safeguarding suspicion, concern, knowledge or allegation directly to the statutory authorities please contact Garda Síochána Buncrana on 074 93 20540, Garda Síochána Letterkenny on 074 91 67100, TUSLA (ROI) Child and Family Agency on 074 91 02233 or HSC Adult Safeguarding, Donegal on 071 983 4660.

Fr. Patrick Doherty 79642496 / Fr. Kieran O'Doherty 79642359
 Sacristans: Glen 79643131/Maghera 79643061 Web Cam www.mcnmedia.live
 Baptisms: 79642983(Notification by Thursday) Pastoral Centre:79642983
 Pilgrim Statue: 79642983 / St Vincent de Paul Helpline: 07752111032
 PARISH FACEBOOK PAGE – www.facebook.com/magheraparish

It's a useful way to stay up to date with all our parish events. Please hit the 'Follow' button and we would be grateful if you could like and share our posts.

Sunday:	St Patrick's St Mary's	9.30am Vigil 6.30am and Sunday 11.30am Wednesday 7.30pm and Friday 10.00am
Daily Mass	St Patrick's	Monday to Thursday 9.30am Friday 7.30pm (Mass for all deceased) Daily Rosary at 9.10am

In this Sunday's gospel, Peter acknowledges Jesus as the Christ, the Son of the living God, and Jesus confers on Peter "the keys of the Kingdom" "an image reflected in the First Reading where the Lord was, He will" place the key of David on the shoulder of those called to Lead His people, those who will be called "father".
Rev. Pat O'Hagan

DERRY DIOCESAN SOCIETY – 9.30am Mass on Saturday 5 September will be offered for all Members of Derry Diocesan Society.

HOLY FACE OF JESUS - Prayers every Tuesday after 9.30am Mass and Divine Mercy.

<u>FEASTS:</u>	Thursday	27 August: St Monica
	Friday	28 August: St Augustine
	Saturday	29 August: The Passion of St John the Baptist

TRÓCAIRE – Thank you all for taking the time and care to give £12,100 to Trocaire this Lent and help Uwamahoro family's build a better life beyond poverty and climate injustice. Yor generosity and grace will forever be part of their story. Thank you so much Fr. Doherty, and the people of Maghera Parish. We'd be lost without your love. Seán Farrell (CEO, Trocaire)

LEGION OF MARY, Maghera is organising a trip to Knock on Sunday 27 September 2026. The Bus will leave Glen chapel at 7am and travel via Dungiven. Cars can be parked in the Chapel car park. We usually return to Glen around 10pm. The fare which will be £25 will be collected on the bus. Bring a packed lunch. We will get the 50 - seater bus which is more comfortable if we have sufficient numbers. To book your seat phone 796742983 or 07748273706 before 24 September. (leave a message if no reply). There will be a toilet stop in Bundoran on the way down and a longer stop on the way home. Food of your choice can be had in any of the local hotels or cafes.

'Embrace the Grace' Young adult Catholic Conference – 29 August – Legion of Mary:

'Embrace the Grace' is a conference on faith and culture for young adults (18-40) with talks, prayer, Mass, confession, workshops, food and social in the historic Legion of Mary headquarters at De Montfort House, North Brunswick Street, Dublin 7. It will be a chance to build faith in friendship with young adults from across the country. Any queries can be directed to: deusetpatria@mail.com

ENVELOPE COLLECTION Thank you for last week's envelope collections of £3,484. We appreciate your support to the church and for bringing your envelopes and donations to the church and pastoral centre. May your generosity be rewarded. Anyone wishing to donate to Maghera parish may do so by visiting website: magheraparishderry.com and using donate button

SENIORS TUESDAY CLUB In Fairhill Youth Centre on Tuesdays at 10.30am

GLEN GAA Website www.wattvgrahamsgac.com Lotto Numbers 42:29:23:48:

No winner. Next week £9,500 4 winners of £50: Terence Regan: Mary Mallon: Paul Hurley and Sinead McGill. Flyover next week £16,500 in 45 Numbers or less.

FALLAGHLOON HALL - BINGO- Sunday night 7.30pm. Jackpot £500 in 45 numbers.

AN CARN - Introduction to Willow Weaving a berry basket. Perfect for those looking to make their own berry basket just in time for foraging season! Saturday 5 Sept 9.30am – 5.00pm at An Carn 18+ Cost £25. **Live Music: Na Leanai** - The children and grandchildren of the Sands Family, a name synonymous with Irish folk music for generations, are joining us at An Coire for a special night of music you don't want to miss! Sat 12 Sept. Doors open at 7.00pm. Cost £16. Under 16s free.

Drumnaph Nature Reserve - Forest Bathing – Join us at Drumnaph for an immersive experience through guided sensory meditations, re-connect with the natural world and weave yourself back into nature! Saturday 29 August 10.00am – 12noon. Cost £10.

Irish Language Classes: – with an emphasis on conversational Irish and building self-confidence - on 21 September in An Carn. Classes in high demand. Booking essential.

OUT & ABOUT COMMUNITY TRANSPORT. – Looking for a wee lift out – hospital/ GP appointments, essential shopping, social outings, visiting family, dentist/eye appointments, community events etc. call **Out & About**, Unit15, Station Road Industrial Estate, Magherafelt BT45 5EY – Just telephone 028 79300123 info@outandaboutct.org

GRANAGHAN & DISTRICT WOMEN'S GROUP – We are delighted to confirm that we organised another fabulous upcycling Furniture DEMO on Wed 9 September from 7pm to 9pm, approximately. The Demo will be delivered by Sandra Hyndman. This Demo is part of our housing Executive funded Upcycling Our Active Community! project and is totally FREE to all attendees! Places however are limited and booking essential Phone Ann McNicholl to enquire book - 07714757643

DEERRY DIOCESAN TRUST = SACRISTAN REQUIRED – for St John the Baptist Church, Granaghan, Swatragh. Rate of pay £12.88 per hour. 12 Hours per week. For application packs contact: Bishop's Office, St Eugene's Cathedral, Francis Street, Derry BT48 9AP – Telephone 02871262302 or email: recruitment@derrydiocese.org

FUNDRAISING CONCERT – MICHAEL ENGLISH & BAND - in St Patrick's Church, Keenaught on Friday 2 October. Commences 8pm. Doors open 7.15pm. Tickets £30. Book online with Eventbrite (<https://www.eventbrite.co.uk>) Search for: Michael English, Keenaught.

CATHOLIC MOTHERS IRELAND FAMILY DAY: Catholic Mothers Ireland will hold its Annual National Mass on Sunday 6 September at Termonbacca Retreat Centre, Derry. The day will begin with Mass at 2pm, celebrated by Bishop Donal McKeown, followed by refreshments, children's activities and a talk for parents. This promises to be a lovely day for the whole family. For more information and booking details, please email: info@catholicmothers.ie All welcome!

15th Sunday in Ordinary Time (Year A)

12 July 2026

The Soil of Our Lives

This Sunday Jesus tells us the parable of the sower. It is one of the most familiar stories in the Gospels. A farmer scatters seed. Some falls on the path, some on rocky ground, some among thorns, and some on rich soil. Only the rich soil produces a harvest.

Anyone who has ever grown anything in soil knows that you can have the best seed in the world, but if the ground isn't ready, nothing will come of it. The work is in the preparation. The digging, the clearing, the weeding. It is slow and unspectacular, and nobody sees it. But it makes all the difference.

Isaiah reminds us this weekend that God's Word never returns to Him empty. Like the rain and the snow that water the earth, His word always accomplishes what it was sent to do. The seed is never the problem. God is endlessly generous. He scatters His grace everywhere, on all of us, without measure and without favourites. The question the parable puts to each of us is a simple one: what kind of ground is He landing on?

Every one of us has been planted with gifts. Gifts of faith, of kindness, of patience, of prayer. Some of them are lying dormant because the soil of our lives has become hardened, or crowded, or shallow. The worries of the week, the busyness, the old hurts we haven't let go of — these are the thorns and the stones. They don't destroy the seed. They just stop it growing.

The good news is that soil can always be worked: A little time in prayer each day. An honest look at what is choking the Word in us. A return to the Sacraments. Small, quiet acts of clearing the ground! When we do

that, our roots go down deeper into God, and we find a steadiness that the heat of life cannot wither.

St Paul tells us the whole of creation is groaning, waiting to be set free. That freedom begins in small plots of ground, that is in hearts like yours and mine that let the Word take root and grow.

So this week, ask the Lord: what needs clearing in me? Then let Him in with the spade! The harvest He promises is thirty, sixty, a hundredfold.

Fr Sean

FATIMA PILGRIMAGE

I'm in Fatima with Fr Stephen Baxter (our newly ordained) and 60 others from our Parishes and others in Fatima. Please be assured of our prayers at all our Masses, Rosaries and Processions for you all and your intentions, and I ask for yours for us as well. Thanks to Fr Michael Canny PP, Fr Patrick Lagan CC and Fr Joshy Parokkaran CC from Waterside for providing cover while I'm away.

We welcome into God's Family through the Sacrament of Baptism:

Lottie Kimberley Jowett

Remy Petroosbabakhan

May they Rest in Peace

Deaths

Gerard O'Connell, 60 Belldoo

Bernard O'Brien, 2 Mourne Park

Jackie Begley, 217 Ballycolman Estate

Jim Harley, 1 Melmount Park

Thomas Martin Roulston, 89 Carlton Drive

Anniversaries

Sr. Monica O’Kane, Mary Kate Mullen, William Robinson

Conor McCarron, Tony McAleer, Susan Logue

Vincent Gormley, Betty McColgan, Ellen Jane McCormick

John Ellis, Frances O’Connor, Tommy McGarrigle

Gerard Blake, Joe Millar, Tom Skehan

Kay McGuigan, William Devine, Jude Crotty

Frank Molloy, Maureen Devine, Eunan Herron

Tommy Finlay, Harry McCrossan, Anne McCay

Magdalene Curry, Molly McDaid, David Coyle

Deirdre Drumm Pearce, Dessie Drumm, Grace Drumm

Noel Brennan, Joe McNulty, Alice Alexander

Robert Brennan, George Fitzpatrick, Francis Moss

Margaret Quigley, Packie Duncan, Frank McElwee

Michael McDaid, Ann McShane, Patrick Early

George Early, Sarah Early, George Devenney

David McDaid, Marie Henderson

Announcements

Last week’s collections amounted to: **Melmount:** £3373.00; **Sion Mills:** £1465.00. Thank you. Those who pay to the weekly collection or any special collections, including Priest’s Collection by cheque are asked that all cheques should be made payable to ‘*Melmount Parish*’ or ‘*Sion Mills Parish*’ depending on the Parish. This is a banking requirement. *Parishioners can still leave their contributions in the Parish Office. If the Office is closed, please use the letterbox.*

Parish Bulletin This is the last bulletin until September.

Exposition of the Blessed Sacrament will take place in St. Mary's, Melmount tomorrow, Monday 13 July after 10.00am Mass until 6.30pm.

Vocations We pray for the men called to serve the Church as priests of our diocese, that their hearts will be the fertile soil Jesus needs to receive the seed which is His Word, and that they will spread His Word, His Good News, by their preaching and by the example of their lives.

Adoration Everyday The Blessed Sacrament can be adored in the Adoration Room, St. Theresa's, Sion Mills anytime while the church is open.

Baptism Dates Melmount

July: Sunday 19; Saturday 25; Sunday 26.

August: Saturday 8; Saturday 29.

September: Saturday 5; Sunday 13; Saturday 19.

October: Sunday 4; Saturday 10; Saturday 17; Saturday 24.

November: Sunday 8; Saturday 14; Saturday 21; Saturday 28.

Baptisms will be at 3.30pm on a Saturday and 12.45pm on a Sunday.

To book a Baptism contact the Parish Office on 71383777 during office hours.

Accord Marriage Preparation Courses (Pre-Marriage Courses) will take place in September 25/26 and November 20/21. All courses are now online for booking at

Www.Accordni.Com

Please Note: These courses are in person and not online courses.

Accord Derry will NOT be facilitating courses during October or December.

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Dlp@Derrydiocese.Org

. *Northern Ireland emergency services: PSNI on 101; Social Services: Gateway Services, Western HSC Trust, 028 71314090 and ask for the Duty Social Worker. Regional Emergency Social Work Services 0800 1979 995.*

The Parish Draws for July and August took place on Wednesday 8 July. The winners are as follows:

July Draw

£500: 1027 Genevieve O’Neill – *Genevieve O’Neill*

£250: 1350 Concepta McGarrigle – *Ann Donaghey*

£250: 1708 Thomas Moore – *Teresa Quigg*

£250: 1338 Marianne Patton – *Carol-ann Stewart*

£150: 1995 Tammy McNulty – *Irene Callan*

£150: 1304 Ina O’Neill – *Sheelagh McKelvey*

£150: 1719 Christine McHugh – *Teresa Quigg*

£100: 1243 Bronagh Lynch – *Declan Duffy*

£100: 1669 Declan McColgan – *Madeleine McColgan*

£100: 1702 Terrie Logue - *Genevieve O’Neill*

August Draw

£500: 1756 Vincent McCarron – *Katrina Houston*

£250: 1626 Anne Neeson – *Madeleine McColgan*

£250: 1379 Gary McNicholl – *Sheelagh McKelvey*

£250: 1862 Emma Lynch – *Elizabeth O'Hare*

£150: 1825 Susan McGuinness – *John Donohoe*

£150: 1684 Teresa Boggs – *Katrina Houston*

£150: 1380 Bridget McCrory – *Sheelagh McKelvey*

£100: 1010 Mya McNulty – *Dolores Houston*

£100: 1258 Corrine Hannigan – *Elizabeth O'Hare*

£100: 1507 Jacintha Gillespie - *Elizabeth O'Hare*

Forty Hours Adoration – St Mary's Melmount

Join us for **Forty Hours Adoration** in **St Mary's Melmount** between **26th and 27th October 2025**.

You can view or download the full programme by opening the link below. *To open in a new tab, right-click and select "Open link in new tab", or hold **Ctrl** (Windows) / **Cmd** (Mac) and click.*



[View Forty Hours Adoration PDF](#)



[Sign-Up Sheet \(PDF\)](#)

40 Hours Adoration
St Mary's, Melmount
26th – 27th October 2025

*You are invited to commit to a period of prayer before the Lord.
Please let us know what period you will cover by filling out a
Commitment Card and posting in the Box here or by posting into
Fr Sean or the Parish Office or send details by email*

Sunday 26th October 2025

8.00am	Morning Prayer
11.30am	Mass
3.00pm	Divine Mercy Chaplet
6.00pm	Holy Hour: Angelus, Evening Prayer and Stations of the Cross
9.00pm	Rosary (Glorious Mysteries)
9.30pm	Night Prayer



Monday 27th October 2025

12.00am	Rosary (Mysteries of Light)
3.00am	Rosary (Sorrowful Mysteries)
6.00am	Angelus and Chaplet for Priests
8.00am	Morning Prayer & Rosary (Joyful Mysteries)
10.00am	Mass
12.00pm	Angelus and Midday Prayer
3.00pm	Divine Mercy Chaplet
6.00pm	Angelus and Chaplet for Priests
8.00pm	Holy Hour: Evening Prayer and Rosary
9.30pm	Night Prayer
12.00am	Solemn Benediction to conclude the 40 Hours



Melmore Pastoral Area – Melmount and Sion Mills Parishes
41 Melmount Road, Strabane, BT82 9EF. Office: 028 7188 3777 Fr Sean: 028 7188 2648
Office: parishoffice@melmountparish.com Fr Sean: sean.coburn@diocemelmore.org

The Parish of Moville

St Pius X, Moville St Mary's, Ballybrack

St Columba's, Ballinacrae St Joseph's Oratory, Shrove



Parish Priest: Fr Colm O'Doherty (074) 9382057

Parish Office: (074) 9382057/0899421375

emails: movilleparish@derrydiocese.org
movilleparish@gmail.com

Bulletin email address: movillebulletin@gmail.com

Parish website: www.movilleparish.com

CALENDAR FOR THE WEEK AHEAD

Sunday 23rd Because of Peter's faith the promise is given to him. It is through faith that the Church at all times can have trust in the promise of God's protective power. So encouraged, we can meet the difficulties and human weaknesses that are part of the Church's life. The deepening of our faith must be the lifelong search of every Christian.

Monday 24th St Bartholomew, Apostle. Probably to be identified with Nathanael of Cana, whom Philip brought to Jesus. Said to have preached the Gospel in India. Patron saint of plasterers, tanners and leatherworkers.

Tuesday 25th St Louis of France (1214-70). King of France, father of eleven children, Franciscan tertiary, man of integrity, died in Tunisia on his second crusade.

St Joseph Calasanz (1556-1648) founded the Piarists to run free schools. Patron of Catholic schools.

Thursday 27th St Monica (332-387). Converted her pagan husband, Patricius, to the faith and by her prayers and her tears brought her son, St Augustine, to Christianity. Patron saint of mothers.

Friday 28th St Augustine (354-430). Bishop of Hippo in North Africa. An outstanding thinker, preacher and pastoral bishop. One of the most significant theological influences in the history of the western Church. Patron of theologians.

Saturday 29th The Passion of St John the Baptist. John prepared the way for Christ and bore witness to him when he came. His martyr's death was his last and greatest act of witness.

Sunday 30th 11.30am Mass will be celebrated in Moville First Anniversary Mass for Kathleen McCauley

Mass this week in St Pius X: Monday to Friday 10am. Saturday 6.30pm; Sunday 10am. **Confessions** in St. Pius X Church: Saturday 5.45pm to 6.15pm. **The Rosary and the Divine Mercy Chaplet** will be recited in St. Pius X Church, Moville, at 7.30pm every day, from Sunday – Friday. **Adoration of the Blessed Sacrament** on Monday, 2-9pm; Wednesday, 6-9pm.

We offer our **sympathy** to the families and friends of Mary Nolan, Redcastle, Charlene Tracey, Derry and Mary Ann Tames, Alabama who died recently. May they rest in peace.

Thank you for your generous financial support to the parish in the past week, which amounted to €3016 and for the following donations – €500, €280 and €40 and €25.

Catholic Mothers Ireland will hold its Fun Day on Sunday, 6 September at Termonbacca Retreat Centre, Derry beginning with Mass at 2pm, celebrated by Bishop Donal McKeown, followed by refreshments, children's activities, and a talk for parents. For details and to book, email info@catholicmothers.ie.

Donegal Down Syndrome Association Annual church-gate collection will take place next weekend 29 /30 August.

Prayer for Vocations: In this Sunday's gospel Peter acknowledges Jesus as the Christ, the Son of the living God, and Jesus confers on Peter "...the keys of the Kingdom..." an image reflected in the First Reading where the Lord says He will "...place the key of David..." on the shoulder of those called to lead His people, those who will be called "father." We pray to the Lord.

Blessing of Bikers and Motorcycles will take place on Sunday 13 September in St Aengus' Chapel, Burt, at 1.30pm. All are welcome to attend the brief service and blessing followed by the run to Ned's Point RNLI Station, to present the donation to the RNLI. Mass for deceased bikers takes place that day at 11.30am in St Patrick's Chapel, Dungiven.

As September approaches with the long evenings, why not sign up for **Irish** conversation classes. Classes depend on numbers. Contact gerrysona123@yahoo.ie if interested.

A Feast of Folk with Patsy Cavanagh and friends in The Cairn, at 8pm every Tuesday during July and August. Ballads and Folk songs from Ireland and further afield as seating is limited, please call 9381104.

Names are being taken for **Bridge Classes**, commencing mid-September. To register for classes or for further information please contact Margaret on 0863936255 as soon as possible

Serenity House (9382945) serenityhouse@eircom.net Chiropodist on Friday 28 August. Call the Centre to book. Classes beginning in September include Macrame, Glass Painting, Crochet and Painting. Contact the Centre for details

Carrowmena Community Centre (9367061) Cream Teas every Tuesday during August from between 2 and 4pm. Cost €5. A wide variety of courses is planned for the autumn. Contact the Centre for more information and to book.

The **Annual Garden Fete** will take place today Sunday, 23 August, from 3 to 6pm at Scoil Mhuire, Buncrana Entry €5 or €15 per family.

Book a **free hearing test** with no obligation, at Blackberry Hearing, Donegal Hearing, Malin Road, by calling 016978470.

Adoration Chapel

The prayer and presence of anyone who comes to quietly meditate before the Blessed Sacrament is an encouragement, a witness to fidelity and a gift to the Parish. As of 31st August, our Adoration Chapel is open for this prayer ministry, for those who faithfully come together to pray the Rosary each evening and to spend time during exposition of the Blessed Sacrament on Mondays and Wednesdays, or for anyone seeking a sanctuary of peace. All are welcome.

Our older parishioners will know this space was used for many years by the Sisters from the Convent of Mercy, who were a praying presence in our parish. Hopefully the warmth and simplicity of the Adoration Chapel will allow many of us to continue that legacy of prayer, in and on behalf of the needs of others and the needs of our world.

The Parish is grateful to all who helped in the design and setting up of the little Chapel and for the signage which points the way and is an invitation to all to 'come and pray'.

Fr O'Doherty hopes to attend the **Sick and Housebound** next week as follows

Monday 24 August – Moville Town Area from 11am.

Wednesday 26 August– Terryrone, Gulladuff and Ballinacrae Area from 11am.

Thursday 27 August – Carnagarve, Ballybrack, Greencastle and Shrove from 11am.

Safeguarding If you have any concerns with regards to Safeguarding children or adults, please contact Marie O'Kane, The Diocesan Designated Liaison Person at 00447596500793 or dlp@derrydiocese.org. Local Safeguarding Representatives are Mary McGranaghan and Brídín Hannaway

15th Sunday in Ordinary Time (Year A)

12 July 2026

The Soil of Our Lives

This Sunday Jesus tells us the parable of the sower. It is one of the most familiar stories in the Gospels. A farmer scatters seed. Some falls on the path, some on rocky ground, some among thorns, and some on rich soil. Only the rich soil produces a harvest.

Anyone who has ever grown anything in soil knows that you can have the best seed in the world, but if the ground isn't ready, nothing will come of it. The work is in the preparation. The digging, the clearing, the weeding. It is slow and unspectacular, and nobody sees it. But it makes all the difference.

Isaiah reminds us this weekend that God's Word never returns to Him empty. Like the rain and the snow that water the earth, His word always accomplishes what it was sent to do. The seed is never the problem. God is endlessly generous. He scatters His grace everywhere, on all of us, without measure and without favourites. The question the parable puts to each of us is a simple one: what kind of ground is He landing on?

Every one of us has been planted with gifts. Gifts of faith, of kindness, of patience, of prayer. Some of them are lying dormant because the soil of our lives has become hardened, or crowded, or shallow. The worries of the week, the busyness, the old hurts we haven't let go of — these are the thorns and the stones. They don't destroy the seed. They just stop it growing.

The good news is that soil can always be worked: A little time in prayer each day. An honest look at what is choking the Word in us. A return to the Sacraments. Small, quiet acts of clearing the ground! When we do that, our roots go down deeper into God, and we find a steadiness that the heat of life cannot wither.

St Paul tells us the whole of creation is groaning, waiting to be set free. That freedom begins in small plots of ground, that is in hearts like yours and mine that let the Word take root and grow.

So this week, ask the Lord: what needs clearing in me? Then let Him in with the spade! The harvest He promises is thirty, sixty, a hundredfold.

Fr Sean

FATIMA PILGRIMAGE

I'm in Fatima with Fr Stephen Baxter (our newly ordained) and 60 others from our Parishes and others in Fatima. Please be assured of our prayers at all our Masses, Rosaries and Processions for you all and your intentions, and I ask for yours for us as well. Thanks to Fr Michael Canny PP, Fr Patrick Lagan CC and Fr Joshy Parokkaran CC from Waterside for providing cover while I'm away.

We welcome into God's Family through the Sacrament of Baptism:

Lottie Kimberley Jowett

Remy Petroosbabakhan

May they Rest in Peace

Deaths

Gerard O'Connell, 60 Belldoo

Bernard O'Brien, 2 Mourne Park

Jackie Begley, 217 Ballycolman Estate

Jim Harley, 1 Melmount Park

Thomas Martin Roulston, 89 Carlton Drive

Anniversaries

Sr. Monica O'Kane, Mary Kate Mullen, William Robinson

Conor McCarron, Tony McAleer, Susan Logue

Vincent Gormley, Betty McColgan, Ellen Jane McCormick

John Ellis, Frances O'Connor, Tommy McGarrigle

Gerard Blake, Joe Millar, Tom Skehan

Kay McGuigan, William Devine, Jude Crotty

Frank Molloy, Maureen Devine, Eunan Herron

Tommy Finlay, Harry McCrossan, Anne McCay

Magdalene Curry, Molly McDaid, David Coyle

Deirdre Drumm Pearce, Dessie Drumm, Grace Drumm

Noel Brennan, Joe McNulty, Alice Alexander

Robert Brennan, George Fitzpatrick, Francis Moss

Margaret Quigley, Packie Duncan, Frank McElwee

Michael McDaid, Ann McShane, Patrick Early

George Early, Sarah Early, George Devenney

David McDaid, Marie Henderson

Announcements

Last week's collections amounted to: **Melmount:** £3373.00; **Sion Mills:** £1465.00. Thank you. Those who pay to the weekly collection or any special collections, including Priest's Collection by cheque are asked that all cheques should be made payable to 'Melmount Parish' or 'Sion Mills Parish' depending on the Parish. This is a banking requirement. *Parishioners can still leave their contributions in the Parish Office. If the Office is closed, please use the letterbox.*

Parish Bulletin This is the last bulletin until September.

Exposition of the Blessed Sacrament will take place in St. Mary's, Melmount tomorrow, Monday 13 July after 10.00am Mass until 6.30pm.

Vocations We pray for the men called to serve the Church as priests of our diocese, that their hearts will be the fertile soil Jesus needs to receive the seed which is His Word, and that they will spread His Word, His Good News, by their preaching and by the example of their lives.

Adoration Everyday The Blessed Sacrament can be adored in the Adoration Room, St. Theresa's, Sion Mills anytime while the church is open.

Baptism Dates Melmount

July: Sunday 19; Saturday 25; Sunday 26.

August: Saturday 8; Saturday 29.

September: Saturday 5; Sunday 13; Saturday 19.

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2 Remembering our Dead.

3 WEBCAM

4 Prayers For Protection

5 Mass Times

6 Getting Married

A short reflection on today's Gospel Matthew 16:13-20

In today's Gospel, Jesus asks his disciples a question that goes to the heart of our faith: "Who do you say that I am?" Peter answers with courage and conviction: "You are the Christ, the Son of the living God."

It is a question Jesus asks each one of us too. We may know about Jesus through Scripture, prayer and the life of the Church, but Jesus invites us to something deeper than simply knowing about him. He asks us to recognise him personally as the Son of God and to place our lives in his hands.

Peter's answer is a moment of great faith, yet Jesus also reminds him that this faith is a gift from God. The Church itself is built upon this faith, and Christ promises that the powers of evil will not overcome it. These words are a source of hope for us, especially when our own faith feels weak or when the Church faces difficulties.

Our response to Jesus cannot remain only words. To call him "the Christ" means allowing his presence to shape the way we live: how we treat others, how readily we forgive, how we respond to those in need, and how faithfully we carry our own crosses.

Perhaps then, this Gospel invites us to pause and answer Jesus' question for ourselves: Who is Jesus for me? May we have the grace to recognise him more clearly, trust him more deeply, and follow him more faithfully each day.

Prayer for Vocations to the Priesthood: In this Sunday's gospel Peter acknowledges Jesus as the Christ, the Son of the living God, and Jesus confers on Peter "...the keys of the Kingdom..." an image reflected in the First Reading where the Lord says He will "...place the key of David..." on the shoulder of those called to lead His people, those who will be called "father."

Today, Sunday 23rd August, we celebrate with joy the Solemnity of our patron, Saint Eugene, whose name and witness have a special place in the life of Saint Eugene's Cathedral. Saint Eugene served the Church with courage and faith, remaining faithful to Christ in challenging times. His life reminds us that holiness is not simply about great deeds, but about faithfully following Christ in the circumstances in which God has placed us.

As we celebrate our patronal feast, we give thanks for the faith handed down to us and for the living community that gathers in this Cathedral. Saint Eugene's witness encourages us to remain steadfast in our faith, generous in our service of others, and united as a parish family.

May Saint Eugene pray for our Cathedral community and for all who enter through its doors. May his example inspire us to proclaim Christ with courage and to live our faith with joy.

St Eugene, pray for us.

Save the Date: Saint Carlo Acutis Day of Prayer. You are invited to come to St Eugene's Cathedral, Derry on Sunday 11th October from 2.00pm where we will have Veneration of a First Class Relic of St Carlo Acutis, gifted to the Cathedral by Carlo's mother, Antonia. The Sacrament of Confession will be available from 2.00pm until Mass at 7.00pm, which will be celebrated by Bishop Michael Router. Adoration of the Blessed Sacrament will take place in the Mother Teresa Chapel during the Celebrations. A short film on Carlo's life will be shown in the Conference Room. Everyone is welcome to this special time.

Sympathy

We offer our sympathy to the family and friends of:
Bobby Moran
Willie Shiels
Jim Moore
May they rest in peace

Anniversaries

Please pray for the repose of the souls of:
Jeanie Gallacher
Philomena Duffy
Margaret Lewis
Sheila Lewis
Johnny Lewis
Nancé Gallagher
Nellie Kerlin
John Feeney
May they rest in peace

Baptisms

We welcome as members of God's family:
Jackson James Burke
Órlaith Joan Nicholas
Matthew David Saunders
To book a Baptism contact the Parish Office 02871 262894

Readers for 29th /30th August

6.15pm Roisin Rice Cutter
7.30pm Niamh Kehoe
9.30am Kate Doherty
11.00am Helen Sweeney
12.30pm Megan Dallet
7.00pm Anna Begley

Collection

Weekly Collection: £5,877
Parish Development: £1,122
Thank you for your generosity

Thank you

Fr Farren acknowledges with thanks the following donations for:
Mary's Meals: £100 £50 £300 £20 £20
Smile Train: £50 £50 £20 £300 £60 £150 £40
Sight Savers: £300 £40 £20
Trócaire: £10

Sick Visitation

Fr Shaun Doherty will attend the sick and housebound in his care on Tuesday and Friday.

Sick Visitation

Fr Paul Farren will attend the sick and housebound in his care during the coming week:
Monday afternoon from 1.30pm:
Lisfannon Park, William Street,
Creggan Street, Fahan Street,
Cable Street, Lower Road, Abbey House, Little Diamond
Mulvey Park, Laburnum Terrace, Elmwood Terrace,
Westland Street, Westland Terrace, Gartan Square, Clarendon Manor, Northland Road

St Monica and St Augustine: On 28th August, we celebrate St Monica, whose faithful prayers for her son Augustine never ceased, even when he had wandered far from the Christian faith. Her patience, trust and perseverance are an encouragement to all who pray for their loved ones. On 29th August, we celebrate St Augustine, Bishop and Doctor of the Church. Through God's grace and his mother's prayers, Augustine experienced a profound conversion and became one of the Church's greatest teachers. Their lives remind us that no one is beyond God's mercy and that persistent prayer can bear beautiful fruit. May St Monica teach us to trust God patiently, and St Augustine inspire us always to seek the truth and rest our hearts in God.

Blessing of Bikers and Motorcycles will take place on Sunday 13th September in St Aengus' Chapel, Burt, Co Donegal, at 1.30pm. All are welcome to attend the brief service and blessing. Following the blessing all are welcome to join the run to Ned's Point RNLI Station, to present the donation to the RNLI.

Please note, Mass will be celebrated on Sunday 13th September in St Patrick's Church, Dungiven, at 11.30am for deceased bikers, especially those who have died in past year.

Catholic Mothers Ireland – Family Day: Catholic Mothers Ireland will hold its Annual National Mass on Sunday, 6th September at Termonbacca Retreat Centre, Derry.

The day will begin with Mass at 2.00pm, celebrated by Bishop Donal McKeown, followed by refreshments, children's activities, and a talk for parents. This promises to be a lovely day for the whole family. For more information and booking details, please email info@catholicmothers.ie. All are welcome.

Just five minutes from Derry, the IOSAS Centre and Celtic Prayer Garden is a special place of peace, community and connection. Enjoy freshly prepared homemade food in our warm and welcoming surroundings, then take time in our beautiful Celtic Prayer Garden, relax and experience its wonderful peace and serenity.

Come along, meet friends and discover somewhere truly different. Group bookings are very welcome, with ample parking and easy level access for visitors with mobility needs. Find us at F93 F104. For more information contact us at 00353 74 9384866.

Accord Derry – Marriage Preparation Workshops 2026 - Accord Derry is pleased to announce upcoming Marriage Preparation Workshops taking place in 2026. These courses are designed to support couples as they prepare for the Sacrament of Marriage.

The remaining available dates for 2026 are as follows:

- September: 25th–26th 2026
- November: 20th–21st 2026

All courses are now available for online booking at: www.accordni.com.

Please note that Accord Derry will not be facilitating Marriage Preparation Courses during October or December 2026. Couples are encouraged to book early to secure a place on their preferred date.

St Eugene's Cathedral is monitored by CCTV cameras and by two live streaming cameras. Live streaming can be viewed online at www.churchservices.tv, www.watchmcnmedia or the parish website. The Diocese of Derry Privacy Notice is displayed on the parish website and Cathedral notice board, or you may obtain a copy from the Parish Office.

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Northern Ireland emergency services: PSNI (Police Service of Northern Ireland): 101 Social Services: Gateway Services, Western HSC Trust: 028 7131 4090 (and ask for the Duty Social Worker), Gateway Services, Northern HSC Trust: 028 9442 4459, Regional Emergency Social Work Services: 0800 1979 995. Republic of Ireland emergency services: Garda Síochána Buncrana: 00353 749 320 540 Letterkenny: 00353 749 167 100, TUSLA (ROI) Child and Family Agency: 00353 749 102 23

*Vol 54 No 32
Twenty-First Sunday
in Ordinary Time
23rd August 2026*

Priests: Fr Paul Farren, Fr Shaun Doherty

 Bulletin

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WEBCAM

NEWS/EVENTS

SCHOOLS

Sunday 23rd August
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Sunday 9th August
Sunday 2nd August
Sunday 26th July
Sunday 19th July
Sunday 12th July
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Sunday 28th June
Sunday 21st June
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Sunday 7th June
Sunday 31st May
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Sunday 15th June

Sunday 8th June

Sunday 1st June

Sunday 25th May

Sunday 18th May

Sunday 11th May

Sunday 4th May

Sunday 27th April

Sunday 20th April

Sunday 13th April

Sunday 6th April

Sunday 30th March

Sunday 23rd March

Sunday 16th March

Sunday 9th March

Sunday 2nd March

Sunday 23rd February

Sunday 16th February

Sunday 9th February

Sunday 2nd February

Sunday 26th January

Sunday 19th January

Sunday 12th January

Sunday 5th January

Sunday 22nd December

Sunday 15th December

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Sunday 10th November
Sunday 3rd November
Sunday 27th October
Sunday 20th October
Sunday 13th October

Saint Mary's Creggan

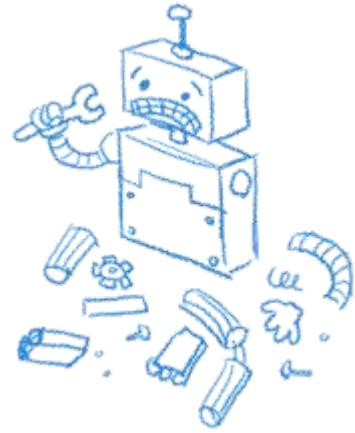
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STEELSTOWN PARISH NEWSLETTER

Sunday, 23rd August 2026

21st Sunday in Ordinary Time

Thoughts on the Gospel

“You are Peter, and on this rock I will build my Church.” — Matthew 16:18

In today’s Gospel, Jesus asks His disciples a very personal question about who they believe He is. Many people had different opinions about Him, but Jesus wanted His followers to speak from their own faith and experience.

Peter answers with confidence, recognising Jesus as the promised Saviour and the Son of God.

This passage reminds us that faith cannot depend only on what others believe. We may learn about God from our parents, teachers, friends or church community, but each of us must eventually make our own response to Jesus.

Remember the word **ROCK**

R — RECOGNISE Jesus as Lord and Saviour.

O — OWN our faith through our daily choices.

C — COMMIT to the calling God gives us.

K — KEEP standing firm when life becomes difficult.

Peter was not perfect, yet Jesus still used him for a great purpose. In the same way, God can work through our weaknesses and help us become part of His mission.

When we build our lives on Christ, our faith becomes stronger, our hope grows deeper, and our lives show the answer to Jesus’ question. Our response should not be seen only in our words, but also in how we love, forgive, serve and remain faithful.

Christ is the true foundation, and when we stand on Him, life’s storms may shake us, but they cannot destroy the hope He gives.

Prayer

Lord Jesus, you are the Messiah, the Son of the living God. Strengthen our faith to confess You with courage. May nothing overcome the hope we have in You.

Liturgy & Prayer

Readings for Sunday 30th August

1st Reading: Jeremiah 20:7-9

Psalm: 62:2-6, 8-9

2nd Reading: Romans 12:1-2

Gospel: Matthew 16:21-27



Saints of the Coming Week

Monday: St Bartholomew, Apostle

Tuesday: St Joseph Calasanz, priest; St Louis

Thursday: St Monica

Friday: St Augustine, bishop & doctor of the Church

Saturday: The Passion of St John the Baptist, martyr



Faith & Spiritual Life

Embrace the Grace

Legion of Mary Young Adult (18-40) Catholic Conference



Saturday 29th August



9.30 am - 6 pm



De Montfort House, Morning Star Ave, Dublin, D07 VA03

Tickets from Eventbrite. Search “**Embrace the Grace.**”



Please Pray for Vocations

Visit **derryvocations.org**



Sharing the Good News

Visit **theway.ie/ezine-2/** for the weekly ezine.



Lough Derg Day Retreats

August: 29 & 31

September: 5, 6, 9, 12, 15, 19 & 20

Take time away from the busyness of life for a day of guided prayer, quiet reflection and spiritual renewal in the peaceful surroundings of Lough Derg.

Visit **loughderg.org**

St Joseph's Men's Camino 2026

A day of **pilgrimage, prayer, brotherhood and renewal.**

Saturday 12th September

Step away from the demands of everyday life and spend a day walking with Christ alongside other Catholic men.

Inspired by the ancient tradition of pilgrimage, St Joseph Men's Camino is a **25km guided pilgrimage along the beautiful Boyne Valley Camino.**

Open to men aged 18 and over.

Cost: €65 (includes lunch & dinner)

Students: €55

Visit **dominicans.ie**

Contemplative Prayer Group

The Contemplative Prayer Group meets on **Mondays at 8 pm** in the Prayer Room in the Parochial House, Barrack St.

All welcome.

Family & Marriage

Catholic Mothers Ireland Family Day

Sunday 6th September

 Termonbacca Retreat Centre, Derry

 Beginning with the **National Mass at 2 pm**, celebrated by Bishop McKeown.

The Mass will be followed by refreshments, children's activities and a talk for parents. This promises to be a lovely day for the whole family.

For information / to book: info@catholicmothers.ie

All welcome.

Accord Derry Marriage Preparation

Marriage Preparation Course for those getting married in **late 2026 / early 2027.**

Next dates:

- September 25th/26th 2026
- November 20th/21st 2026

Please note that Accord Derry will **NOT** be facilitating courses during October or December 2026.

Register online at **accordni.com**

Marriage Enrichment Weekend

Marriage Encounter invites married couples to a residential weekend:

 **2nd - 4th October**

 Focolare Centre, Prosperous, Kildare

Step away from daily distractions to deepen your communication, renew your love and rediscover the joy of your marriage.

Visit **marriageencounter.ie**

Parish & Community Notices

Buncrana Annual Garden Fete

Today (Sunday), 3 - 6 pm

 Grounds of Scoil Mhuire, Buncrana, F93 PN53

Fun for all the family with Bouncy Castles, Mechanical Bull, Petting Farm, Facepainting, Bingo, Rickety Wheel, Children's Games, Raffle Prizes, etc.

Entry: €5pp / €15 per family (*cash only*)

All welcome.

Coffee Morning in Aid of Foyle Hospice

 **Friday 25th September**

 **9.30 am - 12.30 pm**

 Murphy's on the Green

Prize draw: £1 per line.

All welcome.

Michael English Church Concert

An Evening of Faith, Hope and Inspiration

 **Friday 2nd October**

 **7.15 pm**

 St Patrick's Church, Keenaught, Desertmartin

Tickets: £30

Available at Heron's Gift Shop, Draperstown, Moneyneena PO, Ballinascreen, Desertmartin Parish or through Eventbrite.

Reflections Through Poetry

Reflections Through Poetry by **Fr John P Forbes** is available in the Pastoral Office.

Cost: £10

Proceeds to **Children in Crossfire** and **Cause for Sr Clare's Canonisation**.

Support & Wellbeing

RISE

A vital new community initiative, **RISE** is dedicated to supporting the families, friends and loved ones of those living with addiction.

 **Sunday 13th September**

 **12 noon - 4 pm**

 Everglades Hotel, Derry

The gathering aims to bring together people who may feel isolated, overwhelmed or unaware of the support structures available to them as they navigate a loved one's addiction.

The foundational message of RISE is that **recovery and healing involve the whole family**. The day is designed to serve as a safe, welcoming space where people can share experiences, build meaningful connections and discover where they can turn for help.

To secure your place, send a direct message via Facebook Messenger to the official page.

Family Carers Ireland

Family Carers Ireland are running **1:1 support clinics remotely every Tuesday in August** for carers, offering you a space and time to talk over the phone in the comfort of your own home.

 **086 8363842**

 Donegalcs@familycarers.ie

Alzheimer's Society — Carers' Information Support Programme

The Alzheimer's Society is running a **Carers' Information Support Programme (CRISP)** for family, carers and friends of people living with dementia in the Omagh area.

The programme is run over two sessions and attendees should attend both afternoons.

 **7th & 8th September 2026**

 **3 - 5 pm**

 Conference Room, Silver Birch Hotel, 5 Gortin Road, Omagh

To register, please contact **Julie-Anne, Senior Dementia Adviser**.

 **07889 604702**

Registration is required prior to attendance.

Vacancies

Derry Diocesan Trust — Job Opportunity

Administrative & Financial Officer

 Waterside Parish, Derry

 **18 hrs pw**

 **£12.88 - £13.50 per hour**

For further information:

 recruitment@derrydiocese.org

 **028 71262302**

Closing date: 24/8/26

Personal Assistants Wanted

The Churches Trust is recruiting people for flexible part-time work supporting and befriending elderly people living independently at home.

No experience required – **training and support provided.**

A full clean driving licence and access to a vehicle are required.

 For more information, call **02871 311322.**

Fundraising

Lough Derg Annual Fundraising Draw

Help ensure **Station Island remains open for future generations.**

 **Single ticket: €10**

 **Book of 6: €50**

Buy a full book and you're entered into a **sellers' draw.**

Return a complete book for the **Early Bird Draw on 28/8/26.**

 **Main Draw: 23/10/26**

Tickets from loughderg.org/store/c3/annualdraw

 +353 (0) 71 9861518

 info@loughderg.org

Pilgrimage

Medjugorje Pilgrimage

 **23rd - 30th September**

 **Cost: €775 pps**

A Thought for the Week

“You are the Messiah, the Son of the living God.” — Matthew 16:16

May we recognise Christ, own our faith, commit ourselves to His calling and keep standing firm in Him.

R • O • C • K ?



PARISH NEWSLETTER

T: 028 7126 2360 E: threepatrons@derrydiocese.org W: threepatrons.org

Fr Micheál McGavigan PP – Fr Roni Zacharias CC – Fr Stephen Ward CC

Sunday 23rd August 2026 – Twenty First Sunday in Ordinary Time – Year A

In this Sunday's Gospel, Jesus asks his disciples a question that reaches across the centuries and speaks to every Christian: "Who do you say I am?" The disciples can easily repeat what others are saying, but Jesus invites them to move beyond public opinion to a personal profession of faith. Peter responds, "You are the Christ, the Son of the living God," not because he has learned the right answer, but because he has come to know Jesus through walking alongside him. In a world filled with competing voices and opinions, the Lord still asks each of us the same question. Faith cannot rely solely on what others believe or what we learned long ago. It grows through our own experience of Christ's presence in our lives, especially in moments of joy, struggle, loss and hope. As we reflect on the Gospel this week, may we recognise anew the Lord who walks with us and find in him the firm foundation on which to build our lives.

WELCOME TO GOD'S FAMILY

Kayleigh Rose Devine; Hannah Mary Lau; Lorcan Gabriel McIvor; Emily Claire Martin.

REQUIESCANT IN PACE

We offer our sympathies to the family and friends of:

Helen Bradley, Lenamore Gardens; Frances (Lily) Friel, Castlevue Park; Elizabeth Rankin, Pennyburn Court; Anne Campbell, Aberfoyle Crescent; Noel Rodgers, Bloomfield Park

ANNIVERSARIES

Anna Marie Stewart; Kathleen Downey; Micky Doherty; Margaret Yates; Kevin Leonard; Pearse Donnelly; Henry Bryson; Rosaleen Barnett; Eileen Johnson; James & Jean McCauley; Margaret McCarron; Bosco Heaney; Annie Barnfield; Barney Quigg; Bridget Elliott; Davy McLaughlin; Bronagh Sharkey; Gerry Sharkey; Greg Sharkey; Eugene Crawford; Tom Stokes; Jimmy Crumley.

READINGS FOR SUNDAY 23rd AUGUST

1st Isaiah 22:10-23. Psalm: 137:1-3, 6, 8, R/v8.

2nd Romans 11:33-36.

Gospel Matthew 16:13-20

SIMPLE FAMILY PRAYER BOOK

This Sunday begins psalter week 1

READERS NEEDED AT MASS

Our parish is seeking new readers to proclaim the Word of God at weekend Masses. This is a valuable ministry that helps bring the Scriptures to life for our congregation. No previous experience is necessary, and full training and support will be provided. If you would be willing to serve in this important role, or would like to find out more, please contact the parish office or speak to one of the priests after Mass.

VOCATIONS

In this Sunday's gospel Peter acknowledges Jesus as the Christ, the Son of the living God, and Jesus confers on Peter "...the keys of the Kingdom..." an image reflected in the First Reading where the Lord says He will "...place the key of David..." on the shoulder of those called to lead His people, those who will be called "father."

BUNCRANA PARISH GARDEN FETE 2026

The Annual Garden Fete will take place today, Sunday, 23 August, from 3.00 - 6.00pm in the grounds of Scoil Mhuire, BunCrana F93 PN53. Fun for all the family with Bouncy Castles, Mechanical Bull, Petting Farm, Facepainting, Bingo, Rikety Wheel, Children's Games, Raffle Prizes and more. Entry €5pp or €15 per family (cash only). All welcome.

LAST WEEK'S OFFERTORY COLLECTION

St Patrick's Church: £1,266 - St Brigid's Church: £2,272 - St Joseph's Church: £910

2nd Collection (Maintenance & Pastoral Outreach): £1,082.

Thank you for your continued generosity.

BANK DETAILS FOR ONLINE DONATIONS: A/C Name: The Parish of the Three Patrons

Sort Code: 95-06-79 A/C No: 60320021

EMBRACE THE GRACE

Young Adult Catholic Conference - 29 August 2026 - a conference on faith and culture for young adults (18-40) with talks, prayer, Mass, confession, workshops, food and social in the historic Legion of Mary headquarters at De Montfort House, North Brunswick Street, Dublin 7. It will be a chance to build faith in friendship with young adults from across the country. Saturday 30 August from 9.30am to 6pm with a social afterwards. Tickets €20 and can be booked on the eventbrite website by looking up 'Embrace the Grace'. Further queries contact: deusetpatria@gmail.com

BLESSING OF BIKERS & MOTORCYCLES

Will take place on Sunday 13 September in St Aengus' Chapel, Burt, Co Donegal, at 1:30. All are welcome to attend the brief service and blessing. Following the blessing all are welcome to join the run to Ned's Point RNLI Station, to present the donation to the RNLI. Please note, Mass will be celebrated on Sunday 13 September in St Patrick's Chapel, Dungiven, at 11:30am for deceased bikers, especially those who have died in past year.

MICHAEL ENGLISH CHURCH CONCERT

An evening of Faith, Hope and Inspiration. The concert takes place on Friday 2 October at 7.15pm, in St Patrick's Church, Keenaught, Desertmartin. Tickets are £30, and available to buy at Herons Gift Shop, Draperstown, Moneyneena Post Office, Ballinascreen and Desertmartin Parish offices, or online with Eventbrite: <https://www.eventbrite.co.uk/e/michael-english-band-fundraising-concert-tickets-1996641829460>

MARRIAGE ENRICHMENT WEEKEND

Marriage Encounter Ireland invites married couples to a residential Weekend from Friday 2 to Sunday 4 October 2026 at the Focolare Centre, Curryhills, Prosperous, Co. Kildare. Step away from daily distractions to deepen your communication, renew your love, and rediscover the joy of your marriage. Visit www.marriageencounter.ie

ST PIO CAFÉ

The Café at St Pio house will be closed for the next few weeks and will reopen on Tuesday 2nd September. We thank all those who help to make this such a success.

CATHOLIC MOTHERS IRELAND – FAMILY DAY

Catholic Mothers Ireland will hold its Annual National Mass on Sunday 6 September at Termonbacca Retreat Centre, Derry. The day will begin with Mass at 2.00pm, celebrated by Bishop Donal McKeown, followed by refreshments, children's activities, and a talk for parents. This promises to be a lovely day for the whole family. For more information and booking details, please email info@catholicmothers.ie. All are welcome.

PRIVACY NOTICE

The Diocese of Derry complies with GDPR regulations, and a privacy notice is available on the Parish website or by contacting the Parish Office. Livestream and recordings of Mass and services in our Churches are available online. Please note that the front rows of seats are visible online.

SAFEGUARDING

If you have any concerns about the Safeguarding of Children or vulnerable adults within the Church, please contact Marie O'Kane, the Diocesan Designated Liaison Person (DLP) on 07596500793 or at dlp@derrydiocese.org

PARISH GROUPS & MEETINGS (SUMMER)

Monday	After 11am Mass 1pm – 2.30pm 7pm - 9pm	Holy Souls Prayer Group Legion of Mary Woman's Craft Group	Our Lady's Chapel, Galliagh Meeting Room, St Joseph's Church, Galliagh Kildare Room, Carnhill
Tuesday	After 11am Mass 11.30am - 2.30pm 7.30pm - 9.30pm	Devotion to the Holy Face St. Pio's Café Living Disciples Prayer Group	Our Lady's Chapel, Galliagh St Pio Centre, Galliagh (Closed until September) St Pio Centre, Galliagh
Thursday	11.30am - 2.30pm 6pm – 7pm 7pm – 8pm 7.30pm - 8.30pm 8.15pm – 10pm	St. Pio's Café Divine Will Prayer Group Holy Hour for the Unborn Youth Prayer Group Be Still – Men's Prayer Group	St. Pio Centre, Galliagh (Closed until September) Kildare Room, Carnhill Our Lady's Chapel St. Pio Centre, Galliagh Our Lady's Chapel
Friday	11.30am-12.30pm	Divine Mercy Prayer Group	Our Lady's Chapel, Galliagh

PARISH SCHEDULE - SUMMER ST PATRICK'S CHURCH, PENNYBURN

Sunday Mass:	Vigil 6.15pm; 9.45am
Weekday Mass:	Monday to Friday: 10am
Confessions:	Saturday: 5.15pm – 6pm
Baptisms:	Saturday: 4.30pm; Sunday: 1.30pm

ST BRIGID'S CHURCH, CARNHILL

Sunday Mass:	Vigil 5pm; 10.30am & 12.30pm
Weekday Mass:	Monday to Friday: 9.30am; Saturday: 11am
Confessions:	Saturday after 11.00am Mass and 4pm - 4.45pm
Eucharistic Adoration:	Daily: 8.00am – 8.00pm in St Carlo Acutis Chapel
Baptisms:	Saturday: 3.30pm

ST JOSEPH'S CHURCH, GALLIAGH

Sunday Mass:	11.00am; 12.30pm (<i>An tAifreann Naofa</i>); 6.30pm
Weekday Mass:	Monday to Friday: 11am
Confessions:	Sunday: 5.30pm – 6.15pm
Eucharistic Adoration:	Tuesday: 11.30am – 1pm in Our Lady's Chapel
Baptisms:	Saturday: 3.30pm

Parishes of Glendermott & Strathfoyle

Sunday 23rd August 2026

Twenty-first Sunday in Ordinary Time

Keys to the kingdom

When we are asked the question “what is that key for?” our response is usually “it opens that door.” Not “it locks that door,” rather “it opens that door.” In response to the question of Jesus, “Who do you say I am?” Peter’s answer, whether he fully understood it or not was the responsibility of the keys of the kingdom of heaven. Keys are small things, but they carry great meaning. they give access and they open doors. They also show trust, because a key is not usually given to someone unless they are being entrusted with responsibility.

Many doors in life can feel closed: the door of hope after failure, the door of belonging after loneliness, the door of faith after disappointment, the door of peace after hurt. The Gospel invites us to ask what doors Christ wants to open through us for the good of others. A patient conversation, a sincere apology, a generous welcome, or a quiet prayer may become a key in God’s hands.

Jesus does not give Peter keys so that he can keep people out. He gives them so that Peter, and the Church built on his faith, can open the way to God’s mercy, truth and life. The keys remind us that faith is never only private. When we recognise who Jesus is, we are drawn into his mission and we too are trusted with keys: words that can encourage and build up, forgiveness that can release, kindness that can welcome, and courage that can open a path for someone who feels shut out.

Peter’s strength was not that he understood everything or was always successful. His strength began with recognising Jesus and that is where our mission begins too. Before we can open doors for others, we must let Christ open the locked places in our own hearts. He asks us again today, “Who do you say I am?” If we answer with faith, he will place keys in our hands: not for power, but for service; not for control, but for welcome; not to close people off, but to help open the door to the kingdom.

Baptisms We welcome members of God's family in Baptism, **Pennie Maisie Winnie Kelly**, Parklands and **Neveah Helen Boylan**, Woodside Heights

Deaths We keep in our prayers **Sister Mary Mullan** whose funeral took place in Dublin on Wednesday

Anniversaries – We are asked to remember in prayer: Kay Gillespie, Mary Colhoun, Terry McLaughlin, Frances Brown, Frances Kerr, Annie Ming, Dai Parkhouse, Bernard Doherty, Dorothy Kehoe, Mary McConnell, Josie McGeady, Dennis Dillon, Flora McLaughlin, Jim McGowan, Brian McMenamin, Kathy McCauley, Eamonn McCafferty, Jim Hamilton, Michael McLaughlin.

Vocations – In this Sunday's gospel Peter acknowledges Jesus as the Christ, the Son of the living God, and Jesus confers on Peter "...the keys of the Kingdom..." an image reflected in the First Reading where the Lord says He will "...place the key of David..." on the shoulder of those called to lead His people, those who will be called "father." For those interested or even wish to enquire about a call to diocesan priesthood, please contact Fr. Pat O'Hagan, Vocations Director for the Diocese of Derry at pgoh2111@gmail.com

Vocations Society of St Joseph (Waterside Parish) We continue to pray for priests, vocations to priesthood and religious life and support seminarians. The Rosary on Thursday mornings at 9.30am offered for this intention and everyone welcome.

Lectio Divina – Join us on **Thursday** evenings at 8:00pm in St Columb's Church for our weekly praying of the Sacred Scriptures.

Offertory Collections: Glendermott: £3,630.00 Strathfoyle: £555.00

Thank you for your generosity to the parish collections.

Are you interested in volunteering to help children and adults in our parish to prepare to receive the Sacraments? If you have a basic knowledge of Catholic teaching and some teaching experience (not essential), please contact the Parish Office Tel. 02871 342303. You will join a small parish team and be supported in preparing and delivering sessions. The time commitment would be around 2 hours per week from end of September to May. Safeguarding checks will be carried out.

***"He who sings, prays twice."* (St Augustine)** – St Columb's church choir is on its summer break for the months of **July & August** and will resume in September. We are constantly looking for new singers, maybe you would consider joining, just come along and give it a try or talk to Marcus or any choir members.

Administrative & Financial Officer (18 hours pw), Waterside Parish, Parochial House, 32 Chapel Road, Derry. Rate of pay: £12.88 per hr - £13.50 per hr. For application packs please email: recruitment@derrydiocese.org or tel 028 7126 2302. Completed applications must be returned to Personnel, Bishop's House, St Eugene's Cathedral, Francis Street, Derry, BT48 9AP or via email to recruitment@derrydiocese.org no later than 12 noon Monday 24th August 2026. Derry Diocesan Trust is an Equal Opportunities Employer. We welcome applications from all men and women and from members of all communities.

Accord Derry - Marriage Preparation Workshops - September and November 2026. September 25th/26th 2026 – November 20th/21st 2026. These courses are now online for booking at www.accordni.com **Please note** that Accord Derry will **NOT** be facilitating courses during October or December 2026.

Blessing of Bikers and Motorcycles will take place on Sunday 13 September in St Aengus' Chapel, Burt, Co Donegal, at 1:30. All are welcome to attend the brief service and blessing. Following the blessing all are welcome to join the run to Ned's Point RNLI Station, to present the donation to the RNLI.

Catholic Mothers Ireland – Family Day: Catholic Mothers Ireland will hold its Annual National Mass on Sunday, 6 September at Termonbacca Retreat Centre, Derry. The day will begin with Mass at 2.00pm, celebrated by Bishop Donal McKeown, followed by refreshments, children's activities, and a talk for parents. For more information and booking details, please email info@catholicmothers.ie.

Michael English Concert An evening of Faith, Hope and Inspiration. The concert takes place on Friday 2 October at 7.15pm, in St Patrick's Church, Keenaught, Desertmartin. Tickets are £30, and available to buy at online with Eventbrite: <https://www.eventbrite.co.uk/e/michael-english-band-fundraising-concert-tickets-1996641829460>

Exam results time We remember in prayer in a special way those in our parish who have or are receiving exam results around this time and are making decisions on their future.

Holy Spirit source of wisdom and truth

Guide my thoughts words and actions

Help me to discern God's will in all things for my future. Give me courage to follow the path you place before me and the grace to trust in your direction.

Lead me always closer to Christ. Amen

Mass & Confession Times

Sunday

St Columb's Church	10.00am, 12.30pm & 6.00pm
Church of Immaculate Conception	10.15am & 12.15pm
St Oliver Plunkett Church	11.15am
St Mary's Oratory	9.15am

Monday – Friday

St Columb's Church	10.00am & 7.30pm
Church of Immaculate Conception	9.15am (Monday – Friday)
St Oliver Plunkett's Church	11.00am (Mon, Tue and Thursday)

St Mary's Oratory	11.00am (Wednesday only)
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Saturday

St Columb's Church	10.00am & 7.00pm (Vigil of Sunday)
Church of Immaculate Conception	6.00pm (Vigil of Sunday)
St Oliver Plunkett's Church	6.00pm (Vigil of Sunday)

Confessions

St Columb's Church	Monday – Friday 7.00pm – 7.25pm Saturday after 10.00 Mass
Church of Immaculate Conception	Saturday 5.30pm – 5.55pm
St Oliver Plunkett's Church	Saturday 5.30pm – 5.55pm

Parish Office 32 Chapel Road, Derry BT47 2BB. Tel. 02871 342303

Email: secretary@watersideparish.net **Web:** www.watersideparish.net

YouTube Channel: www.youtube.com/WatersideParish

Rev. Michael Canny PP 02871342303 secretary@watersideparish.net

Rev. Patrick Lagan CC 02871342303 secretary@watersideparish.net

Rev Joshy Parokkaran CC 02871342303 secretary@watersideparish.net

SAFEGUARDING CHILDREN AND VULNERABLE ADULTS – If you are concerned about the welfare and safety of children or a vulnerable adult contact: Designated Diocesan Person Ms Marie Gormley at 07596500793 or marie.gormley@derrydiocese.org or PSNI 101.

Our Churches are monitored by CCTV cameras and by live streaming. Live streaming can be viewed online at the parish website. The Diocese of Derry Privacy Notice is displayed on the parish website and Church notice board.
